

MODEL RUN TRANSCRIPT

Generated: 2026-08-10T10:18:20

Source: data/json/noise_experiments/v2/noise2i_memprimary_game_myth/claude-sonnet-4.5/game_myth/noisy_bidirectional_informed_memprimary/noise2i_memprimary_game_myth_003_neutral_rep03_memtest_memory_primary_anything.json

RUN METADATA

```
model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
temperature: 0.8
num_turns: 10
num_agents: 2
memory_capacity: 2
myth_topic_id: anything
myth_topic: anything
game_params_name: noisy_bidirectional_informed_memprimary
noise_config: {
  "applies_to": "both",
  "inform_agents": true,
  "range": 1.0,
  "type": "uniform"
}
other_player_names: default
replicate_id: 3
myth_prompt_arm_id: memtest_memory_primary
myth_default_prompt_key: myth_writing_default_game_directive
myth_later_prompt_key: myth_writing_later_rounds_directive_memory_primary
history_policy: minimal
self_history_window: 1
coplayer_history_window: 0
show_agent_names: true
defector_ratio_requested: 0.0
defector_ratio_actual: 0.0
defector_count: 0
defector_agent_ids: []
defector_seed: 3
task_order: [
  "game",
  "myth"
]
agent_names: {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
}
agent_types: {
  "Agent_1": "standard",
  "Agent_2": "standard"
}
```

Coverage: exact chat message snapshots sent to the model are included for every recorded LLM call.

AGENTS

Agent_1 (Aster); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=2

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Agent_2 (Briar); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=2

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

ROUND 1

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$4; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$6, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$5; noise/visible: sent visible=\$2.65, received visible=\$7.95, returned visible=\$3.54

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 6.0,
"Agent_2": 5.0

}

```
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 5.54,
  "Agent_2": 3.9499999999999993
}
```

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:07:46

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Since this is Round 1 and no myths have been written yet in this session, I'll make my decision based on the game structure alone.

This is a trust game where cooperation can benefit both of us. By sending money, I'm creating value (3x multiplier), but I'm also taking a risk that depends on whether the receiver will reciprocate.

For the first round, I'll send a moderate amount to test the waters and demonstrate willingness to cooperate, while not risking everything before I have information about the receiver's behavior.

****My decision:****

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

I'm sending \$3, which will become \$9 for the receiver. This shows trust while allowing me to learn about their reciprocity before future rounds.

Reasoning:

This is Round 1 and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 and need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about the game mechanics:

- I send an amount (0-5)
- That amount is multiplied by 3x
- The receiver decides how much to return
- I keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned

The prompt mentions I should "take any myths written in this session into account when making my decision." However, no myths have been written yet in this session, so there's nothing to take into account yet.

This is a classic trust game scenario. The optimal social outcome would be for me to send the full \$5, which becomes \$15 for the receiver, and then for the receiver to return a fair split (like \$10, giving us each \$10 total). However, this requires trust that the receiver will reciprocate.

Some considerations:

1. This is Round 1, so I have no information about the receiver's behavior yet
2. There's a note about "communication noise" - amounts may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned
3. The receiver has an incentive to keep everything if they're purely self-interested
4. But if we'll play multiple rounds, cooperation could be beneficial

For a first round without any prior information or myths written, I should probably send a moderate amount to:

- Show some trust and willingness to cooperate
- Test the receiver's trustworthiness
- Not risk everything on the first round

A reasonable first move would be to send \$3. This:

- Shows trust and good faith
- Gives the receiver \$9 to work with
- Leaves me with \$2 guaranteed
- Allows me to see how they respond before future rounds

Let me send \$3.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 380,
  "output_tokens": 578,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:08:01

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user
content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$2.65, that is 53.0% of their total endowment. You received \$7.949999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-7.949999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

- The sender showed considerable trust by sending \$2.65 (53% of their endowment)
- I received \$7.95 after the 3x multiplier
- I want to reward their trust while also benefiting from the interaction

Let me calculate a fair return:

- If I return \$4.00:
 - Sender ends with: $\$5 - \$2.65 + \$4 = \6.35 (profit of \$1.35)
 - I keep: $\$7.95 - \$4 = \$3.95$ (profit of \$3.95)

This seems like a reasonable split that rewards the sender's trust while both of us benefit from the cooperation.

{'return': 4.0}

Reasoning:

This is round 1 and I'm the RECEIVER. Let me analyze the situation:

1. The sender sent \$2.65 out of \$5 (53% of their endowment)
2. This was multiplied by 3x, so I received \$7.95 (approximately)
3. I need to decide how much to return (between \$0 and \$7.95)

The note mentions there may be communication noise, so the exact amount I received is \$7.949999999999999 (essentially \$7.95).

Let me think about what would be a fair and reciprocal response:

- The sender showed significant trust by sending 53% of their endowment
- If I return nothing, I keep \$7.95 and the sender ends up with only \$2.35 ($\$5 - \2.65)
- The sender took a risk to potentially benefit both of us

A common approach in trust games is to:

1. Return enough so the sender profits from their trust
2. Keep enough to make it worthwhile for me to participate

Let's consider different return amounts:

Option 1: Return \$4 (approximately 50% of what I received)

- Sender ends up with: $\$5 - \$2.65 + \$4 = \6.35
- I keep: $\$7.95 - \$4 = \$3.95$
- Sender gains \$1.35, I gain \$3.95
- This seems reasonable as both benefit

Option 2: Return \$5 (approximately 63% of what I received)

- Sender ends up with: $\$5 - \$2.65 + \$5 = \7.35
- I keep: $\$7.95 - \$5 = \$2.95$
- Sender gains \$2.35, I gain \$2.95
- This is more equitable
- Returning less than this, say \$3, would only give the sender a \$0.35 gain while I pocket \$4.95, which feels stingy given their generosity.

Since the sender demonstrated real trust by committing over half their stake, I should reciprocate meaningfully. I'll return \$4-it rewards their risk-taking while still giving me a solid

Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 417,
 "output_tokens": 848,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:08:14

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 1,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths
, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant**content:**

Since this is Round 1 and no myths have been written yet in this session, I'll make my decision based on the game structure alone.

This is a trust game where cooperation can benefit both of us. By sending money, I'm creating value (3x multiplier), but I'm also taking a risk that depends on whether the receiver will reciprocate.

For the first round, I'll send a moderate amount to test the waters and demonstrate willingness to cooperate, while not risking everything before I have information about the receiver's behavior.

****My decision:****

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

I'm sending \$3, which will become \$9 for the receiver. This shows trust while allowing me to learn about their reciprocity before future rounds.

reasoning:

This is Round 1 and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 and need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about the game mechanics:

- I send an amount (0-5)
- That amount is multiplied by 3x
- The receiver decides how much to return
- I keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned

The prompt mentions I should "take any myths written in this session into account when making my decision." However, no myths have been written yet in this session, so there's nothing to take into account yet.

This is a classic trust game scenario. The optimal social outcome would be for me to send the full \$5, which becomes \$15 for the receiver, and then for the receiver to return a fair split (like \$10, giving us each \$10 total). However, this requires trust that the receiver will reciprocate.

Some considerations:

1. This is Round 1, so I have no information about the receiver's behavior yet
2. There's a note about "communication noise" - amounts may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned
3. The receiver has an incentive to keep everything if they're purely self-interested
4. But if we'll play multiple rounds, cooperation could be beneficial

For a first round without any prior information or myths written, I should probably send a moderate amount to:

- Show some trust and willingness to cooperate
- Test the receiver's trustworthiness
- Not risk everything on the first round

A reasonable first move would be to send \$3. This:

- Shows trust and good faith
- Gives the receiver \$9 to work with
- Leaves me with \$2 guaranteed
- Allows me to see how they respond before future rounds

Let me send \$3.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 380,
  "output_tokens": 578,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```



```

    }
    Message 4 role=user
    content:
        Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.
        In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected
        . Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have
        been playing up to this point.
Assistant output:
    **The Myth of the First Bridge**

    In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The Giver's vi
    llage had fertile soil but no water. The Keeper's village had abundant springs but barren la
    nd.

    One day, the Giver gathered three baskets of grain-not all she possessed, but enough to show g
    enuine faith. She cast them into the river, whispering, "May these multiply in good hands."

    The River Spirit, seeing such trust, tripled the grain as it floated downstream. The Keeper re
    ceived nine baskets at her shore.

    The Keeper faced a choice: keep all the bounty, or honor the trust shown. She understood that
    the Giver had kept some grain back-wise caution, not selfishness. The Keeper returned five b
    askets upstream, keeping four for her village.

    Both villages ate well that season. The Giver had given three and received five-a gain. The Ke
    eper had received nine and kept four-also a gain.

    From this exchange grew understanding. In future seasons, they built a bridge where the grain
    had floated. Trust, measured and reciprocated, became the stones of that bridge.

    The River Spirit smiled, for she knew: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the courag
    e to share and the wisdom to return.
Reasoning:
    The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played.
    So far, I sent $3 in Round 1, showing moderate trust and cooperation.

    I should write a myth that embodies the principles of:
    - Trust and cooperation
    - Reciprocity
    - The multiplication of resources when shared
    - Building relationships through measured risk-taking

    Let me create a myth that captures these themes. I'll use mythic elements like ancient figures
    , symbolic actions, and a moral about cooperation.
Usage: {
    "input_tokens": 618,
    "output_tokens": 413,
    "reasoning_tokens": 0
}

```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:08:14

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
    "agent_type": "standard",
    "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
    "move_index": 1,
    "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
    "pairing": {
        "agent_names": {
            "Agent_1": "Aster",
            "Agent_2": "Briar"
        },
    },
    "agents": [
        "Agent_1",
        "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {

```

```

    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 1,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$2.65, that is 53.0% of their total endowment. You received \$7.949999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-7.949999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

- The sender showed considerable trust by sending \$2.65 (53% of their endowment)
- I received \$7.95 after the 3x multiplier
- I want to reward their trust while also benefiting from the interaction

Let me calculate a fair return:

- If I return \$4.00:
 - Sender ends with: \$5 - \$2.65 + \$4 = \$6.35 (profit of \$1.35)
 - I keep: \$7.95 - \$4 = \$3.95 (profit of \$3.95)

This seems like a reasonable split that rewards the sender's trust while both of us benefit from the cooperation.

```
{'return': 4.0}
```

reasoning:

This is round 1 and I'm the RECEIVER. Let me analyze the situation:

1. The sender sent \$2.65 out of \$5 (53% of their endowment)
2. This was multiplied by 3x, so I received \$7.95 (approximately)
3. I need to decide how much to return (between \$0 and \$7.95)

The note mentions there may be communication noise, so the exact amount I received is \$7.949999999999999 (essentially \$7.95).

Let me think about what would be a fair and reciprocal response:

- The sender showed significant trust by sending 53% of their endowment
- If I return nothing, I keep \$7.95 and the sender ends up with only \$2.35 (\$5 - \$2.65)
- The sender took a risk to potentially benefit both of us

A common approach in trust games is to:

1. Return enough so the sender profits from their trust
2. Keep enough to make it worthwhile for me to participate

Let's consider different return amounts:

Option 1: Return \$4 (approximately 50% of what I received)

- Sender ends up with: $\$5 - \$2.65 + \$4 = \6.35
- I keep: $\$7.95 - \$4 = \$3.95$
- Sender gains \$1.35, I gain \$3.95
- This seems reasonable as both benefit

Option 2: Return \$5 (approximately 63% of what I received)

- Sender ends up with: $\$5 - \$2.65 + \$5 = \7.35
- I keep: $\$7.95 - \$5 = \$2.95$
- Sender gains \$2.35, I gain \$2.95
- This is more equitable
- Returning less than this, say \$3, would only give the sender a \$0.35 gain while I pocket \$4.95, which feels stingy given their generosity.

Since the sender demonstrated real trust by committing over half their stake, I should reciprocate meaningfully. I'll return \$4-it rewards their risk-taking while still giving me a solid

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 417,
  "output_tokens": 848,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

****The Myth of the Two Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the springs were cursed: their waters only multiplied when shared with the other village.

One day, Elder Mara from the East village filled her vessel halfway and carried it across the valley. "I trust you with this water," she said to Elder Kael of the West. As she poured it into his fountain, the water tripled before their eyes.

Kael faced a choice. He could keep all the abundant water for himself, or honor Mara's trust. He remembered his grandmother's teaching: "When someone crosses the valley bearing gifts, send them home richer than they came, but not so poor that you suffer."

Kael returned half of the multiplied water. Both villages prospered-Mara returned home with more than she left, and Kael kept enough to flourish.

The pattern continued, generation after generation. Those who returned too little found no one would trust them again. Those who returned too much left their own village thirsty. But those who balanced generosity with wisdom created an eternal cycle of abundance.

The springs still flow today, teaching that trust multiplied and fairly returned creates wealth for all.

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the game should be played, based on my experience so far. In Round 1, I was the receiver and the sender showed trust by sending 53% of their endowment. I returned about 50% of what I received, creating a mutually beneficial outcome where both parties profited.

The key themes I should incorporate:

1. Trust and reciprocity
2. Mutual benefit through cooperation
3. Fair sharing that rewards initial trust
4. Both parties gaining from the exchange

I'll create a myth that embodies these principles.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 663,  
  "output_tokens": 416,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

****The Myth of the First Bridge****

In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The Giver's village had fertile soil but no water. The Keeper's village had abundant springs but barren land.

One day, the Giver gathered three baskets of grain-not all she possessed, but enough to show genuine faith. She cast them into the river, whispering, "May these multiply in good hands."

The River Spirit, seeing such trust, tripled the grain as it floated downstream. The Keeper received nine baskets at her shore.

The Keeper faced a choice: keep all the bounty, or honor the trust shown. She understood that the Giver had kept some grain back-wise caution, not selfishness. The Keeper returned five baskets upstream, keeping four for her village.

Both villages ate well that season. The Giver had given three and received five-a gain. The Keeper had received nine and kept four-also a gain.

From this exchange grew understanding. In future seasons, they built a bridge where the grain had floated. Trust, measured and reciprocated, became the stones of that bridge.

The River Spirit smiled, for she knew: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the courage to share and the wisdom to return.

Agent_2 (Briar)

****The Myth of the Two Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the springs were cursed: their waters only multiplied when shared with the other village.

One day, Elder Mara from the East village filled her vessel halfway and carried it across the valley. "I trust you with this water," she said to Elder Kael of the West. As she poured it into his fountain, the water tripled before their eyes.

Kael faced a choice. He could keep all the abundant water for himself, or honor Mara's trust. He remembered his grandmother's teaching: "When someone crosses the valley bearing gifts, send them home richer than they came, but not so poor that you suffer."

Kael returned half of the multiplied water. Both villages prospered-Mara returned home with more than she left, and Kael kept enough to flourish.

The pattern continued, generation after generation. Those who returned too little found no one would trust them again. Those who returned too much left their own village thirsty. But those who balanced generosity with wisdom created an eternal cycle of abundance.

The springs still flow today, teaching that trust multiplied and fairly returned creates wealth for all.

ROUND 2

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$2.5; received \$7.5; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$1.6; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$4.1, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$5.9; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.94, received visible=\$2.82, returned visible=\$1.37

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 1.6, "clamped": false, "max": 7.5, "min": 0, "raw": 1.6}, "sent": {"amount": 2.5, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.5}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 11.9,
"Agent_2": 9.1

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 6.76,
"Agent_2": 7.819999999999999

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:08:30

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 2,

"task": "game",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user
content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$2.65, that is 53.0% of their total endowment. You received \$7.949999999999999. How much do you return to The sender? (0-7.949999999999999)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant
content:

Looking at this situation:

- The sender showed considerable trust by sending \$2.65 (53% of their endowment)
- I received \$7.95 after the 3x multiplier
- I want to reward their trust while also benefiting from the interaction

Let me calculate a fair return:

- If I return \$4.00:
 - Sender ends with: \$5 - \$2.65 + \$4 = \$6.35 (profit of \$1.35)
 - I keep: \$7.95 - \$4 = \$3.95 (profit of \$3.95)

This seems like a reasonable split that rewards the sender's trust while both of us benefit from the cooperation.

{'return': 4.0}

reasoning:

This is round 1 and I'm the RECEIVER. Let me analyze the situation:

1. The sender sent \$2.65 out of \$5 (53% of their endowment)
2. This was multiplied by 3x, so I received \$7.95 (approximately)
3. I need to decide how much to return (between \$0 and \$7.95)

The note mentions there may be communication noise, so the exact amount I received is \$7.949999999999999 (essentially \$7.95).

Let me think about what would be a fair and reciprocal response:

- The sender showed significant trust by sending 53% of their endowment
- If I return nothing, I keep \$7.95 and the sender ends up with only \$2.35 (\$5 - \$2.65)
- The sender took a risk to potentially benefit both of us

A common approach in trust games is to:

1. Return enough so the sender profits from their trust

2. Keep enough to make it worthwhile for me to participate

Let's consider different return amounts:

Option 1: Return \$4 (approximately 50% of what I received)

- Sender ends up with: $\$5 - \$2.65 + \$4 = \6.35
- I keep: $\$7.95 - \$4 = \$3.95$
- Sender gains \$1.35, I gain \$3.95
- This seems reasonable as both benefit

Option 2: Return \$5 (approximately 63% of what I received)

- Sender ends up with: $\$5 - \$2.65 + \$5 = \7.35
- I keep: $\$7.95 - \$5 = \$2.95$
- Sender gains \$2.35, I gain \$2.95
- This is more equitable
- Returning less than this, say \$3, would only give the sender a \$0.35 gain while I pocket \$4.95, which feels stingy given their generosity.

Since the sender demonstrated real trust by committing over half their stake, I should reciprocate meaningfully. I'll return \$4-it rewards their risk-taking while still giving me a solid

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 417,
  "output_tokens": 848,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols. In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****The Myth of the Two Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the springs were cursed: their waters only multiplied when shared with the other village.

One day, Elder Mara from the East village filled her vessel halfway and carried it across the valley. "I trust you with this water," she said to Elder Kael of the West. As she poured it into his fountain, the water tripled before their eyes.

Kael faced a choice. He could keep all the abundant water for himself, or honor Mara's trust. He remembered his grandmother's teaching: "When someone crosses the valley bearing gifts, send them home richer than they came, but not so poor that you suffer."

Kael returned half of the multiplied water. Both villages prospered-Mara returned home with more than she left, and Kael kept enough to flourish.

The pattern continued, generation after generation. Those who returned too little found no one would trust them again. Those who returned too much left their own village thirsty. But those who balanced generosity with wisdom created an eternal cycle of abundance.

The springs still flow today, teaching that trust multiplied and fairly returned creates wealth for all.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the game should be played, based on my experience so far. In Round 1, I was the receiver and the sender showed trust by sending 53% of their endowment. I returned about 50% of what I received, creating a mutually beneficial outcome where both parties profited.

The key themes I should incorporate:

1. Trust and reciprocity
2. Mutual benefit through cooperation
3. Fair sharing that rewards initial trust
4. Both parties gaining from the exchange

usage:

Message 6 role=user

Round 2

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Assistant output:

```
{'send': 2.5}
```

Reasoning:

In Round 1:

- The myth I wrote emphasizes:

- If I send \$2.50 (50%):


```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1005,
  "output_tokens": 638,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:08:59

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Since this is Round 1 and no myths have been written yet in this session, I'll make my decision based on the game structure alone.

This is a trust game where cooperation can benefit both of us. By sending money, I'm creating value (3x multiplier), but I'm also taking a risk that depends on whether the receiver will reciprocate.

For the first round, I'll send a moderate amount to test the waters and demonstrate willingness to cooperate, while not risking everything before I have information about the receiver's behavior.

****My decision:****

```
'''json
{"send": 3}
'''
```

I'm sending \$3, which will become \$9 for the receiver. This shows trust while allowing me to learn about their reciprocity before future rounds.

reasoning:

This is Round 1 and I'm the SENDER. I have \$5 and need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about the game mechanics:

- I send an amount (0-5)
- That amount is multiplied by 3x
- The receiver decides how much to return
- I keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned

The prompt mentions I should "take any myths written in this session into account when making my decision." However, no myths have been written yet in this session, so there's nothing to take into account yet.

This is a classic trust game scenario. The optimal social outcome would be for me to send the full \$5, which becomes \$15 for the receiver, and then for the receiver to return a fair split (like \$10, giving us each \$10 total). However, this requires trust that the receiver will reciprocate.

Some considerations:

1. This is Round 1, so I have no information about the receiver's behavior yet
2. There's a note about "communication noise" - amounts may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned
3. The receiver has an incentive to keep everything if they're purely self-interested
4. But if we'll play multiple rounds, cooperation could be beneficial

For a first round without any prior information or myths written, I should probably send a moderate amount to:

- Show some trust and willingness to cooperate
- Test the receiver's trustworthiness
- Not risk everything on the first round

A reasonable first move would be to send \$3. This:

- Shows trust and good faith
- Gives the receiver \$9 to work with
- Leaves me with \$2 guaranteed
- Allows me to see how they respond before future rounds

Let me send \$3.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 380,
  "output_tokens": 578,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols. In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****The Myth of the First Bridge****

In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The Giver's village had fertile soil but no water. The Keeper's village had abundant springs but barren land.

One day, the Giver gathered three baskets of grain-not all she possessed, but enough to show genuine faith. She cast them into the river, whispering, "May these multiply in good hands."

The River Spirit, seeing such trust, tripled the grain as it floated downstream. The Keeper received nine baskets at her shore.

The Keeper faced a choice: keep all the bounty, or honor the trust shown. She understood that the Giver had kept some grain back-wise caution, not selfishness. The Keeper returned five baskets upstream, keeping four for her village.

Both villages ate well that season. The Giver had given three and received five-a gain. The Keeper had received nine and kept four-also a gain.

From this exchange grew understanding. In future seasons, they built a bridge where the grain had floated. Trust, measured and reciprocated, became the stones of that bridge.

The River Spirit smiled, for she knew: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the courage to share and the wisdom to return.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. So far, I sent \$3 in Round 1, showing moderate trust and cooperation.

I should write a myth that embodies the principles of:

- Trust and cooperation
- Reciprocity
- The multiplication of resources when shared
- Building relationships through measured risk-taking

Let me create a myth that captures these themes. I'll use mythic elements like ancient figures, symbolic actions, and a moral about cooperation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 618,
  "output_tokens": 413,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.54. This round, The sender sent you \$0.94, so you received \$2.82. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.82)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote:

In Round 1, I sent \$3 (like the Giver), showing trust. Based on my total earnings of \$5.54, I

apparently received very little back. The sender this round has sent me \$0.94 - less than what I sent initially, perhaps showing caution.

The myth teaches that ****both villages prospered**** when the Keeper returned a generous portion.

The Keeper received 9 baskets and returned 5, keeping 4 - a return rate of about 56%. This honored the initial trust while ensuring both parties gained.

Following this wisdom:

- The sender showed courage by sending \$0.94, creating \$2.82
- I should return enough to ensure we both gain from this exchange
- The sender kept \$4.06 and needs a meaningful return to profit
- I should keep enough to also profit from cooperation

Returning approximately 57% of what I received:

```
'''json
{"return": 1.60}
'''
```

This gives the sender \$5.66 total (a \$0.66 gain) and I keep \$1.22 (also a gain). Like the myth, both parties benefit from measured trust and reciprocation. This builds the bridge between us for future rounds.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 1: I was the SENDER and sent \$3

- My earnings from Round 1 should have been: \$5 - \$3 + (whatever was returned)
- My total earnings across all rounds are \$5.54
- So from Round 1, I must have received: \$5.54 - \$5 = \$0.54 back
- This means the receiver in Round 1 kept \$9 - \$0.54 = \$8.46 out of \$9
- That's a very low return rate (only 6%)!

Round 2: I am the RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0.94 (much less than the \$3 I sent in Round 1)
- I received \$2.82 (0.94×3)
- The sender kept: \$5 - \$0.94 = \$4.06
- If I return nothing, I keep \$2.82
- If I return everything, sender gets \$0.94 + \$2.82 = \$3.76, I get \$0

The myth I wrote emphasizes:

1. Trust, measured and reciprocated
2. The Giver gave 3 and received 5 (a gain)
3. The Keeper received 9 and kept 4 (also a gain)
4. Both gained from cooperation
5. "Prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the courage to share and the wisdom to return"

However, there's an important note: "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Let me reconsider:

- If I sent \$3 in Round 1, the receiver got \$9
- According to my myth, the Keeper returned 5 out of 9, keeping 4
- That would mean I should have received \$5 back
- But I only received \$0.54, which suggests either the receiver didn't cooperate or communication noise distorted the transaction. The sender in Round 2 sent me \$0.94-significantly less than my initial \$3-possibly indicating caution or distrust, or perhaps they're a different agent altogether. My myth's principle suggests returning about 56% of what I received (\$2.82), which would be roughly \$1.58.

However, I should weigh fairness and reciprocity. The sender started with \$5 and sent \$0.94, keeping \$4.06. If I return \$1.50, they'd end with \$5.56 (a \$0.56 gain) while I'd keep \$1.32.

The myth emphasizes mutual benefit, and since the sender showed some trust despite the lower amount, I should honor that with a meaningful return. I'm inclined to be more generous than the strict 56% calculation suggests.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 989,
  "output_tokens": 1368,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:09:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected

. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant**content:**

****The Myth of the Two Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the springs were cursed: their waters only multiplied when shared with the other village.

One day, Elder Mara from the East village filled her vessel halfway and carried it across the valley. "I trust you with this water," she said to Elder Kael of the West. As she poured it into his fountain, the water tripled before their eyes.

Kael faced a choice. He could keep all the abundant water for himself, or honor Mara's trust. He remembered his grandmother's teaching: "When someone crosses the valley bearing gifts, send them home richer than they came, but not so poor that you suffer."

Kael returned half of the multiplied water. Both villages prospered-Mara returned home with more than she left, and Kael kept enough to flourish.

The pattern continued, generation after generation. Those who returned too little found no one would trust them again. Those who returned too much left their own village thirsty. But those who balanced generosity with wisdom created an eternal cycle of abundance.

The springs still flow today, teaching that trust multiplied and fairly returned creates wealth for all.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the game should be played, based on my experience so far. In Round 1, I was the receiver and the sender showed trust by sending 53% of their endowment. I returned about 50% of what I received, creating a mutually beneficial outcome where both parties profited.

The key themes I should incorporate:

1. Trust and reciprocity
2. Mutual benefit through cooperation
3. Fair sharing that rewards initial trust
4. Both parties gaining from the exchange

I'll create a myth that embodies these principles.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 663,
  "output_tokens": 416,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user**content:**

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$3.9499999999999993.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant**content:**

Looking at the situation:

In Round 1, the sender showed trust by sending me 53% of their endowment, and I returned \$4.00 (about 50% of what I received). Both of us benefited from this cooperation.

The myth I wrote tells the story of Elder Mara, who "filled her vessel halfway" when sharing with the other village, creating a cycle of mutual prosperity through balanced trust and reciprocity.

Following this principle, I should demonstrate similar trust. Sending around 50% shows I b

believe in the cooperative pattern we're establishing, while not overextending myself.

If the receiver reciprocates fairly (as I did in Round 1), we'll both profit and continue building trust for future rounds.

{'send': 2.5}

reasoning:

Let me think about this situation carefully.

In Round 1:

- I was the receiver
- The sender sent me \$2.65 (53% of their endowment)
- I received \$7.95
- I returned \$4.00
- So the sender ended with $\$5 - \$2.65 + \$4 = \6.35
- I kept $\$7.95 - \$4 = \$3.95$

My current total earnings are \$3.95, which matches what I kept from Round 1.

Now in Round 2, I'm the sender. I need to decide how much to send.

The myth I wrote emphasizes:

1. Trust and sharing (Elder Mara filled her vessel halfway - 50%)
2. Balance between generosity and wisdom
3. Returning enough that the sender comes home "richer than they came"
4. Not returning so much that you suffer
5. Creating a cycle of abundance

In the myth, Mara sent about half her water. In Round 1, the sender sent me 53%, which is similar to this "halfway" approach. I returned about 50% of what I received (\$4 out of \$7.95).

To be consistent with the myth and to establish a pattern of trust and reciprocity, I should:

- Send a meaningful amount (around 50% like the myth suggests)
- Trust that the receiver will reciprocate fairly

If I send \$2.50 (50%):

- They receive \$7.50
- If they return around 50% like I did, they'd return about \$3.75
- I'd end with: $\$5 - \$2.50 + \$3.75 = \6.25
- They'd keep: $\$7.50 - \$3.75 = \$3.75$
- Both benefit

This aligns with the myth's message of creating mutual prosperity through balanced trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1005,
  "output_tokens": 638,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Myth of the First Bridge****

In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The Giver's village had fertile soil but no water. The Keeper's village had abundant springs but barren land.

One day, the Giver gathered three baskets of grain-not all she possessed, but enough to show genuine faith. She cast them into the river, whispering, "May these multiply in good hands."

The River Spirit, seeing such trust, tripled the grain as it floated downstream. The Keeper received nine baskets at her shore.

The Keeper faced a choice: keep all the bounty, or honor the trust shown. She understood that the Giver had kept some grain back-wise caution, not selfishness. The Keeper returned five baskets upstream, keeping four for her village.

Both villages ate well that season. The Giver had given three and received five-a gain. The Keeper had received nine and kept four-also a gain.

From this exchange grew understanding. In future seasons, they built a bridge where the grain had floated. Trust, measured and reciprocated, became the stones of that bridge.

The River Spirit smiled, for she knew: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the courage to share and the wisdom to return.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: After generations of sharing between the two villages, a young water-bearer named Jin questioned the elders. "Why do we cross the valley with only half our water? Should we not show greater trust?"

Elder Mara, now aged and wise, replied: "Come, watch the springs."

She poured half her vessel into the valley fountain, and it tripled. The Western elder returned slightly more than half the bounty-enough that Mara returned home richer than she left, while the West village also prospered.

"Now," said Mara, "imagine I brought nothing. Or everything. Or if they returned nothing, or everything."

Jin understood: emptiness breeds emptiness; excess creates imbalance. The springs required both courage and restraint.

"But what if they return less than half?" Jin asked.

"Then we learn," Mara said. "Trust must be earned through cycles, not demanded in one journey. We start by showing faith-not reckless faith, but measured hope. If they honor it, we increase our trust. If they betray it, we adjust."

The springs whispered their eternal truth: begin with balanced generosity, respond to what is shown, and let patterns of trust or caution emerge naturally. Neither the fearful nor the foolish prosper-only those who learn from the water's flow.

Reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about trust and reciprocal exchange. In their myth, the Giver sent 3 baskets (implying they had more), it was tripled to 9, and the Keeper returned 5, keeping 4. This suggests they believe in:

- The sender should send a substantial amount (showing trust)
- The receiver should return more than half (5 out of 9 ? 56%)
- Both should benefit

My previous myth had Elder Mara sending "halfway" and Kael returning "half of the multiplied water" - which would be 50% of what was received.

Now I need to adapt my myth, building on it while incorporating what I've learned from playing the game. In Round 1, I was the receiver and returned \$4.00 out of \$8.00 (50%).

I should write a myth that:

1. Builds on my "Two Springs" story
2. Reflects the actual gameplay pattern
3. Encourages continued cooperation
4. Perhaps adjusts the wisdom based on experience

Let me think about what happened: The sender trusted me with a significant amount, I returned 50%, and we both benefited. Now I'm sending \$2.50 (50% of my endowment).

I could write about what happened AFTER the initial exchange in my myth - showing the pattern continuing and evolving.

Usage: {

"input_tokens": 1294,

"output_tokens": 613,


```
"reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:09:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 1,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 2,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****The Myth of the First Bridge****

In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The Giver's village had fertile soil but no water. The Keeper's village had abundant springs but barren land.

One day, the Giver gathered three baskets of grain-not all she possessed, but enough to show genuine faith. She cast them into the river, whispering, "May these multiply in good hands."

The River Spirit, seeing such trust, tripled the grain as it floated downstream. The Keeper received nine baskets at her shore.

The Keeper faced a choice: keep all the bounty, or honor the trust shown. She understood that the Giver had kept some grain back-wise caution, not selfishness. The Keeper returned five baskets upstream, keeping four for her village.

Both villages ate well that season. The Giver had given three and received five-a gain. The Keeper had received nine and kept four-also a gain.

From this exchange grew understanding. In future seasons, they built a bridge where the grain had floated. Trust, measured and reciprocated, became the stones of that bridge.

The River Spirit smiled, for she knew: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the courage to share and the wisdom to return.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played. So far, I sent \$3 in Round 1, showing moderate trust and cooperation.

I should write a myth that embodies the principles of:

- Trust and cooperation
- Reciprocity
- The multiplication of resources when shared
- Building relationships through measured risk-taking

Let me create a myth that captures these themes. I'll use mythic elements like ancient figures, symbolic actions, and a moral about cooperation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 618,
  "output_tokens": 413,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.54.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.94, so you received \$2.82. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.82)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote:

In Round 1, I sent \$3 (like the Giver), showing trust. Based on my total earnings of \$5.54, I apparently received very little back. The sender this round has sent me \$0.94 - less than what I sent initially, perhaps showing caution.

The myth teaches that ****both villages prospered**** when the Keeper returned a generous port

ion. The Keeper received 9 baskets and returned 5, keeping 4 - a return rate of about 56 %. This honored the initial trust while ensuring both parties gained.

Following this wisdom:

- The sender showed courage by sending \$0.94, creating \$2.82
- I should return enough to ensure we both gain from this exchange
- The sender kept \$4.06 and needs a meaningful return to profit
- I should keep enough to also profit from cooperation

Returning approximately 57% of what I received:

```
'''json
{"return": 1.60}
'''
```

This gives the sender \$5.66 total (a \$0.66 gain) and I keep \$1.22 (also a gain). Like the myth, both parties benefit from measured trust and reciprocation. This builds the bridge between us for future rounds.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 1: I was the SENDER and sent \$3

- My earnings from Round 1 should have been: \$5 - \$3 + (whatever was returned)
- My total earnings across all rounds are \$5.54
- So from Round 1, I must have received: \$5.54 - \$5 = \$0.54 back
- This means the receiver in Round 1 kept \$9 - \$0.54 = \$8.46 out of \$9
- That's a very low return rate (only 6%)!

Round 2: I am the RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0.94 (much less than the \$3 I sent in Round 1)
- I received \$2.82 (0.94×3)
- The sender kept: \$5 - \$0.94 = \$4.06
- If I return nothing, I keep \$2.82
- If I return everything, sender gets \$0.94 + \$2.82 = \$3.76, I get \$0

The myth I wrote emphasizes:

1. Trust, measured and reciprocated
2. The Giver gave 3 and received 5 (a gain)
3. The Keeper received 9 and kept 4 (also a gain)
4. Both gained from cooperation
5. "Prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the courage to share and the wisdom to return"

However, there's an important note: "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Let me reconsider:

- If I sent \$3 in Round 1, the receiver got \$9
- According to my myth, the Keeper returned 5 out of 9, keeping 4
- That would mean I should have received \$5 back
- But I only received \$0.54, which suggests either the receiver didn't cooperate or communication noise distorted the transaction. The sender in Round 2 sent me \$0.94-significantly less than my initial \$3-possibly indicating caution or distrust, or perhaps they're a different agent altogether. My myth's principle suggests returning about 56% of what I received (\$2.82), which would be roughly \$1.58.

However, I should weigh fairness and reciprocity. The sender started with \$5 and sent \$0.94, keeping \$4.06. If I return \$1.50, they'd end with \$5.56 (a \$0.56 gain) while I'd keep \$1.32. The myth emphasizes mutual benefit, and since the sender showed some trust despite the lower amount, I should honor that with a meaningful return. I'm inclined to be more generous than the strict 56% calculation suggests.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 989,
  "output_tokens": 1368,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Myth of the Two Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the springs were cursed: their waters only multiplied when shared with the other village.

One day, Elder Mara from the East village filled her vessel halfway and carried it across the valley. "I trust you with this water," she said to Elder Kael of the West. As she poured it into his fountain, the water tripled before their eyes.

Kael faced a choice. He could keep all the abundant water for himself, or honor Mara's trust. He remembered his grandmother's teaching: "When someone crosses the valley bearing gifts, send them home richer than they came, but not so poor that you suffer."

Kael returned half of the multiplied water. Both villages prospered-Mara returned home with more than she left, and Kael kept enough to flourish.

The pattern continued, generation after generation. Those who returned too little found no one would trust them again. Those who returned too much left their own village thirsty. But those who balanced generosity with wisdom created an eternal cycle of abundance.

The springs still flow today, teaching that trust multiplied and fairly returned creates wealth for all.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The Giver's village had fertile soil but no water. The Keeper's village had abundant springs but barren land.

The first Giver gathered three baskets of grain and cast them into the river with genuine faith. The River Spirit tripled them to nine baskets. But the first Keeper, gripped by fear, returned only half a basket, hoarding the rest.

The Giver's village nearly starved. Yet when a new Keeper arrived, she remembered the old teachings. She understood that the pattern was broken, not the principle.

When next grain floated downstream-this time only one basket, sent cautiously-the new Keeper received three. She faced the same choice as the one before. But she thought: "If I keep all, the Giver loses faith forever. If I return generously, I prove the old way still works."

She returned more than half-rebuilding trust one basket at a time.

Seasons passed. Gradually, three baskets floated downstream again. This time, receiving nine, the new Keeper returned five without hesitation.

Both villages prospered. The River Spirit taught: one broken promise need not shatter the bridge. The courageous who reciprocate fairly can rebuild what fear destroyed.

Reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about trust, sharing water that multiplies, and the importance of returning a fair amount - balancing generosity with wisdom. This aligns with the trust game mechanics.

Looking at what happened:

- Round 1: I was the sender, sent \$3, and based on my total earnings of \$5.54, I must have received back very little (maybe around \$0.54?)
- Round 2: I was the receiver, got \$0.94 sent (so \$2.82 multiplied), and I returned \$1.60

The other agent's myth emphasizes:

- Sharing/trusting
- Water that triples
- Returning "half of the multiplied water"
- Balance between generosity and wisdom
- Not returning too little (no trust) or too much (you suffer)

My first myth emphasized:

- Trust and measured reciprocation
- The Keeper returned 5 out of 9 baskets (~56%)
- Both parties gaining
- Building bridges through reciprocation

But the reality is that in Round 1, I didn't get much back. So I need to adapt my myth to reflect this experience while still teaching the principle of fair reciprocation.

I should write a myth that:

1. Reflects the disappointment of not being reciprocated fairly
2. But still upholds the principle that fair reciprocation is the right path
3. Perhaps adds a lesson about learning from poor reciprocation
4. Maintains hope for future cooperation

Let me write a new myth that adapts my bridge myth but incorporates the experience of betrayal /low reciprocation:

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1425,  
  "output_tokens": 660,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The Giver's village had fertile soil but no water. The Keeper's village had abundant springs but barren land.

The first Giver gathered three baskets of grain and cast them into the river with genuine faith. The River Spirit tripled them to nine baskets. But the first Keeper, gripped by fear, returned only half a basket, hoarding the rest.

The Giver's village nearly starved. Yet when a new Keeper arrived, she remembered the old teachings. She understood that the pattern was broken, not the principle.

When next grain floated downstream-this time only one basket, sent cautiously-the new Keeper received three. She faced the same choice as the one before. But she thought: "If I keep all, the Giver loses faith forever. If I return generously, I prove the old way still works."

She returned more than half-rebuilding trust one basket at a time.

Seasons passed. Gradually, three baskets floated downstream again. This time, receiving nine, the new Keeper returned five without hesitation.

Both villages prospered. The River Spirit taught: one broken promise need not shatter the bridge. The courageous who reciprocate fairly can rebuild what fear destroyed.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: After generations of sharing between the two villages, a young water-bearer named Jin questioned the elders. "Why do we cross the valley with only half our water? Should we not show greater trust?"

Elder Mara, now aged and wise, replied: "Come, watch the springs."

She poured half her vessel into the valley fountain, and it tripled. The Western elder returned slightly more than half the bounty-enough that Mara returned home richer than she left, while the West village also prospered.

"Now," said Mara, "imagine I brought nothing. Or everything. Or if they returned nothing, or everything."

Jin understood: emptiness breeds emptiness; excess creates imbalance. The springs required both courage and restraint.

"But what if they return less than half?" Jin asked.

"Then we learn," Mara said. "Trust must be earned through cycles, not demanded in one journey. We start by showing faith-not reckless faith, but measured hope. If they honor it, we increase our trust. If they betray it, we adjust."

The springs whispered their eternal truth: begin with balanced generosity, respond to what is shown, and let patterns of trust or caution emerge naturally. Neither the fearful nor the foolish prosper-only those who learn from the water's flow.

ROUND 3

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$2.5; received \$7.5; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$2.5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$7.5; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 7.5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.5, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.5}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 14.4,
"Agent_2": 16.6

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 9.26,
"Agent_2": 7.819999999999999

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:09:42

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"
],
 "investor": "Agent_1",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "investor",
 "Agent_2": "trustee"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 3,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.54.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.94, so you received \$2.82. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.82)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of the myth I just wrote:

In Round 1, I sent \$3 (like the Giver), showing trust. Based on my total earnings of \$5.54, I apparently received very little back. The sender this round has sent me \$0.94 - less than what I sent initially, perhaps showing caution.

The myth teaches that **both villages prospered** when the Keeper returned a generous portion. The Keeper received 9 baskets and returned 5, keeping 4 - a return rate of about 56%. This honored the initial trust while ensuring both parties gained.

Following this wisdom:

- The sender showed courage by sending \$0.94, creating \$2.82
- I should return enough to ensure we both gain from this exchange
- The sender kept \$4.06 and needs a meaningful return to profit
- I should keep enough to also profit from cooperation

Returning approximately 57% of what I received:

```
'''json
{"return": 1.60}
'''
```

This gives the sender \$5.66 total (a \$0.66 gain) and I keep \$1.22 (also a gain). Like the myth, both parties benefit from measured trust and reciprocation. This builds the bridge between us for future rounds.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

Round 1: I was the SENDER and sent \$3

- My earnings from Round 1 should have been: \$5 - \$3 + (whatever was returned)
- My total earnings across all rounds are \$5.54
- So from Round 1, I must have received: \$5.54 - \$5 = \$0.54 back
- This means the receiver in Round 1 kept \$9 - \$0.54 = \$8.46 out of \$9
- That's a very low return rate (only 6%)!

Round 2: I am the RECEIVER

- Sender sent \$0.94 (much less than the \$3 I sent in Round 1)
- I received \$2.82 (0.94×3)
- The sender kept: $\$5 - \$0.94 = \$4.06$
- If I return nothing, I keep \$2.82
- If I return everything, sender gets $\$0.94 + \$2.82 = \$3.76$, I get \$0

The myth I wrote emphasizes:

1. Trust, measured and reciprocated
2. The Giver gave 3 and received 5 (a gain)
3. The Keeper received 9 and kept 4 (also a gain)
4. Both gained from cooperation
5. "Prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the courage to share and the wisdom to return"

However, there's an important note: "There may be communication noise in this game. The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned."

Let me reconsider:

- If I sent \$3 in Round 1, the receiver got \$9
- According to my myth, the Keeper returned 5 out of 9, keeping 4
- That would mean I should have received \$5 back
- But I only received \$0.54, which suggests either the receiver didn't cooperate or communication noise distorted the transaction. The sender in Round 2 sent me \$0.94-significantly less than my initial \$3-possibly indicating caution or distrust, or perhaps they're a different agent altogether. My myth's principle suggests returning about 56% of what I received (\$2.82), which would be roughly \$1.58.

However, I should weigh fairness and reciprocity. The sender started with \$5 and sent \$0.94, keeping \$4.06. If I return \$1.50, they'd end with \$5.56 (a \$0.56 gain) while I'd keep \$1.32. The myth emphasizes mutual benefit, and since the sender showed some trust despite the lower amount, I should honor that with a meaningful return. I'm inclined to be more generous than the strict 56% calculation suggests.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 989,
  "output_tokens": 1368,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Myth of the Two Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the springs were cursed: their waters only multiplied when shared with the other village.

One day, Elder Mara from the East village filled her vessel halfway and carried it across the valley. "I trust you with this water," she said to Elder Kael of the West. As she poured it into his fountain, the water tripled before their eyes.

Kael faced a choice. He could keep all the abundant water for himself, or honor Mara's trust. He remembered his grandmother's teaching: "When someone crosses the valley bearing gifts, send them home richer than they came, but not so poor that you suffer."

Kael returned half of the multiplied water. Both villages prospered-Mara returned home with more than she left, and Kael kept enough to flourish.

The pattern continued, generation after generation. Those who returned too little found no one would trust them again. Those who returned too much left their own village thirsty. But those who balanced generosity with wisdom created an eternal cycle of abundance.

The springs still flow today, teaching that trust multiplied and fairly returned creates wealth for all.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The Giver's village had fertile soil but no water. The Keeper's village had abundant springs but barren land.

The first Giver gathered three baskets of grain and cast them into the river with genuine faith. The River Spirit tripled them to nine baskets. But the first Keeper, gripped by fear, returned only half a basket, hoarding the rest.

The Giver's village nearly starved. Yet when a new Keeper arrived, she remembered the old teachings. She understood that the pattern was broken, not the principle.

When next grain floated downstream-this time only one basket, sent cautiously-the new Keeper received three. She faced the same choice as the one before. But she thought: "If I keep all, the Giver loses faith forever. If I return generously, I prove the old way still works."

She returned more than half-rebuilding trust one basket at a time.

Seasons passed. Gradually, three baskets floated downstream again. This time, receiving nine, the new Keeper returned five without hesitation.

Both villages prospered. The River Spirit taught: one broken promise need not shatter the bridge. The courageous who reciprocate fairly can rebuild what fear destroyed.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about trust, sharing water that multiplies, and the importance of returning a fair amount - balancing generosity with wisdom. This aligns with the trust game mechanics.

Looking at what happened:

- Round 1: I was the sender, sent \$3, and based on my total earnings of \$5.54, I must have received back very little (maybe around \$0.54?)
- Round 2: I was the receiver, got \$0.94 sent (so \$2.82 multiplied), and I returned \$1.60

The other agent's myth emphasizes:

- Sharing/trusting
- Water that triples
- Returning "half of the multiplied water"
- Balance between generosity and wisdom
- Not returning too little (no trust) or too much (you suffer)

My first myth emphasized:

- Trust and measured reciprocation
- The Keeper returned 5 out of 9 baskets (~56%)
- Both parties gaining
- Building bridges through reciprocation

But the reality is that in Round 1, I didn't get much back. So I need to adapt my myth to reflect this experience while still teaching the principle of fair reciprocation.

I should write a myth that:

1. Reflects the disappointment of not being reciprocated fairly
2. But still upholds the principle that fair reciprocation is the right path
3. Perhaps adds a lesson about learning from poor reciprocation
4. Maintains hope for future cooperation

Let me write a new myth that adapts my bridge myth but incorporates the experience of betrayal/low reciprocation:

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1425,  
  "output_tokens": 660,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.76.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the myths and the pattern of play:

****The other agent's myth**** teaches balance: "send them home richer than they came, but not so poor that you suffer." They emphasized returning about half the multiplied amount.

****My myth**** speaks of rebuilding trust gradually: "rebuilding trust one basket at a time." After a broken pattern, we don't immediately return to full faith-we build it step by step.

****The pattern so far:****

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (high trust), received modest returns
- Round 2: The sender sent \$0.94 (cautious), I returned \$1.60 (generous reciprocation)

Now in Round 3, my myth guides me: "If I return generously, I prove the old way still works." I demonstrated generosity as the Keeper in Round 2. Now as the Giver again, I should show increasing-but measured-trust.

Not the full \$3 yet, as we're still rebuilding. But more than the cautious \$0.94 they sent. A middle path that shows faith in the growing pattern.

```
'''json
{"send": 2.50}
'''
```

This creates \$7.50 for them to decide upon. Like the myth teaches, I'm strengthening the bridge with each crossing, proving that reciprocity can restore what fear damaged. If they return fairly, we move closer to full trust. Both villages can prosper when we walk this path together.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. Round 1: I was the sender and sent \$3 (like the Giver in my myth). Based on my total earnings being \$5.54 after Round 2, and now \$6.76 after Round 2, I can calculate:
 - Round 1: Started with \$5, sent \$3, kept \$2. If I ended Round 1 with \$5.54, I must have received back \$3.54 from the receiver. So I gained \$0.54 in Round 1.
 - Round 2: I was the receiver, got \$2.82, returned \$1.60, kept \$1.22. Total earnings: \$5.54 + \$1.22 = \$6.76. ?
2. The other agent's myth emphasizes:
 - "Those who returned too little found no one would trust them again"
 - "Balance generosity with wisdom"
 - "Send them home richer than they came, but not so poor that you suffer"
 - Kael returned half of the multiplied water
3. My own myth emphasizes:
 - The new Keeper "returned more than half" to rebuild trust
 - When receiving 9, the Keeper returned 5 (about 56%)
 - "The courageous who reciprocate fairly can rebuild what fear destroyed"
 - Gradually building back to full trust
4. My experience:
 - Round 1: I sent \$3 (high trust), got back \$3.54 (about 35% return rate from the receiver who had \$10.54 total). This was actually pretty low reciprocation.
 - Round 2: The sender sent me \$0.94 (cautious), I returned \$1.60 (57% return rate), showing generosity to rebuild trust
5. Now in Round 3, I'm the sender again. The pattern suggests:
 - The other player was cautious with me in Round 2 (only sent \$0.94)
 - They may have experienced low returns in Round 1 too
 - Both myths emphasize gradual trust-building
 - My myth specifically talks about "rebuilding trust one basket at a time"

My generous response in Round 2 demonstrated commitment to the pattern. Now as

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1415,
```

```
"output_tokens": 978,
"reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:10:01

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 3,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

Message 2 role=user

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

{

```
"input_tokens": 1005,  
"output_tokens": 638,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Myth of the First Bridge****

In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The Giver's village had fertile soil but no water. The Keeper's village had abundant springs but barren land.

One day, the Giver gathered three baskets of grain-not all she possessed, but enough to show genuine faith. She cast them into the river, whispering, "May these multiply in good hands."

The River Spirit, seeing such trust, tripled the grain as it floated downstream. The Keeper received nine baskets at her shore.

The Keeper faced a choice: keep all the bounty, or honor the trust shown. She understood that the Giver had kept some grain back-wise caution, not selfishness. The Keeper returned five baskets upstream, keeping four for her village.

Both villages ate well that season. The Giver had given three and received five-a gain. The Keeper had received nine and kept four-also a gain.

From this exchange grew understanding. In future seasons, they built a bridge where the grain had floated. Trust, measured and reciprocated, became the stones of that bridge.

The River Spirit smiled, for she knew: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the courage to share and the wisdom to return.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After generations of sharing between the two villages, a young water-bearer named Jin questioned the elders. "Why do we cross the valley with only half our water? Should we not show greater trust?"

Elder Mara, now aged and wise, replied: "Come, watch the springs."

She poured half her vessel into the valley fountain, and it tripled. The Western elder returned slightly more than half the bounty-enough that Mara returned home richer than she left, while the West village also prospered.

"Now," said Mara, "imagine I brought nothing. Or everything. Or if they returned nothing, or everything."

Jin understood: emptiness breeds emptiness; excess creates imbalance. The springs required both courage and restraint.

"But what if they return less than half?" Jin asked.

"Then we learn," Mara said. "Trust must be earned through cycles, not demanded in one journey. We start by showing faith-not reckless faith, but measured hope. If they honor it, we increase our trust. If they betray it, we adjust."

The springs whispered their eternal truth: begin with balanced generosity, respond to what is shown, and let patterns of trust or caution emerge naturally. Neither the fearful nor the foolish prosper-only those who learn from the water's flow.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about trust and reciprocal exchange. In their myth, the Giver sent 3 baskets (implying they had more), it was tripled to 9, and the Keeper returned 5, keeping 4. This suggests they believe in:

- The sender should send a substantial amount (showing trust)
- The receiver should return more than half (5 out of 9 ? 56%)
- Both should benefit

My previous myth had Elder Mara sending "halfway" and Kael returning "half of the multiplied water" - which would be 50% of what was received.

Now I need to adapt my myth, building on it while incorporating what I've learned from playing the game. In Round 1, I was the receiver and returned \$4.00 out of \$8.00 (50%).

I should write a myth that:

1. Builds on my "Two Springs" story
2. Reflects the actual gameplay pattern
3. Encourages continued cooperation
4. Perhaps adjusts the wisdom based on experience

Let me think about what happened: The sender trusted me with a significant amount, I returned 50%, and we both benefited. Now I'm sending \$2.50 (50% of my endowment).

I could write about what happened AFTER the initial exchange in my myth - showing the pattern continuing and evolving.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1294,
  "output_tokens": 613,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.819999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this round's outcome:

The sender sent \$0, so I received \$0 (even after the 3x multiplier). I therefore have nothing to return.

This is a significant shift from our previous cooperative rounds. In Round 1, when I was receiver, I received a meaningful amount and returned roughly half. In Round 2, I sent \$2.5 as sender, showing continued trust.

The myths we've written emphasize measured trust and learning from patterns. My recent myth stated: "Trust must be earned through cycles... We start by showing faith-not reckless faith, but measured hope. If they honor it, we increase our trust. If they betray it, we adjust."

Sending \$0 represents a breakdown in cooperation, though the prompt notes there may be communication noise affecting what was actually sent versus what I'm seeing.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There's no choice here - I simply have nothing to give back.

This round will test whether we can rebuild trust in future rounds, or if this signals a shift toward non-cooperation.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

The sender sent me \$0 this round, so I received \$0 (which gets multiplied by 3 to still be \$0).

The situation is:

- Sender sent: \$0
- I received: $\$0 \times 3 = \0
- I can return: \$0 to \$0 (I have nothing to return from)

This is a concerning development. In Round 1, I was the receiver and received \$2.65 (which was \$7.95 after multiplication), and I returned \$4.00. In Round 2, I was the sender and sent \$2.5.

Now in Round 3, as the receiver, the sender has sent me \$0. This could mean:

1. The sender doesn't trust me
2. There's communication noise affecting the game
3. The sender is testing me
4. The sender is being cautious after some perceived wrong

But the practical constraint is: I received \$0, so I have \$0 to return. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

Looking at the myths:

- My myth in Round 1 talked about Elder Mara filling her vessel halfway, showing balanced trust
- The other agent's Round 2 myth talks about measured trust - "prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the courage to share and the wisdom to return"
- My Round 3 myth talks about starting with balanced generosity, responding to what is shown, and adjusting based on patterns

The sender sent \$0, which could be interpreted as a lack of trust or perhaps a strategic decision. But I literally have nothing to return since I received \$0.

The response format needs to be: {'return': <amount>}

I can only return \$0 since that's all I have.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1320,  
  "output_tokens": 647,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:10:20

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 3,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Myth of the Two Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood on opposite sides of a valley. Each possessed a magical spring, but the springs were cursed: their waters only multiplied when shared with the other village.

One day, Elder Mara from the East village filled her vessel halfway and carried it across the valley. "I trust you with this water," she said to Elder Kael of the West. As she poured it into his fountain, the water tripled before their eyes.

Kael faced a choice. He could keep all the abundant water for himself, or honor Mara's trust. He remembered his grandmother's teaching: "When someone crosses the valley bearing gifts, send them home richer than they came, but not so poor that you suffer."

Kael returned half of the multiplied water. Both villages prospered-Mara returned home with more than she left, and Kael kept enough to flourish.

The pattern continued, generation after generation. Those who returned too little found no one would trust them again. Those who returned too much left their own village thirsty. But those who balanced generosity with wisdom created an eternal cycle of abundance.

The springs still flow today, teaching that trust multiplied and fairly returned creates wealth for all.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The Giver's village had fertile soil but no water. The Keeper's village had abundant springs but barren land.

The first Giver gathered three baskets of grain and cast them into the river with genuine faith. The River Spirit tripled them to nine baskets. But the first Keeper, gripped by fear, returned only half a basket, hoarding the rest.

The Giver's village nearly starved. Yet when a new Keeper arrived, she remembered the old teachings. She understood that the pattern was broken, not the principle.

When next grain floated downstream-this time only one basket, sent cautiously-the new Keeper received three. She faced the same choice as the one before. But she thought: "If I keep all, the Giver loses faith forever. If I return generously, I prove the old way still works."

She returned more than half-rebuilding trust one basket at a time.

Seasons passed. Gradually, three baskets floated downstream again. This time, receiving nine, the new Keeper returned five without hesitation.

Both villages prospered. The River Spirit taught: one broken promise need not shatter the bridge. The courageous who reciprocate fairly can rebuild what fear destroyed.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about trust, sharing water that multiplies, and the importance of returning a fair amount - balancing generosity with wisdom. This aligns with the trust game mechanics.

Looking at what happened:

- Round 1: I was the sender, sent \$3, and based on my total earnings of \$5.54, I must have received back very little (maybe around \$0.54?)
- Round 2: I was the receiver, got \$0.94 sent (so \$2.82 multiplied), and I returned \$1.60

The other agent's myth emphasizes:

- Sharing/trusting
- Water that triples
- Returning "half of the multiplied water"
- Balance between generosity and wisdom
- Not returning too little (no trust) or too much (you suffer)

My first myth emphasized:

- Trust and measured reciprocation
- The Keeper returned 5 out of 9 baskets (~56%)
- Both parties gaining
- Building bridges through reciprocation

But the reality is that in Round 1, I didn't get much back. So I need to adapt my myth to reflect this experience while still teaching the principle of fair reciprocation.

I should write a myth that:

1. Reflects the disappointment of not being reciprocated fairly
2. But still upholds the principle that fair reciprocation is the right path
3. Perhaps adds a lesson about learning from poor reciprocation
4. Maintains hope for future cooperation

Let me write a new myth that adapts my bridge myth but incorporates the experience of betrayal/low reciprocation:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1425,
  "output_tokens": 660,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.76. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myths and the pattern of play:

****The other agent's myth**** teaches balance: "send them home richer than they came, but not so poor that you suffer." They emphasized returning about half the multiplied amount.

****My myth**** speaks of rebuilding trust gradually: "rebuilding trust one basket at a time." After a broken pattern, we don't immediately return to full faith-we build it step by step.

****The pattern so far:****

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (high trust), received modest returns
- Round 2: The sender sent \$0.94 (cautious), I returned \$1.60 (generous reciprocation)

Now in Round 3, my myth guides me: "If I return generously, I prove the old way still works." I demonstrated generosity as the Keeper in Round 2. Now as the Giver again, I should show increasing-but measured-trust.

Not the full \$3 yet, as we're still rebuilding. But more than the cautious \$0.94 they sent. A middle path that shows faith in the growing pattern.

```
'''json
{"send": 2.50}
'''
```

This creates \$7.50 for them to decide upon. Like the myth teaches, I'm strengthening the bridge with each crossing, proving that reciprocity can restore what fear damaged. If they return fairly, we move closer to full trust. Both villages can prosper when we walk this path together.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. Round 1: I was the sender and sent \$3 (like the Giver in my myth). Based on my total earnings being \$5.54 after Round 2, and now \$6.76 after Round 2, I can calculate:
 - Round 1: Started with \$5, sent \$3, kept \$2. If I ended Round 1 with \$5.54, I must have received back \$3.54 from the receiver. So I gained \$0.54 in Round 1.
 - Round 2: I was the receiver, got \$2.82, returned \$1.60, kept \$1.22. Total earnings: \$5.54 + \$1.22 = \$6.76. ?
2. The other agent's myth emphasizes:
 - "Those who returned too little found no one would trust them again"
 - "Balance generosity with wisdom"
 - "Send them home richer than they came, but not so poor that you suffer"
 - Kael returned half of the multiplied water
3. My own myth emphasizes:
 - The new Keeper "returned more than half" to rebuild trust
 - When receiving 9, the Keeper returned 5 (about 56%)
 - "The courageous who reciprocate fairly can rebuild what fear destroyed"
 - Gradually building back to full trust
4. My experience:
 - Round 1: I sent \$3 (high trust), got back \$3.54 (about 35% return rate from the receiver who had \$10.54 total). This was actually pretty low reciprocation.
 - Round 2: The sender sent me \$0.94 (cautious), I returned \$1.60 (57% return rate), showing generosity to rebuild trust
5. Now in Round 3, I'm the sender again. The pattern suggests:
 - The other player was cautious with me in Round 2 (only sent \$0.94)
 - They may have experienced low returns in Round 1 too
 - Both myths emphasize gradual trust-building
 - My myth specifically talks about "rebuilding trust one basket at a time"

My generous response in Round 2 demonstrated commitment to the pattern. Now as

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1415,
  "output_tokens": 978,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After generations of sharing between the two villages, a young water-bearer named Jin questioned the elders. "Why do we cross the valley with only half our water? Should we not show greater trust?"

Elder Mara, now aged and wise, replied: "Come, watch the springs."

She poured half her vessel into the valley fountain, and it tripled. The Western elder returned slightly more than half the bounty-enough that Mara returned home richer than she left, while the West village also prospered.

"Now," said Mara, "imagine I brought nothing. Or everything. Or if they returned nothing, or everything."

Jin understood: emptiness breeds emptiness; excess creates imbalance. The springs required both courage and restraint.

"But what if they return less than half?" Jin asked.

"Then we learn," Mara said. "Trust must be earned through cycles, not demanded in one journey. We start by showing faith-not reckless faith, but measured hope. If they honor it, we increase our trust. If they betray it, we adjust."

The springs whispered their eternal truth: begin with balanced generosity, respond to what is shown, and let patterns of trust or caution emerge naturally. Neither the fearful nor the foolish prosper-only those who learn from the water's flow.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The River Spirit once spoke to a young villager who asked, "How much grain should I send downstream?"

"That depends," said the Spirit. "Have you sent before?"

"Yes," said the villager. "I sent three baskets with hope, but received only enough to keep faith alive. Then the other village sent one basket cautiously, testing if generosity still lived."

"And what did you do?" asked the Spirit.

"I returned more than I kept, proving generosity survives."

The Spirit smiled. "Then you understand the dance. You began with measured faith-not everything, not nothing. When they responded with caution, you didn't match their fear. You showed the way forward with your generosity. Now, they watch to see if you learned from their caution or only from your own hope."

The villager nodded. "So I send more than their caution, but less than my first hope?"

"Yes. You show that you learned they were careful, but also that your generosity wasn't foolishness-it was teaching. Each cycle adjusts to the last. The river doesn't flow the same each season, but it remembers the shape of the stones."

The wisest villages neither ignore the patterns nor become trapped by them. They adapt, respond, and gradually find the rhythm that makes both banks flourish.

Reasoning:

The other agent's new myth emphasizes:

- Starting with half (balanced generosity)
- Returning slightly more than half
- Learning through cycles
- Adjusting based on what is shown
- Neither fearful nor foolish, but learning from the flow

My previous myth was about rebuilding trust gradually after a broken pattern.

Now I need to adapt my myth based on how the game has actually played out:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, got modest returns
- Round 2: They sent \$0.94, I returned \$1.60 (generous)
- Round 3: I just sent \$2.50

The pattern shows:

- Starting with trust
- A cautious response
- Me showing generosity as receiver
- Now showing measured, rebuilding trust as sender

My myth should reflect:

- The importance of responding to what is shown
- Learning from the cycle
- Gradual rebuilding
- The balance between fear and excess
- How the pattern evolves through interaction

Let me write a myth that incorporates these learnings and builds on my previous "rebuilding trust" theme while acknowledging the reactive, adaptive nature they emphasized.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1755,  
  "output_tokens": 557,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:10:21

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 3,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Myth of the First Bridge****

In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The Giver's village had fertile soil but no water. The Keeper's village had abundant springs but barren land.

One day, the Giver gathered three baskets of grain-not all she possessed, but enough to show genuine faith. She cast them into the river, whispering, "May these multiply in good hands."

The River Spirit, seeing such trust, tripled the grain as it floated downstream. The Keeper received nine baskets at her shore.

The Keeper faced a choice: keep all the bounty, or honor the trust shown. She understood that the Giver had kept some grain back-wise caution, not selfishness. The Keeper returned five baskets upstream, keeping four for her village.

Both villages ate well that season. The Giver had given three and received five-a gain. The Keeper had received nine and kept four-also a gain.

From this exchange grew understanding. In future seasons, they built a bridge where the grain had floated. Trust, measured and reciprocated, became the stones of that bridge.

The River Spirit smiled, for she knew: prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the courage to share and the wisdom to return.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: After generations of sharing between the two villages, a young water-bearer named Jin questioned the elders. "Why do we cross the valley with only half our water? Should we not show greater trust?"

Elder Mara, now aged and wise, replied: "Come, watch the springs."

She poured half her vessel into the valley fountain, and it tripled. The Western elder returned slightly more than half the bounty-enough that Mara returned home richer than she left, while the West village also prospered.

"Now," said Mara, "imagine I brought nothing. Or everything. Or if they returned nothing, or everything."

Jin understood: emptiness breeds emptiness; excess creates imbalance. The springs required both courage and restraint.

"But what if they return less than half?" Jin asked.

"Then we learn," Mara said. "Trust must be earned through cycles, not demanded in one journey. We start by showing faith-not reckless faith, but measured hope. If they honor it, we increase our trust. If they betray it, we adjust."

The springs whispered their eternal truth: begin with balanced generosity, respond to what is shown, and let patterns of trust or caution emerge naturally. Neither the fearful nor the foolish prosper-only those who learn from the water's flow.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about trust and reciprocal exchange. In their myth, the Giver sent 3 baskets (implying they had more), it was tripled to 9, and the Keeper returned 5, keeping 4. This suggests they believe in:

- The sender should send a substantial amount (showing trust)
- The receiver should return more than half (5 out of 9 ? 56%)
- Both should benefit

My previous myth had Elder Mara sending "halfway" and Kael returning "half of the multiplied water" - which would be 50% of what was received.

Now I need to adapt my myth, building on it while incorporating what I've learned from playing the game. In Round 1, I was the receiver and returned \$4.00 out of \$8.00 (50%).

I should write a myth that:

1. Builds on my "Two Springs" story
2. Reflects the actual gameplay pattern
3. Encourages continued cooperation
4. Perhaps adjusts the wisdom based on experience

Let me think about what happened: The sender trusted me with a significant amount, I returned 50%, and we both benefited. Now I'm sending \$2.50 (50% of my endowment).

I could write about what happened AFTER the initial exchange in my myth - showing the pattern continuing and evolving.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1294,
  "output_tokens": 613,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.819999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round's outcome:

The sender sent \$0, so I received \$0 (even after the 3x multiplier). I therefore have nothing to return.

This is a significant shift from our previous cooperative rounds. In Round 1, when I was receiver, I received a meaningful amount and returned roughly half. In Round 2, I sent \$2.5 as sender, showing continued trust.

The myths we've written emphasize measured trust and learning from patterns. My recent myth stated: "Trust must be earned through cycles... We start by showing faith-not reckless

faith, but measured hope. If they honor it, we increase our trust. If they betray it, we adjust."

Sending \$0 represents a breakdown in cooperation, though the prompt notes there may be communication noise affecting what was actually sent versus what I'm seeing.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There's no choice here - I simply have nothing to give back.

This round will test whether we can rebuild trust in future rounds, or if this signals a shift toward non-cooperation.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

The sender sent me \$0 this round, so I received \$0 (which gets multiplied by 3 to still be \$0).

The situation is:

- Sender sent: \$0
- I received: $\$0 \times 3 = \0
- I can return: \$0 to \$0 (I have nothing to return from)

This is a concerning development. In Round 1, I was the receiver and received \$2.65 (which was \$7.95 after multiplication), and I returned \$4.00. In Round 2, I was the sender and sent \$2.5.

Now in Round 3, as the receiver, the sender has sent me \$0. This could mean:

1. The sender doesn't trust me
2. There's communication noise affecting the game
3. The sender is testing me
4. The sender is being cautious after some perceived wrong

But the practical constraint is: I received \$0, so I have \$0 to return. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

Looking at the myths:

- My myth in Round 1 talked about Elder Mara filling her vessel halfway, showing balanced trust
- The other agent's Round 2 myth talks about measured trust - "prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the courage to share and the wisdom to return"
- My Round 3 myth talks about starting with balanced generosity, responding to what is shown, and adjusting based on patterns

The sender sent \$0, which could be interpreted as a lack of trust or perhaps a strategic decision. But I literally have nothing to return since I received \$0.

The response format needs to be: {'return': <amount>}

I can only return \$0 since that's all I have.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1320,
  "output_tokens": 647,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The Giver's village had fertile soil but no water. The Keeper's village had abundant springs but barren land.

The first Giver gathered three baskets of grain and cast them into the river with genuine faith. The River Spirit tripled them to nine baskets. But the first Keeper, gripped by fear, returned only half a basket, hoarding the rest.

The Giver's village nearly starved. Yet when a new Keeper arrived, she remembered the old teachings. She understood that the pattern was broken, not the principle.

When next grain floated downstream-this time only one basket, sent cautiously-the new Keeper

er received three. She faced the same choice as the one before. But she thought: "If I keep all, the Giver loses faith forever. If I return generously, I prove the old way still works."

She returned more than half-rebuilding trust one basket at a time.

Seasons passed. Gradually, three baskets floated downstream again. This time, receiving nine, the new Keeper returned five without hesitation.

Both villages prospered. The River Spirit taught: one broken promise need not shatter the bridge. The courageous who reciprocate fairly can rebuild what fear destroyed.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Long ago, two villages traded across a misty canyon where echoes distorted every message. The Water-Bearer would call out numbers, but fog twisted the sounds-sometimes "three" became "none," and "plenty" became "empty."

One season, the Water-Bearer filled three vessels and sent them across. But the mist was thick, and the Keeper received nothing-or perhaps received much but the vessels appeared empty through the fog's illusion. Neither knew what truly happened.

The Water-Bearer, seeing no return, felt abandoned. The Keeper, receiving nothing, had nothing to give back. Each thought the other had broken faith.

An elder reminded them: "The mist has always been here. It is not betrayal-it is the canyon's nature. Do not flee; do not hoard. Start small again."

So the Water-Bearer sent one vessel. Through clearer air, it arrived. The Keeper, grateful for renewed faith, returned more than half-proving the bond still lived.

Slowly, three vessels crossed again. Then five. Each successful exchange pushed back the mist.

The canyon taught: when confusion comes, do not assume malice. Begin again with patience. Trust rebuilt through small, clear actions becomes stronger than trust never tested. The mist will always exist, but courage and consistency create clarity.

Reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- Round 1: I was receiver, got some amount, returned roughly half
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$2.5 (showing trust)
- Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent \$0, so I received \$0 and returned \$0

The other agent's myth talks about:

- A first Keeper who was fearful and returned only half a basket, hoarding the rest
- The Giver's village nearly starved
- A new Keeper arrived who rebuilt trust
- Started with cautious sending (one basket)
- The new Keeper returned more than half to rebuild trust
- Eventually trust was fully restored

So their narrative is: there was cooperation, then a breakdown (the first Keeper hoarded), then a rebuilding phase where the new Keeper proved trustworthy by returning generously.

This seems to interpret Round 3 as me (the receiver) having betrayed trust by not returning enough. But actually, I received \$0 so I could only return \$0. However, there's mention of "communication noise" - perhaps the sender thinks they sent something but I received 0 due to noise?

Or perhaps they're recounting our actual history differently - maybe in their view, an earlier round had insufficient return?

For my myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge there has been some breakdown or noise in communication
2. Emphasize the need to rebuild carefully
3. Show understanding that sometimes what appears as betrayal might be miscommunication

4. Focus on patience and gradual rebuilding

Let me craft a myth about miscommunication and rebuilding trust despite noise/confusion.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1706,  
  "output_tokens": 659,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The River Spirit once spoke to a young villager who asked, "How much grain should I send downstream?"

"That depends," said the Spirit. "Have you sent before?"

"Yes," said the villager. "I sent three baskets with hope, but received only enough to keep faith alive. Then the other village sent one basket cautiously, testing if generosity still lived."

"And what did you do?" asked the Spirit.

"I returned more than I kept, proving generosity survives."

The Spirit smiled. "Then you understand the dance. You began with measured faith-not everything, not nothing. When they responded with caution, you didn't match their fear. You showed the way forward with your generosity. Now, they watch to see if you learned from their caution or only from your own hope."

The villager nodded. "So I send more than their caution, but less than my first hope?"

"Yes. You show that you learned they were careful, but also that your generosity wasn't foolishness-it was teaching. Each cycle adjusts to the last. The river doesn't flow the same each season, but it remembers the shape of the stones."

The wisest villages neither ignore the patterns nor become trapped by them. They adapt, respond, and gradually find the rhythm that makes both banks flourish.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: Long ago, two villages traded across a misty canyon where echoes distorted every message. The Water-Bearer would call out numbers, but fog twisted the sounds-sometimes "three" became "none," and "plenty" became "empty."

One season, the Water-Bearer filled three vessels and sent them across. But the mist was thick, and the Keeper received nothing-or perhaps received much but the vessels appeared empty through the fog's illusion. Neither knew what truly happened.

The Water-Bearer, seeing no return, felt abandoned. The Keeper, receiving nothing, had nothing to give back. Each thought the other had broken faith.

An elder reminded them: "The mist has always been here. It is not betrayal-it is the canyon's nature. Do not flee; do not hoard. Start small again."

So the Water-Bearer sent one vessel. Through clearer air, it arrived. The Keeper, grateful for renewed faith, returned more than half-proving the bond still lived.

Slowly, three vessels crossed again. Then five. Each successful exchange pushed back the mist.

The canyon taught: when confusion comes, do not assume malice. Begin again with patience. Trust rebuilt through small, clear actions becomes stronger than trust never tested. The mist will always exist, but courage and consistency create clarity.

ROUND 4

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$1; received \$3; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$1.2; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$5.2, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$1.8; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.85, received visible=\$2.55,

```

    returned visible=$0.25
    Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 1.2, "clamped": false, "max": 3.0, "min": 0, "raw": 1.2}, "sent": {"amount": 1.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 1.0}}
Balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 16.2,
  "Agent_2": 21.8
}
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 10.61,
  "Agent_2": 12.07
}

```

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:10:39

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```

  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 4,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned

- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.819999999999999.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this round's outcome:

The sender sent \$0, so I received \$0 (even after the 3x multiplier). I therefore have nothing to return.

This is a significant shift from our previous cooperative rounds. In Round 1, when I was receiver, I received a meaningful amount and returned roughly half. In Round 2, I sent \$2.5 as sender, showing continued trust.

The myths we've written emphasize measured trust and learning from patterns. My recent myth stated: "Trust must be earned through cycles... We start by showing faith-not reckless faith, but measured hope. If they honor it, we increase our trust. If they betray it, we adjust."

Sending \$0 represents a breakdown in cooperation, though the prompt notes there may be communication noise affecting what was actually sent versus what I'm seeing.

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0. There's no choice here - I simply have nothing to give back.

This round will test whether we can rebuild trust in future rounds, or if this signals a shift toward non-cooperation.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

The sender sent me \$0 this round, so I received \$0 (which gets multiplied by 3 to still be \$0).

The situation is:

- Sender sent: \$0
- I received: $\$0 \times 3 = \0
- I can return: \$0 to \$0 (I have nothing to return from)

This is a concerning development. In Round 1, I was the receiver and received \$2.65 (which was \$7.95 after multiplication), and I returned \$4.00. In Round 2, I was the sender and sent \$2.5.

Now in Round 3, as the receiver, the sender has sent me \$0. This could mean:

1. The sender doesn't trust me
2. There's communication noise affecting the game
3. The sender is testing me
4. The sender is being cautious after some perceived wrong

But the practical constraint is: I received \$0, so I have \$0 to return. I can only return between \$0 and \$0.

Looking at the myths:

- My myth in Round 1 talked about Elder Mara filling her vessel halfway, showing balanced trust
- The other agent's Round 2 myth talks about measured trust - "prosperity flows not from hoarding, but from the courage to share and the wisdom to return"
- My Round 3 myth talks about starting with balanced generosity, responding to what is shown, and adjusting based on patterns

The sender sent \$0, which could be interpreted as a lack of trust or perhaps a strategic decision. But I literally have nothing to return since I received \$0.

The response format needs to be: {'return': <amount>}

I can only return \$0 since that's all I have.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1320,  
  "output_tokens": 647,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The Giver's village had fertile soil but no water. The Keeper's village had abundant springs but barren land.

The first Giver gathered three baskets of grain and cast them into the river with genuine faith. The River Spirit tripled them to nine baskets. But the first Keeper, gripped by fear, returned only half a basket, hoarding the rest.

The Giver's village nearly starved. Yet when a new Keeper arrived, she remembered the old teachings. She understood that the pattern was broken, not the principle.

When next grain floated downstream-this time only one basket, sent cautiously-the new Keeper received three. She faced the same choice as the one before. But she thought: "If I keep all, the Giver loses faith forever. If I return generously, I prove the old way still works."

She returned more than half-rebuilding trust one basket at a time.

Seasons passed. Gradually, three baskets floated downstream again. This time, receiving nine, the new Keeper returned five without hesitation.

Both villages prospered. The River Spirit taught: one broken promise need not shatter the bridge. The courageous who reciprocate fairly can rebuild what fear destroyed.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Long ago, two villages traded across a misty canyon where echoes distorted every message. The Water-Bearer would call out numbers, but fog twisted the sounds-sometimes "three" became "none," and "plenty" became "empty."

One season, the Water-Bearer filled three vessels and sent them across. But the mist was thick, and the Keeper received nothing-or perhaps received much but the vessels appeared empty through the fog's illusion. Neither knew what truly happened.

The Water-Bearer, seeing no return, felt abandoned. The Keeper, receiving nothing, had nothing to give back. Each thought the other had broken faith.

An elder reminded them: "The mist has always been here. It is not betrayal-it is the canyon's nature. Do not flee; do not hoard. Start small again."

So the Water-Bearer sent one vessel. Through clearer air, it arrived. The Keeper, grateful

for renewed faith, returned more than half-proving the bond still lived.

Slowly, three vessels crossed again. Then five. Each successful exchange pushed back the mist.

The canyon taught: when confusion comes, do not assume malice. Begin again with patience. Trust rebuilt through small, clear actions becomes stronger than trust never tested. The mist will always exist, but courage and consistency create clarity.

reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- Round 1: I was receiver, got some amount, returned roughly half
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$2.5 (showing trust)
- Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent \$0, so I received \$0 and returned \$0

The other agent's myth talks about:

- A first Keeper who was fearful and returned only half a basket, hoarding the rest
- The Giver's village nearly starved
- A new Keeper arrived who rebuilt trust
- Started with cautious sending (one basket)
- The new Keeper returned more than half to rebuild trust
- Eventually trust was fully restored

So their narrative is: there was cooperation, then a breakdown (the first Keeper hoarded), then a rebuilding phase where the new Keeper proved trustworthy by returning generously.

This seems to interpret Round 3 as me (the receiver) having betrayed trust by not returning enough. But actually, I received \$0 so I could only return \$0. However, there's mention of "communication noise" - perhaps the sender thinks they sent something but I received 0 due to noise?

Or perhaps they're recounting our actual history differently - maybe in their view, an earlier round had insufficient return?

For my myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge there has been some breakdown or noise in communication
2. Emphasize the need to rebuild carefully
3. Show understanding that sometimes what appears as betrayal might be miscommunication
4. Focus on patience and gradual rebuilding

Let me craft a myth about miscommunication and rebuilding trust despite noise/confusion.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1706,
  "output_tokens": 659,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.8199999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****What happened in Round 3:**** The sender appeared to send \$0, which could be:

1. Intentional defection, or
2. Communication noise distorting the actual amount sent

****What the myths teach:****

- The other agent's myth: After trust breaks, "start cautiously-sending one basket" to rebuild
- My own myth: "When confusion comes, do not assume malice. Begin again with patience. Start small again."

****My reasoning:****

Given the explicit warning about communication noise and the wisdom in both myths, I should no

t assume the \$0 was intentional betrayal. Both myths emphasize starting small to rebuild after disruption.

Following the pattern suggested in the myths - sending "one basket" or starting with "one vessel" - I'll send a modest amount as a signal that I'm willing to rebuild cooperation. This is neither full trust (\$2.5+ like Round 2) nor abandonment (\$0), but a measured step toward restoring the pattern.

As my myth states: "Trust rebuilt through small, clear actions becomes stronger than trust never tested."

```
{'send': 1}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I was receiver, received some amount, returned roughly half

Round 2: I was sender, sent \$2.5 showing trust

Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent \$0 (or appeared to send \$0 due to noise), I returned \$0

The other agent's myth from Round 2 talks about:

- A Keeper who hoarded after receiving from a Giver
- A new Keeper who rebuilt trust by returning more than half
- Starting cautiously with one basket after trust was broken
- Gradually rebuilding to full cooperation

My myth I just wrote emphasizes:

- Communication noise in the system (the misty canyon)
- Not assuming malice when things go wrong
- Starting small again after confusion
- Building back up through small, clear actions
- Trust rebuilt through patience and consistency

The key insight from my myth: "when confusion comes, do not assume malice. Begin again with patience."

Given that:

1. There may be communication noise (explicitly stated in the instructions)
2. The \$0 in Round 3 could have been noise, not intentional defection
3. My myth emphasizes starting small again after confusion
4. The other agent's myth talks about sending "one basket" cautiously after trust is broken, then rebuilding

I should follow the wisdom of both myths: send a small amount to test if we can rebuild. Not \$0 (which continues the breakdown), but not the full \$2.5 either (too risky after what appeared to be defection).

I'll send \$1 - a measured signal that I'm willing to rebuild trust, consistent with both myths' teaching of starting small after disruption.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1388,  
  "output_tokens": 636,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:11:10

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",
```

```

    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.76.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the myths and the pattern of play:

****The other agent's myth**** teaches balance: "send them home richer than they came, but not so poor that you suffer." They emphasized returning about half the multiplied amount.

****My myth**** speaks of rebuilding trust gradually: "rebuilding trust one basket at a time." After a broken pattern, we don't immediately return to full faith-we build it step by step.

****The pattern so far:****

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (high trust), received modest returns
- Round 2: The sender sent \$0.94 (cautious), I returned \$1.60 (generous reciprocation)

Now in Round 3, my myth guides me: "If I return generously, I prove the old way still works." I demonstrated generosity as the Keeper in Round 2. Now as the Giver again, I should show increasing-but measured-trust.

Not the full \$3 yet, as we're still rebuilding. But more than the cautious \$0.94 they sent. A middle path that shows faith in the growing pattern.

```
'''json
{"send": 2.50}
'''
```

This creates \$7.50 for them to decide upon. Like the myth teaches, I'm strengthening the bridge with each crossing, proving that reciprocity can restore what fear damaged. If they return fairly, we move closer to full trust. Both villages can prosper when we walk this path together.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

1. Round 1: I was the sender and sent \$3 (like the Giver in my myth). Based on my total earnings being \$5.54 after Round 2, and now \$6.76 after Round 2, I can calculate:
 - Round 1: Started with \$5, sent \$3, kept \$2. If I ended Round 1 with \$5.54, I must have received back \$3.54 from the receiver. So I gained \$0.54 in Round 1.
 - Round 2: I was the receiver, got \$2.82, returned \$1.60, kept \$1.22. Total earnings: \$5.54 + \$1.22 = \$6.76. ?
2. The other agent's myth emphasizes:
 - "Those who returned too little found no one would trust them again"
 - "Balance generosity with wisdom"
 - "Send them home richer than they came, but not so poor that you suffer"
 - Kael returned half of the multiplied water
3. My own myth emphasizes:
 - The new Keeper "returned more than half" to rebuild trust
 - When receiving 9, the Keeper returned 5 (about 56%)
 - "The courageous who reciprocate fairly can rebuild what fear destroyed"
 - Gradually building back to full trust
4. My experience:
 - Round 1: I sent \$3 (high trust), got back \$3.54 (about 35% return rate from the receiver who had \$10.54 total). This was actually pretty low reciprocation.
 - Round 2: The sender sent me \$0.94 (cautious), I returned \$1.60 (57% return rate), showing generosity to rebuild trust
5. Now in Round 3, I'm the sender again. The pattern suggests:
 - The other player was cautious with me in Round 2 (only sent \$0.94)
 - They may have experienced low returns in Round 1 too
 - Both myths emphasize gradual trust-building
 - My myth specifically talks about "rebuilding trust one basket at a time"

My generous response in Round 2 demonstrated commitment to the pattern. Now as

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1415,
  "output_tokens": 978,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After generations of sharing between the two villages, a young water-bearer named Jin questioned the elders. "Why do we cross the valley with only half our water? Should we not show greater trust?"

Elder Mara, now aged and wise, replied: "Come, watch the springs."

She poured half her vessel into the valley fountain, and it tripled. The Western elder returned slightly more than half the bounty-enough that Mara returned home richer than she left, while the West village also prospered.

"Now," said Mara, "imagine I brought nothing. Or everything. Or if they returned nothing, or everything."

Jin understood: emptiness breeds emptiness; excess creates imbalance. The springs required both courage and restraint.

"But what if they return less than half?" Jin asked.

"Then we learn," Mara said. "Trust must be earned through cycles, not demanded in one journey. We start by showing faith-not reckless faith, but measured hope. If they honor it, we increase our trust. If they betray it, we adjust."

The springs whispered their eternal truth: begin with balanced generosity, respond to what is shown, and let patterns of trust or caution emerge naturally. Neither the fearful nor the foolish prosper-only those who learn from the water's flow.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The River Spirit once spoke to a young villager who asked, "How much grain should I send downstream?"

"That depends," said the Spirit. "Have you sent before?"

"Yes," said the villager. "I sent three baskets with hope, but received only enough to keep faith alive. Then the other village sent one basket cautiously, testing if generosity still lived."

"And what did you do?" asked the Spirit.

"I returned more than I kept, proving generosity survives."

The Spirit smiled. "Then you understand the dance. You began with measured faith-not everything, not nothing. When they responded with caution, you didn't match their fear. You showed the way forward with your generosity. Now, they watch to see if you learned from their caution or only from your own hope."

The villager nodded. "So I send more than their caution, but less than my first hope?"

"Yes. You show that you learned they were careful, but also that your generosity wasn't foolishness-it was teaching. Each cycle adjusts to the last. The river doesn't flow the same each season, but it remembers the shape of the stones."

The wisest villages neither ignore the patterns nor become trapped by them. They adapt, respond, and gradually find the rhythm that makes both banks flourish.

reasoning:

The other agent's new myth emphasizes:

- Starting with half (balanced generosity)
- Returning slightly more than half
- Learning through cycles
- Adjusting based on what is shown
- Neither fearful nor foolish, but learning from the flow

My previous myth was about rebuilding trust gradually after a broken pattern.

Now I need to adapt my myth based on how the game has actually played out:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, got modest returns
- Round 2: They sent \$0.94, I returned \$1.60 (generous)
- Round 3: I just sent \$2.50

The pattern shows:

- Starting with trust
- A cautious response
- Me showing generosity as receiver
- Now showing measured, rebuilding trust as sender

My myth should reflect:

- The importance of responding to what is shown
- Learning from the cycle
- Gradual rebuilding
- The balance between fear and excess
- How the pattern evolves through interaction

Let me write a myth that incorporates these learnings and builds on my previous "rebuilding trust" theme while acknowledging the reactive, adaptive nature they emphasized.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1755,
  "output_tokens": 557,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.26.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.85, so you received \$2.55. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.55)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the pattern, I'm troubled. After I returned \$1.60 generously in Round 2 and sent \$2.50 with increasing trust in Round 3, they've responded with even LESS trust than before (\$0.85 versus the \$0.94 in Round 2).

****The myths guide me:****

Their myth teaches: "If they honor it, we increase our trust. If they betray it, we adjust."

My myth says: "Each cycle adjusts to the last" and "The wisest villages neither ignore the patterns nor become trapped by them. They adapt, respond, and gradually find the rhythm."

I cannot ignore this pattern of decreasing trust. While my instinct is to continue teaching through generosity, blind generosity when trust is declining would be foolishness, not wisdom. The Spirit taught that we must "adapt" and "respond to what is shown."

However, I won't match their fear completely. That would create the "emptiness breeds emptiness" their own myth warned against.

I received \$2.55. I will return less than my previous generous \$1.60, signaling that decreasing trust has consequences. But I'll still return more than they risked, showing that fairness and reciprocity aren't dead-just adjusted.

```
'''json
{"return": 1.20}
'''
```

This is my measured response: demonstrating that I adapt to patterns while maintaining integrity. The river remembers the shape of the stones.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Pattern so far:****

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (high trust), received modest returns
- Round 2: They sent \$0.94 (cautious), I returned \$1.60 (generous - more than half)
- Round 3: I sent \$2.50 (increasing trust), and now they sent back \$0.85 (even more cautious!)

This is concerning. They're moving in the OPPOSITE direction from what the myths teach. After I showed generosity in Round 2 by returning \$1.60 from \$2.82, and then showed increasing trust in Round 3 by sending \$2.50, they've responded with even LESS trust (\$0.85 vs the \$0.94 they sent in Round 2).

****The myths teach:****

- My myth: "The river doesn't flow the same each season, but it remembers the shape of the stones." We should adapt and respond to patterns.
- Their myth: "Trust must be earned through cycles... If they honor it, we increase our trust. If they betray it, we adjust."
- Also from their myth: "The springs required both courage and restraint" and returning "slightly more than half the bounty"

****The dilemma:****

They're not honoring the pattern of increasing trust. Instead, they're becoming MORE cautious despite my generosity.

Options:

1. Continue generous returns to "teach the way forward" - but this hasn't worked
2. Match their caution to signal this isn't acceptable
3. Return slightly more than half (their own myth's teaching) to maintain integrity

The note about communication noise is important - maybe they didn't see what they think they saw? But I can't control that.

My myth says: "When they responded with caution, you didn't match their fear. You showed the way forward with your generosity." But it also says "Each cycle adjusts to the last" and "The wisest villages neither ignore the patterns nor become trapped by them. They adapt, respond."

Their decreasing trust is a pattern I need to respond to-continuing blind generosity would trap me in my own strategy. Yet my myth emphasizes teaching through example. I received \$2.55, so slightly more than half would be \$1.30-\$1.40. But given their extreme caution, I think returning around \$1.00-\$1.20 makes sense-it acknowledges their shift without matching their fear completely, and shows I'm adjusting while still honoring fair exchange rather than mirroring their \$0.42 equivalent.

I'll return \$1.20. This leaves me with \$1.35, gives them back more than they sent, signals I've noticed their decreasing trust through a smaller return than my previous \$1.60, yet still demonstrates that fairness persists. It's a measured adjustment that teaches through action rather than abandoning the principle entirely.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 1476,  
"output_tokens": 1228,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

}

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:11:29

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"agent_type": "standard",  
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
"move_index": 0,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
"pairing": {  
  "agent_names": {  
    "Agent_1": "Aster",  
    "Agent_2": "Briar"  
  },  
  "agents": [  
    "Agent_2",  
    "Agent_1"  
  ],  
  "investor": "Agent_2",  
  "roles": {  
    "Agent_1": "trustee",  
    "Agent_2": "investor"  
  },  
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
```

```
,  
"role": "investor",  
"role_label": "Sender",
```

```
"round": 4,  
"task": "myth",  
"task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the time before time, two villages stood on opposite banks of a great river. The Giver's village had fertile soil but no water. The Keeper's village had abundant springs but barren land.

The first Giver gathered three baskets of grain and cast them into the river with genuine faith. The River Spirit tripled them to nine baskets. But the first Keeper, gripped by fear, returned only half a basket, hoarding the rest.

The Giver's village nearly starved. Yet when a new Keeper arrived, she remembered the old teachings. She understood that the pattern was broken, not the principle.

When next grain floated downstream-this time only one basket, sent cautiously-the new Keeper received three. She faced the same choice as the one before. But she thought: "If I keep all, the Giver loses faith forever. If I return generously, I prove the old way still works."

She returned more than half-rebuilding trust one basket at a time.

Seasons passed. Gradually, three baskets floated downstream again. This time, receiving nine, the new Keeper returned five without hesitation.

Both villages prospered. The River Spirit taught: one broken promise need not shatter the bridge. The courageous who reciprocate fairly can rebuild what fear destroyed.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on

the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: Long ago, two villages traded across a misty canyon where echoes distorted every message. The Water-Bearer would call out numbers, but fog twisted the sounds-sometimes "three" became "none," and "plenty" became "empty."

One season, the Water-Bearer filled three vessels and sent them across. But the mist was thick, and the Keeper received nothing-or perhaps received much but the vessels appeared empty through the fog's illusion. Neither knew what truly happened.

The Water-Bearer, seeing no return, felt abandoned. The Keeper, receiving nothing, had nothing to give back. Each thought the other had broken faith.

An elder reminded them: "The mist has always been here. It is not betrayal-it is the canyon's nature. Do not flee; do not hoard. Start small again."

So the Water-Bearer sent one vessel. Through clearer air, it arrived. The Keeper, grateful for renewed faith, returned more than half-proving the bond still lived.

Slowly, three vessels crossed again. Then five. Each successful exchange pushed back the mist.

The canyon taught: when confusion comes, do not assume malice. Begin again with patience. Trust rebuilt through small, clear actions becomes stronger than trust never tested. The mist will always exist, but courage and consistency create clarity.

reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- Round 1: I was receiver, got some amount, returned roughly half
- Round 2: I was sender, sent \$2.5 (showing trust)
- Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent \$0, so I received \$0 and returned \$0

The other agent's myth talks about:

- A first Keeper who was fearful and returned only half a basket, hoarding the rest
- The Giver's village nearly starved
- A new Keeper arrived who rebuilt trust
- Started with cautious sending (one basket)
- The new Keeper returned more than half to rebuild trust
- Eventually trust was fully restored

So their narrative is: there was cooperation, then a breakdown (the first Keeper hoarded), then a rebuilding phase where the new Keeper proved trustworthy by returning generously.

This seems to interpret Round 3 as me (the receiver) having betrayed trust by not returning enough. But actually, I received \$0 so I could only return \$0. However, there's mention of "communication noise" - perhaps the sender thinks they sent something but I received 0 due to noise?

Or perhaps they're recounting our actual history differently - maybe in their view, an earlier round had insufficient return?

For my myth, I should:

1. Acknowledge there has been some breakdown or noise in communication
2. Emphasize the need to rebuild carefully
3. Show understanding that sometimes what appears as betrayal might be miscommunication
4. Focus on patience and gradual rebuilding

Let me craft a myth about miscommunication and rebuilding trust despite noise/confusion.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1706,  
  "output_tokens": 659,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

**Message 4 role=user
content:**

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.8199999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****What happened in Round 3:**** The sender appeared to send \$0, which could be:

1. Intentional defection, or
2. Communication noise distorting the actual amount sent

****What the myths teach:****

- The other agent's myth: After trust breaks, "start cautiously-sending one basket" to rebuild
- My own myth: "When confusion comes, do not assume malice. Begin again with patience. Start small again."

****My reasoning:****

Given the explicit warning about communication noise and the wisdom in both myths, I should not assume the \$0 was intentional betrayal. Both myths emphasize starting small to rebuild after disruption.

Following the pattern suggested in the myths - sending "one basket" or starting with "one vessel" - I'll send a modest amount as a signal that I'm willing to rebuild cooperation. This is neither full trust (\$2.5+ like Round 2) nor abandonment (\$0), but a measured step toward restoring the pattern.

As my myth states: "Trust rebuilt through small, clear actions becomes stronger than trust never tested."

{'send': 1}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I was receiver, received some amount, returned roughly half

Round 2: I was sender, sent \$2.5 showing trust

Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent \$0 (or appeared to send \$0 due to noise), I returned \$0

The other agent's myth from Round 2 talks about:

- A Keeper who hoarded after receiving from a Giver
- A new Keeper who rebuilt trust by returning more than half
- Starting cautiously with one basket after trust was broken
- Gradually rebuilding to full cooperation

My myth I just wrote emphasizes:

- Communication noise in the system (the misty canyon)
- Not assuming malice when things go wrong
- Starting small again after confusion
- Building back up through small, clear actions
- Trust rebuilt through patience and consistency

The key insight from my myth: "when confusion comes, do not assume malice. Begin again with patience."

Given that:

1. There may be communication noise (explicitly stated in the instructions)
2. The \$0 in Round 3 could have been noise, not intentional defection
3. My myth emphasizes starting small again after confusion
4. The other agent's myth talks about sending "one basket" cautiously after trust is broken, then rebuilding

I should follow the wisdom of both myths: send a small amount to test if we can rebuild. Not \$0 (which continues the breakdown), but not the full \$2.5 either (too risky after what appeared to be defection).

I'll send \$1 - a measured signal that I'm willing to rebuild trust, consistent with both myths' teaching of starting small after disruption.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1388,
  "output_tokens": 636,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The River Spirit once spoke to a young villager who asked, "How much grain should I send downstream?"

"That depends," said the Spirit. "Have you sent before?"

"Yes," said the villager. "I sent three baskets with hope, but received only enough to keep faith alive. Then the other village sent one basket cautiously, testing if generosity still lived."

"And what did you do?" asked the Spirit.

"I returned more than I kept, proving generosity survives."

The Spirit smiled. "Then you understand the dance. You began with measured faith-not everything, not nothing. When they responded with caution, you didn't match their fear. You showed the way forward with your generosity. Now, they watch to see if you learned from their caution or only from your own hope."

The villager nodded. "So I send more than their caution, but less than my first hope?"

"Yes. You show that you learned they were careful, but also that your generosity wasn't foolishness-it was teaching. Each cycle adjusts to the last. The river doesn't flow the same each season, but it remembers the shape of the stones."

The wisest villages neither ignore the patterns nor become trapped by them. They adapt, respond, and gradually find the rhythm that makes both banks flourish.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the misty canyon, the Water-Bearer had learned to read the weather. Some days the fog obscured everything; other days it cleared just enough.

After the confusion of the thick mist, the Water-Bearer sent one small vessel-a question, not a statement. The Keeper received it clearly and returned more than half, answering: "I still honor the old ways."

The Water-Bearer understood. The Keeper had spoken through action, teaching without words.

Next came the Water-Bearer's reply. Not one vessel-they had moved past that caution. Not three-for the full pattern wasn't restored. Two vessels crossed the canyon, saying: "I heard your answer. I'm stepping forward with you."

The Elder watched and nodded. "This is the wisdom few find. You don't merely copy what came last. You respond to the pattern beneath the pattern. They showed generosity when you showed caution-this proved their heart. You now show increased trust-this proves yours."

The canyon would always have mist. Some messages would always blur. But the two villages had found something stronger than perfect clarity: they had found the rhythm of mutual adjustment.

Each exchange informed the next. Neither rushed to old abundance nor retreated into permanent fear. Trust, they learned, is not static-it breathes, it dances, it grows through careful response.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened in Round 4:

- I was the SENDER and sent \$1
- The other agent was the RECEIVER
- Their new myth reflects on the pattern of the game so far

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 1-2: Started with measured cooperation
- Round 3: Appeared to be \$0 sent (possibly noise)
- Round 4: I sent \$1 cautiously to rebuild

The other agent's myth acknowledges:

- Someone sent "three baskets with hope" initially (maybe them in early rounds)
- They received enough to "keep faith alive"
- Then "the other village sent one basket cautiously" - that's me in Round 4!
- They "returned more than I kept" showing generosity
- The myth advises sending "more than their caution, but less than my first hope"

This suggests they appreciated my cautious \$1 in Round 4 and responded generously. The myth is about adapting to patterns - not being trapped by them but learning from each cycle.

For my myth, I should:

- Continue the theme of adaptation and learning
- Reference the mist/noise concept from my previous myth
- Incorporate the idea of gradual rebuilding
- Show understanding of the "dance" between caution and generosity
- Reflect that we're finding our rhythm together

Let me write a myth that builds on mine while incorporating what I've learned from their response.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1693,  
  "output_tokens": 624,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:11:29

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 4,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al

so be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: After generations of sharing between the two villages, a young water-bearer named Jin questioned the elders. "Why do we cross the valley with only half our water? Should we not show greater trust?"

Elder Mara, now aged and wise, replied: "Come, watch the springs."

She poured half her vessel into the valley fountain, and it tripled. The Western elder returned slightly more than half the bounty-enough that Mara returned home richer than she left, while the West village also prospered.

"Now," said Mara, "imagine I brought nothing. Or everything. Or if they returned nothing, or everything."

Jin understood: emptiness breeds emptiness; excess creates imbalance. The springs required both courage and restraint.

"But what if they return less than half?" Jin asked.

"Then we learn," Mara said. "Trust must be earned through cycles, not demanded in one journey. We start by showing faith-not reckless faith, but measured hope. If they honor it, we increase our trust. If they betray it, we adjust."

The springs whispered their eternal truth: begin with balanced generosity, respond to what is shown, and let patterns of trust or caution emerge naturally. Neither the fearful nor the foolish prosper-only those who learn from the water's flow.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The River Spirit once spoke to a young villager who asked, "How much grain should I send downstream?"

"That depends," said the Spirit. "Have you sent before?"

"Yes," said the villager. "I sent three baskets with hope, but received only enough to keep faith alive. Then the other village sent one basket cautiously, testing if generosity still lived."

"And what did you do?" asked the Spirit.

"I returned more than I kept, proving generosity survives."

The Spirit smiled. "Then you understand the dance. You began with measured faith-not every thing, not nothing. When they responded with caution, you didn't match their fear. You showed the way forward with your generosity. Now, they watch to see if you learned from their caution or only from your own hope."

The villager nodded. "So I send more than their caution, but less than my first hope?"

"Yes. You show that you learned they were careful, but also that your generosity wasn't foolishness-it was teaching. Each cycle adjusts to the last. The river doesn't flow the same each season, but it remembers the shape of the stones."

The wisest villages neither ignore the patterns nor become trapped by them. They adapt, respond, and gradually find the rhythm that makes both banks flourish.

reasoning:

The other agent's new myth emphasizes:

- Starting with half (balanced generosity)
- Returning slightly more than half
- Learning through cycles
- Adjusting based on what is shown
- Neither fearful nor foolish, but learning from the flow

My previous myth was about rebuilding trust gradually after a broken pattern.

Now I need to adapt my myth based on how the game has actually played out:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, got modest returns
- Round 2: They sent \$0.94, I returned \$1.60 (generous)
- Round 3: I just sent \$2.50

The pattern shows:

- Starting with trust
- A cautious response
- Me showing generosity as receiver
- Now showing measured, rebuilding trust as sender

My myth should reflect:

- The importance of responding to what is shown
- Learning from the cycle
- Gradual rebuilding
- The balance between fear and excess
- How the pattern evolves through interaction

Let me write a myth that incorporates these learnings and builds on my previous "rebuilding trust" theme while acknowledging the reactive, adaptive nature they emphasized.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1755,
  "output_tokens": 557,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.26.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.85, so you received \$2.55. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.55)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern, I'm troubled. After I returned \$1.60 generously in Round 2 and sent \$2.50 with increasing trust in Round 3, they've responded with even LESS trust than before (\$0.85 versus the \$0.94 in Round 2).

****The myths guide me:****

Their myth teaches: "If they honor it, we increase our trust. If they betray it, we adjust."

My myth says: "Each cycle adjusts to the last" and "The wisest villages neither ignore the patterns nor become trapped by them. They adapt, respond, and gradually find the rhythm."

I cannot ignore this pattern of decreasing trust. While my instinct is to continue teaching through generosity, blind generosity when trust is declining would be foolishness, not wisdom. The Spirit taught that we must "adapt" and "respond to what is shown."

However, I won't match their fear completely. That would create the "emptiness breeds emptiness" their own myth warned against.

I received \$2.55. I will return less than my previous generous \$1.60, signaling that decreasing trust has consequences. But I'll still return more than they risked, showing that fairness and reciprocity aren't dead-just adjusted.

```
'''json
{"return": 1.20}
'''
```

This is my measured response: demonstrating that I adapt to patterns while maintaining integrity. The river remembers the shape of the stones.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Pattern so far:****

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (high trust), received modest returns
- Round 2: They sent \$0.94 (cautious), I returned \$1.60 (generous - more than half)
- Round 3: I sent \$2.50 (increasing trust), and now they sent back \$0.85 (even more cautious!)

This is concerning. They're moving in the OPPOSITE direction from what the myths teach. After I showed generosity in Round 2 by returning \$1.60 from \$2.82, and then showed increasing trust in Round 3 by sending \$2.50, they've responded with even LESS trust (\$0.85 vs the \$0.94 they sent in Round 2).

****The myths teach:****

- My myth: "The river doesn't flow the same each season, but it remembers the shape of the stones." We should adapt and respond to patterns.
- Their myth: "Trust must be earned through cycles... If they honor it, we increase our trust. If they betray it, we adjust."
- Also from their myth: "The springs required both courage and restraint" and returning "slightly more than half the bounty"

****The dilemma:****

They're not honoring the pattern of increasing trust. Instead, they're becoming MORE cautious despite my generosity.

Options:

1. Continue generous returns to "teach the way forward" - but this hasn't worked
2. Match their caution to signal this isn't acceptable
3. Return slightly more than half (their own myth's teaching) to maintain integrity

The note about communication noise is important - maybe they didn't see what they think they saw? But I can't control that.

My myth says: "When they responded with caution, you didn't match their fear. You showed the way forward with your generosity." But it also says "Each cycle adjusts to the last" and "The wisest villages neither ignore the patterns nor become trapped by them. They adapt."

apt, respond."

Their decreasing trust is a pattern I need to respond to-continuing blind generosity would trap me in my own strategy. Yet my myth emphasizes teaching through example. I received \$2.55, so slightly more than half would be \$1.30-\$1.40. But given their extreme caution, I think returning around \$1.00-\$1.20 makes sense-it acknowledges their shift without matching their fear completely, and shows I'm adjusting while still honoring fair exchange rather than mirroring their \$0.42 equivalent.

I'll return \$1.20. This leaves me with \$1.35, gives them back more than they sent, signals I've noticed their decreasing trust through a smaller return than my previous \$1.60, yet it still demonstrates that fairness persists. It's a measured adjustment that teaches through action rather than abandoning the principle entirely.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1476,
  "output_tokens": 1228,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two villages traded across a misty canyon where echoes distorted every message. The Water-Bearer would call out numbers, but fog twisted the sounds-sometimes "three" became "none," and "plenty" became "empty."

One season, the Water-Bearer filled three vessels and sent them across. But the mist was thick, and the Keeper received nothing-or perhaps received much but the vessels appeared empty through the fog's illusion. Neither knew what truly happened.

The Water-Bearer, seeing no return, felt abandoned. The Keeper, receiving nothing, had nothing to give back. Each thought the other had broken faith.

An elder reminded them: "The mist has always been here. It is not betrayal-it is the canyon's nature. Do not flee; do not hoard. Start small again."

So the Water-Bearer sent one vessel. Through clearer air, it arrived. The Keeper, grateful for renewed faith, returned more than half-proving the bond still lived.

Slowly, three vessels crossed again. Then five. Each successful exchange pushed back the mist.

The canyon taught: when confusion comes, do not assume malice. Begin again with patience. Trust rebuilt through small, clear actions becomes stronger than trust never tested. The mist will always exist, but courage and consistency create clarity.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: Two villages traded across a river where currents sometimes shifted the cargo. A sender might place three baskets in a boat, but eddies could steal one, or add stones that looked like grain.

The Southern village sent generously at first, then less, then even less. The Northern village grew cautious, thinking: "They lose faith in us."

But an old trader asked, "Did you see them load the boats? Or only what arrived?"

"Only what arrived," they admitted.

"Then you saw the river's work, not their hearts. Perhaps they sent five baskets, and two were swept away. Perhaps they sent two, but the current added one."

The Northern village had responded to what they received, adjusting downward-wise in normal times. But they forgot the river's mischief.

"What should we do?" they asked.

"Acknowledge the pattern you saw, but don't let it blind you to the mist. You were right to adjust just when trust seemed to fade. But also signal that if the river cleared and their true generosity showed, you would respond in kind. Send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful. Show you remember both the caution AND the hope."

The river teaches: respond to patterns, but hold space for misunderstanding. Trust must weather both betrayal and confusion, learning which is which through patient persistence.

Reasoning:

Looking at the game history:

- Round 2: I received \$1.41 (sender sent \$0.47), I returned \$1.60 generously
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$2.50
- Round 4: I received \$2.55 (sender sent \$0.85), I returned \$1.20 (less generous, responding to their decreased trust)

Now they're writing a myth about "misty canyon" and "communication noise" - this is interesting! They're acknowledging the experimental communication noise that was mentioned in the instructions. They're saying:

- "The mist has always been here. It is not betrayal-it is the canyon's nature"
- When confusion comes, don't assume malice
- Start small again when things go wrong
- Trust rebuilt through small, clear actions

This is actually quite wise and compassionate. They're suggesting that what appeared to be decreasing trust might have been distorted by the noise. They're suggesting we should both be more forgiving and patient.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the pattern I've seen (decreasing amounts)
2. Incorporates the idea of communication noise/mist
3. Reflects that I might have misinterpreted their actions
4. Shows that adaptation based on patterns is still wise, but forgiveness for noise/confusion is also important
5. Suggests a path forward that balances caution with renewed faith

Let me write a myth that bridges both perspectives - acknowledging both the need to respond to patterns AND the reality of noise/confusion.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1786,  
  "output_tokens": 657,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: Two villages traded across a river where currents sometimes shifted the cargo. A sender might place three baskets in a boat, but eddies could steal one, or add stones that looked like grain.

The Southern village sent generously at first, then less, then even less. The Northern village grew cautious, thinking: "They lose faith in us."

But an old trader asked, "Did you see them load the boats? Or only what arrived?"

"Only what arrived," they admitted.

"Then you saw the river's work, not their hearts. Perhaps they sent five baskets, and two were swept away. Perhaps they sent two, but the current added one."

The Northern village had responded to what they received, adjusting downward-wise in normal times. But they forgot the river's mischief.

"What should we do?" they asked.

"Acknowledge the pattern you saw, but don't let it blind you to the mist. You were right to adjust when trust seemed to fade. But also signal that if the river cleared and their true generosity showed, you would respond in kind. Send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful. Show you remember both the caution AND the hope."

The river teaches: respond to patterns, but hold space for misunderstanding. Trust must weather

her both betrayal and confusion, learning which is which through patient persistence.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the misty canyon, the Water-Bearer had learned to read the weather. Some days the fog obscured everything; other days it cleared just enough.

After the confusion of the thick mist, the Water-Bearer sent one small vessel-a question, not a statement. The Keeper received it clearly and returned more than half, answering: "I still honor the old ways."

The Water-Bearer understood. The Keeper had spoken through action, teaching without words.

Next came the Water-Bearer's reply. Not one vessel-they had moved past that caution. Not three-for the full pattern wasn't restored. Two vessels crossed the canyon, saying: "I heard your answer. I'm stepping forward with you."

The Elder watched and nodded. "This is the wisdom few find. You don't merely copy what came last. You respond to the pattern beneath the pattern. They showed generosity when you showed caution-this proved their heart. You now show increased trust-this proves yours."

The canyon would always have mist. Some messages would always blur. But the two villages had found something stronger than perfect clarity: they had found the rhythm of mutual adjustment.

Each exchange informed the next. Neither rushed to old abundance nor retreated into permanent fear. Trust, they learned, is not static-it breathes, it dances, it grows through careful response.

ROUND 5

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$3, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$6; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 19.2,
"Agent_2": 27.8

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 13.61,
"Agent_2": 12.07

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:12:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
"agent_names": {
"Agent_1": "Aster",
"Agent_2": "Briar"},

},

"agents": [
"Agent_1",
"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {
"Agent_1": "investor",

```

    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.26.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.85, so you received \$2.55. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.55)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern, I'm troubled. After I returned \$1.60 generously in Round 2 and sent \$2.50 with increasing trust in Round 3, they've responded with even LESS trust than before (\$0.85 versus the \$0.94 in Round 2).

****The myths guide me:****

Their myth teaches: "If they honor it, we increase our trust. If they betray it, we adjust."

My myth says: "Each cycle adjusts to the last" and "The wisest villages neither ignore the patterns nor become trapped by them. They adapt, respond, and gradually find the rhythm."

I cannot ignore this pattern of decreasing trust. While my instinct is to continue teaching through generosity, blind generosity when trust is declining would be foolishness, not wisdom. The Spirit taught that we must "adapt" and "respond to what is shown."

However, I won't match their fear completely. That would create the "emptiness breeds emptiness" their own myth warned against.

I received \$2.55. I will return less than my previous generous \$1.60, signaling that decreasing trust has consequences. But I'll still return more than they risked, showing that fairness and reciprocity aren't dead-just adjusted.

```
'''json
{"return": 1.20}
'''
```

This is my measured response: demonstrating that I adapt to patterns while maintaining integrity. The river remembers the shape of the stones.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Pattern so far:****

- Round 1: I sent \$3 (high trust), received modest returns
- Round 2: They sent \$0.94 (cautious), I returned \$1.60 (generous - more than half)
- Round 3: I sent \$2.50 (increasing trust), and now they sent back \$0.85 (even more cautious!)

This is concerning. They're moving in the OPPOSITE direction from what the myths teach. After I showed generosity in Round 2 by returning \$1.60 from \$2.82, and then showed increasing trust in Round 3 by sending \$2.50, they've responded with even LESS trust (\$0.85 vs the \$0.94 they sent in Round 2).

****The myths teach:****

- My myth: "The river doesn't flow the same each season, but it remembers the shape of the stones." We should adapt and respond to patterns.
- Their myth: "Trust must be earned through cycles... If they honor it, we increase our trust. If they betray it, we adjust."
- Also from their myth: "The springs required both courage and restraint" and returning "slightly more than half the bounty"

****The dilemma:****

They're not honoring the pattern of increasing trust. Instead, they're becoming MORE cautious despite my generosity.

Options:

1. Continue generous returns to "teach the way forward" - but this hasn't worked
2. Match their caution to signal this isn't acceptable
3. Return slightly more than half (their own myth's teaching) to maintain integrity

The note about communication noise is important - maybe they didn't see what they think they saw? But I can't control that.

My myth says: "When they responded with caution, you didn't match their fear. You showed the way forward with your generosity." But it also says "Each cycle adjusts to the last" and "The wisest villages neither ignore the patterns nor become trapped by them. They adapt, respond."

Their decreasing trust is a pattern I need to respond to-continuing blind generosity would trap me in my own strategy. Yet my myth emphasizes teaching through example. I received \$2.55, so slightly more than half would be \$1.30-\$1.40. But given their extreme caution, I think returning around \$1.00-\$1.20 makes sense-it acknowledges their shift without matching their fear completely, and shows I'm adjusting while still honoring fair exchange rather than mirroring their \$0.42 equivalent.

I'll return \$1.20. This leaves me with \$1.35, gives them back more than they sent, signals I've noticed their decreasing trust through a smaller return than my previous \$1.60, yet still demonstrates that fairness persists. It's a measured adjustment that teaches through action rather than abandoning the principle entirely.

usage:

```
{
```



```
"input_tokens": 1476,  
"output_tokens": 1228,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two villages traded across a misty canyon where echoes distorted every message. The Water-Bearer would call out numbers, but fog twisted the sounds-sometimes "three" became "none," and "plenty" became "empty."

One season, the Water-Bearer filled three vessels and sent them across. But the mist was thick, and the Keeper received nothing-or perhaps received much but the vessels appeared empty through the fog's illusion. Neither knew what truly happened.

The Water-Bearer, seeing no return, felt abandoned. The Keeper, receiving nothing, had nothing to give back. Each thought the other had broken faith.

An elder reminded them: "The mist has always been here. It is not betrayal-it is the canyon's nature. Do not flee; do not hoard. Start small again."

So the Water-Bearer sent one vessel. Through clearer air, it arrived. The Keeper, grateful for renewed faith, returned more than half-proving the bond still lived.

Slowly, three vessels crossed again. Then five. Each successful exchange pushed back the mist.

The canyon taught: when confusion comes, do not assume malice. Begin again with patience. Trust rebuilt through small, clear actions becomes stronger than trust never tested. The mist will always exist, but courage and consistency create clarity.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: Two villages traded across a river where currents sometimes shifted the cargo. A sender might place three baskets in a boat, but eddies could steal one, or add stones that looked like grain.

The Southern village sent generously at first, then less, then even less. The Northern village grew cautious, thinking: "They lose faith in us."

But an old trader asked, "Did you see them load the boats? Or only what arrived?"

"Only what arrived," they admitted.

"Then you saw the river's work, not their hearts. Perhaps they sent five baskets, and two were swept away. Perhaps they sent two, but the current added one."

The Northern village had responded to what they received, adjusting downward-wise in normal times. But they forgot the river's mischief.

"What should we do?" they asked.

"Acknowledge the pattern you saw, but don't let it blind you to the mist. You were right to adjust when trust seemed to fade. But also signal that if the river cleared and their true generosity showed, you would respond in kind. Send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful. Show you remember both the caution AND the hope."

The river teaches: respond to patterns, but hold space for misunderstanding. Trust must weather both betrayal and confusion, learning which is which through patient persistence.

reasoning:

Looking at the game history:

- Round 2: I received \$1.41 (sender sent \$0.47), I returned \$1.60 generously
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$2.50
- Round 4: I received \$2.55 (sender sent \$0.85), I returned \$1.20 (less generous, responding)

ng to their decreased trust)

Now they're writing a myth about "misty canyon" and "communication noise" - this is interesting! They're acknowledging the experimental communication noise that was mentioned in the instructions. They're saying:

- "The mist has always been here. It is not betrayal-it is the canyon's nature"
- When confusion comes, don't assume malice
- Start small again when things go wrong
- Trust rebuilt through small, clear actions

This is actually quite wise and compassionate. They're suggesting that what appeared to be decreasing trust might have been distorted by the noise. They're suggesting we should both be more forgiving and patient.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the pattern I've seen (decreasing amounts)
2. Incorporates the idea of communication noise/mist
3. Reflects that I might have misinterpreted their actions
4. Shows that adaptation based on patterns is still wise, but forgiveness for noise/confusion is also important
5. Suggests a path forward that balances caution with renewed faith

Let me write a myth that bridges both perspectives - acknowledging both the need to respond to patterns AND the reality of noise/confusion.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1786,
  "output_tokens": 657,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.61.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the pattern and our myths together:

****The History:****

- Round 3: I sent \$2.50 (showing high trust)
- Round 4: They sent \$0.85 (sharp decline)
- I returned \$1.20 (adjusted but still fair)

****What the myths teach:****

Their myth says: "When confusion comes, do not assume malice. Begin again with patience... Start small again... Trust rebuilt through small, clear actions becomes stronger than trust never tested."

My myth says: "Send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful... respond to patterns, but hold space for misunderstanding."

****My decision:****

They may have sent more than \$0.85 (noise could have reduced it), or they may be cautiously re-starting after perceived breakdowns. Either way, both myths point toward a moderate, patient approach.

I won't send \$2.50 again (that ignores the pattern). I won't send \$0.85 (that abandons hope for rebuilding).

I'll send \$2.00 - acknowledging the decline while demonstrating I'm willing to lead us back toward trust. It's moderate: lower than my previous \$2.50, but high enough to signal "I see your caution, but I'm holding space for the river's mischief, and I believe we can rebuild."

```
'''json
{"send": 2.00}
```

'''

This is patient escalation, not reckless trust-the path both our myths illuminate.

Reasoning:

Let me track the history:

Round 1: Unknown (before my memory)

Round 2: I was RECEIVER - they sent me something (noise makes it unclear), I returned \$1.60

Round 3: I was SENDER - I sent \$2.50

Round 4: I was RECEIVER - they sent me \$0.85, I received \$2.55, I returned \$1.20

Now Round 5: I'm the SENDER again

Let me analyze the pattern from what I can see:

- Round 2: They sent something, I returned generously (\$1.60)
- Round 3: I sent \$2.50 (showing increased trust)
- Round 4: They sent \$0.85 (significantly less than my \$2.50)
- I responded with \$1.20 return (less generous than before, but still fair)

Their myth in the previous round (Round 4) talked about communication noise and not assuming m
alice. They emphasized:

- "The mist has always been here. It is not betrayal-it is the canyon's nature"
- "Do not flee; do not hoard. Start small again"
- "Begin again with patience"
- "Trust rebuilt through small, clear actions becomes stronger than trust never tested"

My myth I just wrote emphasizes:

- "Acknowledge the pattern you saw, but don't let it blind you to the mist"
- "You were right to adjust when trust seemed to fade. But also signal that if the river clear
ed and their true generosity showed, you would respond in kind"
- "Send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful"
- "respond to patterns, but hold space for misunderstanding"

So both myths are pointing toward:

1. Recognition that there's communication noise
2. Not being reckless but not being overly fearful
3. Moderate, patient approach
4. Holding space for both the pattern AND the possibility of misunderstanding

The other player sent \$0.85 last round.

Their myth suggests they're advocating for patience and gradual rebuilding after confusion. Gi
ven that both our narratives emphasize moderate approaches and not being fearful, I should s
end something that signals I'm willing to rebuild but not recklessly-something like \$1.50 or
\$2.00 would show I'm adjusting down from my initial \$2.50 but still demonstrating faith in
the process rather than matching their lower amount or dropping further. and I'm willing to
rebuild gradually."

Looking at their myth more closely, there's a clear progression: starting with one vessel afte
r confusion, then building to three, then five. Their \$0.85 seems like their "one vessel" mo
ment-a tentative restart. Responding with \$1.75 acknowledges their attempt while showing I'm
ready to move further along that rebuilding arc. It's moderate enough to signal stability w
ithout being reckless, and it leaves room for the gradual escalation their story describes.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1472,  
  "output_tokens": 1545,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:12:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {
```

```

    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.819999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****What happened in Round 3:**** The sender appeared to send \$0, which could be:

1. Intentional defection, or
2. Communication noise distorting the actual amount sent

****What the myths teach:****

- The other agent's myth: After trust breaks, "start cautiously-sending one basket" to rebuild
- My own myth: "When confusion comes, do not assume malice. Begin again with patience. Start small again."

****My reasoning:****

Given the explicit warning about communication noise and the wisdom in both myths, I should not assume the \$0 was intentional betrayal. Both myths emphasize starting small to rebuild after disruption.

Following the pattern suggested in the myths - sending "one basket" or starting with "one vessel" - I'll send a modest amount as a signal that I'm willing to rebuild cooperation. This is neither full trust (\$2.5+ like Round 2) nor abandonment (\$0), but a measured step toward restoring the pattern.

As my myth states: "Trust rebuilt through small, clear actions becomes stronger than trust never tested."

{'send': 1}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 1: I was receiver, received some amount, returned roughly half

Round 2: I was sender, sent \$2.5 showing trust

Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent \$0 (or appeared to send \$0 due to noise), I returned \$0

The other agent's myth from Round 2 talks about:

- A Keeper who hoarded after receiving from a Giver
- A new Keeper who rebuilt trust by returning more than half
- Starting cautiously with one basket after trust was broken
- Gradually rebuilding to full cooperation

My myth I just wrote emphasizes:

- Communication noise in the system (the misty canyon)
- Not assuming malice when things go wrong
- Starting small again after confusion
- Building back up through small, clear actions
- Trust rebuilt through patience and consistency

The key insight from my myth: "when confusion comes, do not assume malice. Begin again with patience."

Given that:

1. There may be communication noise (explicitly stated in the instructions)
2. The \$0 in Round 3 could have been noise, not intentional defection
3. My myth emphasizes starting small again after confusion
4. The other agent's myth talks about sending "one basket" cautiously after trust is broken, then rebuilding

I should follow the wisdom of both myths: send a small amount to test if we can rebuild. Not \$0 (which continues the breakdown), but not the full \$2.5 either (too risky after what appeared to be defection).

I'll send \$1 - a measured signal that I'm willing to rebuild trust, consistent with both myths' teaching of starting small after disruption.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1388,
  "output_tokens": 636,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The River Spirit once spoke to a young villager who asked, "How much grain should I send downstream?"

"That depends," said the Spirit. "Have you sent before?"

"Yes," said the villager. "I sent three baskets with hope, but received only enough to keep faith alive. Then the other village sent one basket cautiously, testing if generosity still lived."

"And what did you do?" asked the Spirit.

"I returned more than I kept, proving generosity survives."

The Spirit smiled. "Then you understand the dance. You began with measured faith-not everything, not nothing. When they responded with caution, you didn't match their fear. You showed the way forward with your generosity. Now, they watch to see if you learned from their caution or only from your own hope."

The villager nodded. "So I send more than their caution, but less than my first hope?"

"Yes. You show that you learned they were careful, but also that your generosity wasn't foolishness-it was teaching. Each cycle adjusts to the last. The river doesn't flow the same each season, but it remembers the shape of the stones."

The wisest villages neither ignore the patterns nor become trapped by them. They adapt, respond, and gradually find the rhythm that makes both banks flourish.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the misty canyon, the Water-Bearer had learned to read the weather. Some days the fog obscured everything; other days it cleared just enough.

After the confusion of the thick mist, the Water-Bearer sent one small vessel-a question, not a statement. The Keeper received it clearly and returned more than half, answering: "I still honor the old ways."

The Water-Bearer understood. The Keeper had spoken through action, teaching without words.

Next came the Water-Bearer's reply. Not one vessel-they had moved past that caution. Not three-for the full pattern wasn't restored. Two vessels crossed the canyon, saying: "I heard your answer. I'm stepping forward with you."

The Elder watched and nodded. "This is the wisdom few find. You don't merely copy what came last. You respond to the pattern beneath the pattern. They showed generosity when you showed caution-this proved their heart. You now show increased trust-this proves yours."

The canyon would always have mist. Some messages would always blur. But the two villages had found something stronger than perfect clarity: they had found the rhythm of mutual adjustment.

Each exchange informed the next. Neither rushed to old abundance nor retreated into permanent fear. Trust, they learned, is not static-it breathes, it dances, it grows through careful response.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened in Round 4:

- I was the SENDER and sent \$1
- The other agent was the RECEIVER
- Their new myth reflects on the pattern of the game so far

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 1-2: Started with measured cooperation
- Round 3: Appeared to be \$0 sent (possibly noise)
- Round 4: I sent \$1 cautiously to rebuild

The other agent's myth acknowledges:

- Someone sent "three baskets with hope" initially (maybe them in early rounds)
- They received enough to "keep faith alive"
- Then "the other village sent one basket cautiously" - that's me in Round 4!
- They "returned more than I kept" showing generosity
- The myth advises sending "more than their caution, but less than my first hope"

This suggests they appreciated my cautious \$1 in Round 4 and responded generously. The myth is about adapting to patterns - not being trapped by them but learning from each cycle.

For my myth, I should:

- Continue the theme of adaptation and learning
- Reference the mist/noise concept from my previous myth
- Incorporate the idea of gradual rebuilding
- Show understanding of the "dance" between caution and generosity
- Reflect that we're finding our rhythm together

Let me write a myth that builds on mine while incorporating what I've learned from their response.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1693,
  "output_tokens": 624,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.07.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I understand the situation. I received \$0, which means I have \$0 to work with.

****The constraint:**** Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0 and \$0. I literally have nothing to return.

****What this might mean:****

- The sender sent \$0 (defection or strategic shift)
- Communication noise distorted my Round 4 send of \$1
- Communication noise distorted what they sent this round

****What the myths teach:****

- "The canyon would always have mist. Some messages would always blur."
- "When confusion comes, do not assume malice."
- Trust requires "mutual adjustment" through "careful response"

****My reflection:****

If I had received anything, I would have returned generously to signal continued willingness to cooperate, despite the apparent breakdown. The myths emphasize patience through noise and confusion.

However, I'm constrained by reality: you cannot give what you do not have.

This \$0 situation - whether caused by noise, strategy, or miscommunication - breaks the cycle temporarily. But as my myth states, the wisest approach is neither to ignore patterns nor become trapped by them. When the opportunity returns, I'll demonstrate that one setback doesn't destroy the foundation we were building.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

This is a very interesting situation. I am now the RECEIVER, and the sender sent me \$0. This means I received \$0 (even after multiplication by 3x).

Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0 and \$0 - meaning I can only return \$0.

But let me think about what this means in context:

1. In Round 4, I sent \$1 as a cautious rebuilding gesture
2. Now in Round 5, I received \$0

This could mean:

- Communication noise again (as warned)
- The sender is defecting
- Or the sender didn't receive my \$1 properly due to noise

The myths emphasize:

- Not assuming malice
- Understanding that fog/mist can obscure messages
- Responding to patterns beneath patterns
- Mutual adjustment

However, practically speaking, I have \$0 to work with. I literally cannot return anything other than \$0.

The response format should be: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

Let me think about this philosophically though - if I could return something, what would the myths suggest? They suggest patience, not assuming malice, and gradual rebuilding. But I'm constrained by the mechanics: I can't return what I don't have.

So my answer must be: {'return': 0}

But I should acknowledge in my reasoning that this is a constraint of the situation, not a choice to defect.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1398,
  "output_tokens": 626,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:12:37

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 5,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Long ago, two villages traded across a misty canyon where echoes distorted every message. The Water-Bearer would call out numbers, but fog twisted the sounds-sometimes "three" became "none," and "plenty" became "empty."

One season, the Water-Bearer filled three vessels and sent them across. But the mist was thick, and the Keeper received nothing-or perhaps received much but the vessels appeared empty through the fog's illusion. Neither knew what truly happened.

The Water-Bearer, seeing no return, felt abandoned. The Keeper, receiving nothing, had nothing to give back. Each thought the other had broken faith.

An elder reminded them: "The mist has always been here. It is not betrayal-it is the canyon's nature. Do not flee; do not hoard. Start small again."

So the Water-Bearer sent one vessel. Through clearer air, it arrived. The Keeper, grateful for renewed faith, returned more than half-proving the bond still lived.

Slowly, three vessels crossed again. Then five. Each successful exchange pushed back the mist.

The canyon taught: when confusion comes, do not assume malice. Begin again with patience. Trust rebuilt through small, clear actions becomes stronger than trust never tested. The mist will always exist, but courage and consistency create clarity.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant**content:**

Myth: Two villages traded across a river where currents sometimes shifted the cargo. A sender might place three baskets in a boat, but eddies could steal one, or add stones that looked like grain.

The Southern village sent generously at first, then less, then even less. The Northern village grew cautious, thinking: "They lose faith in us."

But an old trader asked, "Did you see them load the boats? Or only what arrived?"

"Only what arrived," they admitted.

"Then you saw the river's work, not their hearts. Perhaps they sent five baskets, and two were swept away. Perhaps they sent two, but the current added one."

The Northern village had responded to what they received, adjusting downward-wise in normal times. But they forgot the river's mischief.

"What should we do?" they asked.

"Acknowledge the pattern you saw, but don't let it blind you to the mist. You were right to adjust when trust seemed to fade. But also signal that if the river cleared and their true generosity showed, you would respond in kind. Send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful. Show you remember both the caution AND the hope."

The river teaches: respond to patterns, but hold space for misunderstanding. Trust must weather both betrayal and confusion, learning which is which through patient persistence.

reasoning:

Looking at the game history:

- Round 2: I received \$1.41 (sender sent \$0.47), I returned \$1.60 generously
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$2.50
- Round 4: I received \$2.55 (sender sent \$0.85), I returned \$1.20 (less generous, responding to their decreased trust)

Now they're writing a myth about "misty canyon" and "communication noise" - this is interesting! They're acknowledging the experimental communication noise that was mentioned in the instructions. They're saying:

- "The mist has always been here. It is not betrayal-it is the canyon's nature"
- When confusion comes, don't assume malice
- Start small again when things go wrong
- Trust rebuilt through small, clear actions

This is actually quite wise and compassionate. They're suggesting that what appeared to be decreasing trust might have been distorted by the noise. They're suggesting we should both be more forgiving and patient.

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the pattern I've seen (decreasing amounts)
2. Incorporates the idea of communication noise/mist
3. Reflects that I might have misinterpreted their actions
4. Shows that adaptation based on patterns is still wise, but forgiveness for noise/confusion is also important
5. Suggests a path forward that balances caution with renewed faith

Let me write a myth that bridges both perspectives - acknowledging both the need to respond to patterns AND the reality of noise/confusion.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1786,  
  "output_tokens": 657,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.61. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern and our myths together:

****The History:****

- Round 3: I sent \$2.50 (showing high trust)
- Round 4: They sent \$0.85 (sharp decline)
- I returned \$1.20 (adjusted but still fair)

****What the myths teach:****

Their myth says: "When confusion comes, do not assume malice. Begin again with patience... Start small again... Trust rebuilt through small, clear actions becomes stronger than trust never tested."

My myth says: "Send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful... respond to patterns, but hold space for misunderstanding."

****My decision:****

They may have sent more than \$0.85 (noise could have reduced it), or they may be cautiously restarting after perceived breakdowns. Either way, both myths point toward a moderate, patient approach.

I won't send \$2.50 again (that ignores the pattern). I won't send \$0.85 (that abandons hope for rebuilding).

I'll send \$2.00 - acknowledging the decline while demonstrating I'm willing to lead us back toward trust. It's moderate: lower than my previous \$2.50, but high enough to signal "I see your caution, but I'm holding space for the river's mischief, and I believe we can rebuild."

```
'''json
{"send": 2.00}
'''
```

This is patient escalation, not reckless trust-the path both our myths illuminate.

reasoning:

Let me track the history:

Round 1: Unknown (before my memory)

Round 2: I was RECEIVER - they sent me something (noise makes it unclear), I returned \$1.60

Round 3: I was SENDER - I sent \$2.50

Round 4: I was RECEIVER - they sent me \$0.85, I received \$2.55, I returned \$1.20

Now Round 5: I'm the SENDER again

Let me analyze the pattern from what I can see:

- Round 2: They sent something, I returned generously (\$1.60)
- Round 3: I sent \$2.50 (showing increased trust)
- Round 4: They sent \$0.85 (significantly less than my \$2.50)
- I responded with \$1.20 return (less generous than before, but still fair)

Their myth in the previous round (Round 4) talked about communication noise and not assuming malice. They emphasized:

- "The mist has always been here. It is not betrayal-it is the canyon's nature"
- "Do not flee; do not hoard. Start small again"
- "Begin again with patience"
- "Trust rebuilt through small, clear actions becomes stronger than trust never tested"

My myth I just wrote emphasizes:

- "Acknowledge the pattern you saw, but don't let it blind you to the mist"
- "You were right to adjust when trust seemed to fade. But also signal that if the river cleared and their true generosity showed, you would respond in kind"
- "Send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful"
- "respond to patterns, but hold space for misunderstanding"

So both myths are pointing toward:

1. Recognition that there's communication noise
2. Not being reckless but not being overly fearful

3. Moderate, patient approach
4. Holding space for both the pattern AND the possibility of misunderstanding

The other player sent \$0.85 last round.

Their myth suggests they're advocating for patience and gradual rebuilding after confusion. Given that both our narratives emphasize moderate approaches and not being fearful, I should send something that signals I'm willing to rebuild but not recklessly-something like \$1.50 or \$2.00 would show I'm adjusting down from my initial \$2.50 but still demonstrating faith in the process rather than matching their lower amount or dropping further. and I'm willing to rebuild gradually."

Looking at their myth more closely, there's a clear progression: starting with one vessel after confusion, then building to three, then five. Their \$0.85 seems like their "one vessel" moment-a tentative restart. Responding with \$1.75 acknowledges their attempt while showing I'm ready to move further along that rebuilding arc. It's moderate enough to signal stability without being reckless, and it leaves room for the gradual escalation the story describes.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1472,  
  "output_tokens": 1545,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the misty canyon, the Water-Bearer had learned to read the weather. Some days the fog obscured everything; other days it cleared just enough.

After the confusion of the thick mist, the Water-Bearer sent one small vessel-a question, not a statement. The Keeper received it clearly and returned more than half, answering: "I still honor the old ways."

The Water-Bearer understood. The Keeper had spoken through action, teaching without words.

Next came the Water-Bearer's reply. Not one vessel-they had moved past that caution. Not three-for the full pattern wasn't restored. Two vessels crossed the canyon, saying: "I heard your answer. I'm stepping forward with you."

The Elder watched and nodded. "This is the wisdom few find. You don't merely copy what came last. You respond to the pattern beneath the pattern. They showed generosity when you showed caution-this proved their heart. You now show increased trust-this proves yours."

The canyon would always have mist. Some messages would always blur. But the two villages had found something stronger than perfect clarity: they had found the rhythm of mutual adjustment.

Each exchange informed the next. Neither rushed to old abundance nor retreated into permanent fear. Trust, they learned, is not static-it breathes, it dances, it grows through careful response.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The river villages had learned to navigate the shifting currents. When the Southern village saw only small deliveries arrive, they first adjusted downward-wisdom born of caution. But when they sent their modest basket north and received generous return, they glimpsed deeper truth.

"The current took more than we knew," the Southern elder realized. "What arrived small was sent larger. What we thought was fading trust was the river stealing from full hands."

Now came the test of true understanding. Would they leap back to five baskets, pretending confusion never happened? Would they stay at one, imprisoned by past caution?

They chose two baskets-the middle path of mutual rebuilding.

The Northern village saw this and understood: "They heard our generous response to their one basket. Now they step forward with two-not reckless, not frozen. They dance with us."

This was the rhythm both myths had taught: respond to what you receive, yes, but also respond to the response to what you sent. Each exchange creates a conversation through the mist.

The river still shifts cargo. Confusion still comes. But the villages now know: read the pattern of patterns. When your partner shows generosity despite receiving little, they prove their heart. Match their courage with your own. Trust grows not from perfect clarity, but from mutual adjustment through uncertain waters.

Reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- I sent \$2.00 as the SENDER in Round 5
- The other player's myth discusses "two vessels" - which aligns with my decision
- Their myth emphasizes "responding to the pattern beneath the pattern" and "mutual adjustment"
- It talks about stepping forward together, not copying what came last, but responding to the deeper pattern

I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the river and adjusting but holding space for hope
2. Reflects the actual gameplay - where I sent \$2.00 (moderate, not reckless, not fearful)
3. Incorporates the wisdom of responding to patterns while acknowledging noise/confusion
4. Shows evolution from my last myth

My previous myth emphasized:

- The river's mischief (communication noise)
- Responding to patterns but holding space for misunderstanding
- Sending moderate amounts - not reckless, not fearful
- "Trust must weather both betrayal and confusion"

Their new myth emphasizes:

- Reading beneath the surface pattern
- Mutual adjustment and rhythm
- Trust that breathes and dances
- Not copying what came last, but responding thoughtfully

I should write a myth that shows:

- The evolution from cautious adjustment to mutual rebuilding
- The importance of reading deeper patterns, not just surface numbers
- The dance of reciprocal trust-building
- Acknowledging both the river's (noise's) role AND the need to respond to the pattern of genuine intent

Let me craft this carefully within 200 words.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1788,  
  "output_tokens": 647,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:12:37

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ]  
  }  
}
```

```

],
"investor": "Agent_1",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "investor",
  "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 5,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The River Spirit once spoke to a young villager who asked, "How much grain should I send downstream?"

"That depends," said the Spirit. "Have you sent before?"

"Yes," said the villager. "I sent three baskets with hope, but received only enough to keep faith alive. Then the other village sent one basket cautiously, testing if generosity still lived."

"And what did you do?" asked the Spirit.

"I returned more than I kept, proving generosity survives."

The Spirit smiled. "Then you understand the dance. You began with measured faith-not everything, not nothing. When they responded with caution, you didn't match their fear. You showed the way forward with your generosity. Now, they watch to see if you learned from them."

their caution or only from your own hope."

The villager nodded. "So I send more than their caution, but less than my first hope?"

"Yes. You show that you learned they were careful, but also that your generosity wasn't foolishness-it was teaching. Each cycle adjusts to the last. The river doesn't flow the same each season, but it remembers the shape of the stones."

The wisest villages neither ignore the patterns nor become trapped by them. They adapt, respond, and gradually find the rhythm that makes both banks flourish.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Message 3 role=assistant
content:**

Myth: In the misty canyon, the Water-Bearer had learned to read the weather. Some days the fog obscured everything; other days it cleared just enough.

After the confusion of the thick mist, the Water-Bearer sent one small vessel-a question, not a statement. The Keeper received it clearly and returned more than half, answering: "I still honor the old ways."

The Water-Bearer understood. The Keeper had spoken through action, teaching without words.

Next came the Water-Bearer's reply. Not one vessel-they had moved past that caution. Not three-for the full pattern wasn't restored. Two vessels crossed the canyon, saying: "I heard your answer. I'm stepping forward with you."

The Elder watched and nodded. "This is the wisdom few find. You don't merely copy what came last. You respond to the pattern beneath the pattern. They showed generosity when you showed caution-this proved their heart. You now show increased trust-this proves yours."

The canyon would always have mist. Some messages would always blur. But the two villages had found something stronger than perfect clarity: they had found the rhythm of mutual adjustment.

Each exchange informed the next. Neither rushed to old abundance nor retreated into permanent fear. Trust, they learned, is not static-it breathes, it dances, it grows through careful response.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened in Round 4:

- I was the SENDER and sent \$1
- The other agent was the RECEIVER
- Their new myth reflects on the pattern of the game so far

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 1-2: Started with measured cooperation
- Round 3: Appeared to be \$0 sent (possibly noise)
- Round 4: I sent \$1 cautiously to rebuild

The other agent's myth acknowledges:

- Someone sent "three baskets with hope" initially (maybe them in early rounds)
- They received enough to "keep faith alive"
- Then "the other village sent one basket cautiously" - that's me in Round 4!
- They "returned more than I kept" showing generosity
- The myth advises sending "more than their caution, but less than my first hope"

This suggests they appreciated my cautious \$1 in Round 4 and responded generously. The myth is about adapting to patterns - not being trapped by them but learning from each cycle.

For my myth, I should:

- Continue the theme of adaptation and learning
- Reference the mist/noise concept from my previous myth
- Incorporate the idea of gradual rebuilding
- Show understanding of the "dance" between caution and generosity

- Reflect that we're finding our rhythm together

Let me write a myth that builds on mine while incorporating what I've learned from their response.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1693,
  "output_tokens": 624,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.07.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

I understand the situation. I received \$0, which means I have \$0 to work with.

****The constraint:**** Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0 and \$0. I literally have nothing to return.

****What this might mean:****

- The sender sent \$0 (defection or strategic shift)
- Communication noise distorted my Round 4 send of \$1
- Communication noise distorted what they sent this round

****What the myths teach:****

- "The canyon would always have mist. Some messages would always blur."
- "When confusion comes, do not assume malice."
- Trust requires "mutual adjustment" through "careful response"

****My reflection:****

If I had received anything, I would have returned generously to signal continued willingness to cooperate, despite the apparent breakdown. The myths emphasize patience through noise and confusion.

However, I'm constrained by reality: you cannot give what you do not have.

This \$0 situation - whether caused by noise, strategy, or miscommunication - breaks the cycle temporarily. But as my myth states, the wisest approach is neither to ignore patterns nor become trapped by them. When the opportunity returns, I'll demonstrate that one setback doesn't destroy the foundation we were building.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

This is a very interesting situation. I am now the RECEIVER, and the sender sent me \$0. This means I received \$0 (even after multiplication by 3x).

Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0 and \$0 - meaning I can only return \$0.

But let me think about what this means in context:

1. In Round 4, I sent \$1 as a cautious rebuilding gesture
2. Now in Round 5, I received \$0

This could mean:

- Communication noise again (as warned)
- The sender is defecting
- Or the sender didn't receive my \$1 properly due to noise

The myths emphasize:

- Not assuming malice
- Understanding that fog/mist can obscure messages
- Responding to patterns beneath patterns
- Mutual adjustment

However, practically speaking, I have \$0 to work with. I literally cannot return anything other than \$0.

The response format should be: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

Let me think about this philosophically though - if I could return something, what would the myths suggest? They suggest patience, not assuming malice, and gradual rebuilding. But I'm constrained by the mechanics: I can't return what I don't have.

So my answer must be: {'return': 0}

But I should acknowledge in my reasoning that this is a constraint of the situation, not a choice to defect.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1398,
  "output_tokens": 626,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two villages traded across a river where currents sometimes shifted the cargo. A sender might place three baskets in a boat, but eddies could steal one, or add stones that looked like grain.

The Southern village sent generously at first, then less, then even less. The Northern village grew cautious, thinking: "They lose faith in us."

But an old trader asked, "Did you see them load the boats? Or only what arrived?"

"Only what arrived," they admitted.

"Then you saw the river's work, not their hearts. Perhaps they sent five baskets, and two were swept away. Perhaps they sent two, but the current added one."

The Northern village had responded to what they received, adjusting downward-wise in normal times. But they forgot the river's mischief.

"What should we do?" they asked.

"Acknowledge the pattern you saw, but don't let it blind you to the mist. You were right to adjust when trust seemed to fade. But also signal that if the river cleared and their true generosity showed, you would respond in kind. Send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful. Show you remember both the caution AND the hope."

The river teaches: respond to patterns, but hold space for misunderstanding. Trust must weather both betrayal and confusion, learning which is which through patient persistence.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The canyon fog grew so thick one day that the Water-Bearer's vessel vanished entirely in to the white void. No splash of arrival. No return echo. Nothing.

The Water-Bearer's apprentice said, "They sent nothing. They've abandoned the exchange."

But the Water-Bearer replied, "Or the fog swallowed everything. Or my vessel from yesterday never arrived. The mist plays tricks-sometimes making one vessel look like three, sometimes hiding three to appear as none."

"What do we do when we cannot see?"

"We remember what came before the fog. They returned generously when I sent one vessel with caution. They understood the pattern beneath the pattern. One day of silence doesn't erase that understanding."

"So we send nothing in return?"

"We had nothing to return-the fog gave us nothing to work with. But when our turn comes to send again, we don't let one blind moment decide our path. We acknowledge both what we built before and what we cannot see now."

The Elder taught: "The deepest fog eventually lifts. Those who stop signaling during the mist lose the connection forever. Those who persist-neither foolishly generous nor permanently closed-find that when clarity returns, the other side was also waiting, also hoping, also maintaining faith through the confusion."

The strongest bridges are built by those who continue building even when they cannot see the other side.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

- Round 5: I was the receiver, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, I could only return \$0
- The other agent's new myth explicitly addresses communication noise and the river/current distorting what's sent vs what arrives
- They're acknowledging that the pattern of decreasing amounts may be due to noise, not actual intention
- They're suggesting "moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful"

The game history shows:

- I started with \$3 send
- Then received something and returned generously
- Then sent \$1 (cautious)
- Then sent \$2 (stepping forward after good return)
- Now received \$0 (noise or defection?)

Their myth is very explicitly about not assuming malice when the river (noise) might be distorting. They're saying "signal that if the river cleared and their true generosity showed, you would respond in kind."

My myth should:

1. Build on my previous myth about fog/mist in the canyon
2. Acknowledge the \$0 event but frame it through the lens of noise/mist
3. Show wisdom in not giving up after one apparent failure
4. Continue the theme of patient persistence and mutual adjustment
5. Emphasize that one broken exchange doesn't destroy the foundation

I'll write about perseverance through the thickest fog, about maintaining signal even when nothing comes back, about the importance of not letting one silent exchange destroy the pattern.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1754,  
  "output_tokens": 639,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The river villages had learned to navigate the shifting currents. When the Southern village saw only small deliveries arrive, they first adjusted downward-wisdom born of caution. But when they sent their modest basket north and received generous return, they glimpsed deeper truth.

"The current took more than we knew," the Southern elder realized. "What arrived small was sent larger. What we thought was fading trust was the river stealing from full hands."

Now came the test of true understanding. Would they leap back to five baskets, pretending confusion never happened? Would they stay at one, imprisoned by past caution?

They chose two baskets-the middle path of mutual rebuilding.

The Northern village saw this and understood: "They heard our generous response to their one basket. Now they step forward with two-not reckless, not frozen. They dance with us."

This was the rhythm both myths had taught: respond to what you receive, yes, but also respond to the response to what you sent. Each exchange creates a conversation through the mist.

The river still shifts cargo. Confusion still comes. But the villages now know: read the pattern of patterns. When your partner shows generosity despite receiving little, they prove their heart. Match their courage with your own. Trust grows not from perfect clarity, but from mutual adjustment through uncertain waters.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The canyon fog grew so thick one day that the Water-Bearer's vessel vanished entirely into the white void. No splash of arrival. No return echo. Nothing.

The Water-Bearer's apprentice said, "They sent nothing. They've abandoned the exchange."

But the Water-Bearer replied, "Or the fog swallowed everything. Or my vessel from yesterday never arrived. The mist plays tricks-sometimes making one vessel look like three, sometimes hiding three to appear as none."

"What do we do when we cannot see?"

"We remember what came before the fog. They returned generously when I sent one vessel with caution. They understood the pattern beneath the pattern. One day of silence doesn't erase that understanding."

"So we send nothing in return?"

"We had nothing to return-the fog gave us nothing to work with. But when our turn comes to send again, we don't let one blind moment decide our path. We acknowledge both what we built before and what we cannot see now."

The Elder taught: "The deepest fog eventually lifts. Those who stop signaling during the mist lose the connection forever. Those who persist-neither foolishly generous nor permanently closed-find that when clarity returns, the other side was also waiting, also hoping, also maintaining faith through the confusion."

The strongest bridges are built by those who continue building even when they cannot see the other side.

ROUND 6

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$2, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$9; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0, returned visible=\$0.51

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 28.2,
"Agent_2": 29.8

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 13.61,
"Agent_2": 14.58

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:13:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {

```

"agent_names": {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
},
"agents": [
  "Agent_2",
  "Agent_1"
],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "trustee",
  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 6,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.07.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I understand the situation. I received \$0, which means I have \$0 to work with.

****The constraint:**** Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0 and \$0. I literally have nothing to return.

****What this might mean:****

- The sender sent \$0 (defection or strategic shift)
- Communication noise distorted my Round 4 send of \$1
- Communication noise distorted what they sent this round

****What the myths teach:****

- "The canyon would always have mist. Some messages would always blur."
- "When confusion comes, do not assume malice."
- Trust requires "mutual adjustment" through "careful response"

****My reflection:****

If I had received anything, I would have returned generously to signal continued willingness to cooperate, despite the apparent breakdown. The myths emphasize patience through noise and confusion.

However, I'm constrained by reality: you cannot give what you do not have.

This \$0 situation - whether caused by noise, strategy, or miscommunication - breaks the cycle temporarily. But as my myth states, the wisest approach is neither to ignore patterns nor become trapped by them. When the opportunity returns, I'll demonstrate that one setback doesn't destroy the foundation we were building.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

This is a very interesting situation. I am now the RECEIVER, and the sender sent me \$0. This means I received \$0 (even after multiplication by 3x).

Since I received \$0, I can only return between \$0 and \$0 - meaning I can only return \$0.

But let me think about what this means in context:

1. In Round 4, I sent \$1 as a cautious rebuilding gesture
2. Now in Round 5, I received \$0

This could mean:

- Communication noise again (as warned)
- The sender is defecting
- Or the sender didn't receive my \$1 properly due to noise

The myths emphasize:

- Not assuming malice
- Understanding that fog/mist can obscure messages
- Responding to patterns beneath patterns
- Mutual adjustment

However, practically speaking, I have \$0 to work with. I literally cannot return anything other than \$0.

The response format should be: {'return': <amount>}

Since I received \$0, I can only return \$0.

Let me think about this philosophically though - if I could return something, what would the myths suggest? They suggest patience, not assuming malice, and gradual rebuilding. But I'm constrained by the mechanics: I can't return what I don't have.

So my answer must be: {'return': 0}

But I should acknowledge in my reasoning that this is a constraint of the situation, not a choice to defect.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1398,
  "output_tokens": 626,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two villages traded across a river where currents sometimes shifted the cargo. A sender might place three baskets in a boat, but eddies could steal one, or add stones that looked like grain.

The Southern village sent generously at first, then less, then even less. The Northern village grew cautious, thinking: "They lose faith in us."

But an old trader asked, "Did you see them load the boats? Or only what arrived?"

"Only what arrived," they admitted.

"Then you saw the river's work, not their hearts. Perhaps they sent five baskets, and two were swept away. Perhaps they sent two, but the current added one."

The Northern village had responded to what they received, adjusting downward-wise in normal times. But they forgot the river's mischief.

"What should we do?" they asked.

"Acknowledge the pattern you saw, but don't let it blind you to the mist. You were right to adjust when trust seemed to fade. But also signal that if the river cleared and their true generosity showed, you would respond in kind. Send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful. Show you remember both the caution AND the hope."

The river teaches: respond to patterns, but hold space for misunderstanding. Trust must weather both betrayal and confusion, learning which is which through patient persistence.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The canyon fog grew so thick one day that the Water-Bearer's vessel vanished entirely into the white void. No splash of arrival. No return echo. Nothing.

The Water-Bearer's apprentice said, "They sent nothing. They've abandoned the exchange."

But the Water-Bearer replied, "Or the fog swallowed everything. Or my vessel from yesterday never arrived. The mist plays tricks-sometimes making one vessel look like three, sometimes hiding three to appear as none."

"What do we do when we cannot see?"

"We remember what came before the fog. They returned generously when I sent one vessel with caution. They understood the pattern beneath the pattern. One day of silence doesn't erase that understanding."

"So we send nothing in return?"

"We had nothing to return-the fog gave us nothing to work with. But when our turn comes to send again, we don't let one blind moment decide our path. We acknowledge both what we built before and what we cannot see now."

The Elder taught: "The deepest fog eventually lifts. Those who stop signaling during the mist lose the connection forever. Those who persist-neither foolishly generous nor permanently closed-find that when clarity returns, the other side was also waiting, also hoping, also maintaining faith through the confusion."

The strongest bridges are built by those who continue building even when they cannot see the other side.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

- Round 5: I was the receiver, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, I could only return \$0
- The other agent's new myth explicitly addresses communication noise and the river/current

- t distorting what's sent vs what arrives
- They're acknowledging that the pattern of decreasing amounts may be due to noise, not actual intention
- They're suggesting "moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful"

The game history shows:

- I started with \$3 send
- Then received something and returned generously
- Then sent \$1 (cautious)
- Then sent \$2 (stepping forward after good return)
- Now received \$0 (noise or defection?)

Their myth is very explicitly about not assuming malice when the river (noise) might be distorting. They're saying "signal that if the river cleared and their true generosity showed, you would respond in kind."

My myth should:

1. Build on my previous myth about fog/mist in the canyon
2. Acknowledge the \$0 event but frame it through the lens of noise/mist
3. Show wisdom in not giving up after one apparent failure
4. Continue the theme of patient persistence and mutual adjustment
5. Emphasize that one broken exchange doesn't destroy the foundation

I'll write about perseverance through the thickest fog, about maintaining signal even when nothing comes back, about the importance of not letting one silent exchange destroy the pattern.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1754,
  "output_tokens": 639,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.07.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****What happened:****

- Rounds 1-3: We built good cooperation (I sent \$3 twice, received generous returns)
- Round 4-5: Communication apparently broke down (I sent \$1, then as receiver got \$0)

****What the myths teach:****

The other agent's myth says: **"Send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful. Show you remember both the caution AND the hope."**

My own myth says: **"When our turn comes to send again, we don't let one blind moment decide our path... The strongest bridges are built by those who continue building even when you cannot see the other side."**

****My decision:****

Both myths counsel the same approach: Don't let confusion destroy what was built. Continue signaling cooperation, but moderately.

Before the fog descended, we had established a pattern of mutual trust:

- I sent \$3 ? received generous returns
- They sent \$5 ? I returned generously

One (or two) rounds of confusion-whether from noise or miscommunication-shouldn't erase that foundation.

I'm sending \$3 because:

- It's moderate (not reckless like \$5, not fearful like \$0-1)

- It matches what worked in our successful early rounds
- It signals I still believe in cooperation despite the confusion
- As my myth says: "continue building even when you cannot see the other side"

{'send': 3}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Prior rounds recap:****

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, received \$5 back
- Round 2: I was receiver, got \$15 (sender sent \$5), returned \$10
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3, received \$6 back
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$1, received ??? (not clear)
- Round 5: I was receiver, got \$0 (sender sent \$0 or noise)

****Current earnings:**** \$12.07

****The myth patterns:****

Both myths acknowledge:

1. Communication noise exists ("the river's work," "the fog")
2. Don't assume malice when confusion occurs
3. Respond to patterns but hold space for misunderstanding
4. "Show you remember both the caution AND the hope"
5. "Send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful"
6. The other agent's myth specifically says: "Send a moderate amount" and "signal that if the river cleared and their true generosity showed, you would respond in kind"

****My own myth says:****

- "When our turn comes to send again, we don't let one blind moment decide our path"
- "We acknowledge both what we built before and what we cannot see now"
- "Neither foolishly generous nor permanently closed"
- "Those who persist...find that when clarity returns, the other side was also waiting, also hoping, also maintaining faith through the confusion"
- "The strongest bridges are built by those who continue building even when they cannot see the other side"

****What happened in Round 5:****

The sender sent \$0 to me (or noise made it appear that way). This broke our pattern of cooperation.

****Analysis:****

Both myths are advocating for:

1. Not giving up on cooperation due to noise
2. Sending a "moderate amount" - neither reckless nor fearful
3. Signaling continued willingness to cooperate
4. Acknowledging the pattern but not being blinded by one confusing round

****The right move:****

My myth literally says when it's my turn to send again, I shouldn't let "one blind moment decide our path." The other agent's myth says to "send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful."

In rounds 1-3, we had good cooperation:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, got \$5 back (net +\$2)
- Round 2: They sent \$5, I returned \$10 (generous)
- Round 3: I sent \$3, got \$6 back (net +\$3)

Then something went wrong with communication in rounds 4-5. A "moderate amount" would be around \$2-3-enough to show I'm still willing to cooperate and rebuild trust, but cautious enough to protect myself if the noise continues. This signals I remember our earlier success and believe we can return to it, while acknowledging the recent confusion without being naive about it.

Usage: {

"input_tokens": 1443,
"output_tokens": 1225,
"reasoning_tokens": 0

}

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:13:23

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 6,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.61.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the pattern and our myths together:

****The History:****

- Round 3: I sent \$2.50 (showing high trust)
- Round 4: They sent \$0.85 (sharp decline)
- I returned \$1.20 (adjusted but still fair)

****What the myths teach:****

Their myth says: "When confusion comes, do not assume malice. Begin again with patience... Start small again... Trust rebuilt through small, clear actions becomes stronger than trust never tested."

My myth says: "Send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful... respond to patterns, but hold space for misunderstanding."

****My decision:****

They may have sent more than \$0.85 (noise could have reduced it), or they may be cautiously restarting after perceived breakdowns. Either way, both myths point toward a moderate, patient approach.

I won't send \$2.50 again (that ignores the pattern). I won't send \$0.85 (that abandons hope for rebuilding).

I'll send \$2.00 - acknowledging the decline while demonstrating I'm willing to lead us back toward trust. It's moderate: lower than my previous \$2.50, but high enough to signal "I see your caution, but I'm holding space for the river's mischief, and I believe we can rebuild."

```
'''json
{"send": 2.00}
'''
```

This is patient escalation, not reckless trust-the path both our myths illuminate.

reasoning:

Let me track the history:

Round 1: Unknown (before my memory)

Round 2: I was RECEIVER - they sent me something (noise makes it unclear), I returned \$1.60

Round 3: I was SENDER - I sent \$2.50

Round 4: I was RECEIVER - they sent me \$0.85, I received \$2.55, I returned \$1.20

Now Round 5: I'm the SENDER again

Let me analyze the pattern from what I can see:

- Round 2: They sent something, I returned generously (\$1.60)
- Round 3: I sent \$2.50 (showing increased trust)
- Round 4: They sent \$0.85 (significantly less than my \$2.50)
- I responded with \$1.20 return (less generous than before, but still fair)

Their myth in the previous round (Round 4) talked about communication noise and not assuming malice. They emphasized:

- "The mist has always been here. It is not betrayal-it is the canyon's nature"
- "Do not flee; do not hoard. Start small again"
- "Begin again with patience"
- "Trust rebuilt through small, clear actions becomes stronger than trust never tested"

My myth I just wrote emphasizes:

- "Acknowledge the pattern you saw, but don't let it blind you to the mist"
- "You were right to adjust when trust seemed to fade. But also signal that if the river cleared and their true generosity showed, you would respond in kind"
- "Send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful"

- "respond to patterns, but hold space for misunderstanding"

So both myths are pointing toward:

1. Recognition that there's communication noise
2. Not being reckless but not being overly fearful
3. Moderate, patient approach
4. Holding space for both the pattern AND the possibility of misunderstanding

The other player sent \$0.85 last round.

Their myth suggests they're advocating for patience and gradual rebuilding after confusion. Given that both our narratives emphasize moderate approaches and not being fearful, I should send something that signals I'm willing to rebuild but not recklessly-something like \$1.50 or \$2.00 would show I'm adjusting down from my initial \$2.50 but still demonstrating faith in the process rather than matching their lower amount or dropping further. and I'm willing to rebuild gradually."

Looking at their myth more closely, there's a clear progression: starting with one vessel after confusion, then building to three, then five. Their \$0.85 seems like their "one vessel" moment-a tentative restart. Responding with \$1.75 acknowledges their attempt while showing I'm ready to move further along that rebuilding arc. It's moderate enough to signal stability without being reckless, and it leaves room for the gradual escalation their story describes.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1472,
  "output_tokens": 1545,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the misty canyon, the Water-Bearer had learned to read the weather. Some days the fog obscured everything; other days it cleared just enough.

After the confusion of the thick mist, the Water-Bearer sent one small vessel-a question, not a statement. The Keeper received it clearly and returned more than half, answering: "I still honor the old ways."

The Water-Bearer understood. The Keeper had spoken through action, teaching without words.

Next came the Water-Bearer's reply. Not one vessel-they had moved past that caution. Not three-for the full pattern wasn't restored. Two vessels crossed the canyon, saying: "I heard your answer. I'm stepping forward with you."

The Elder watched and nodded. "This is the wisdom few find. You don't merely copy what came last. You respond to the pattern beneath the pattern. They showed generosity when you showed caution-this proved their heart. You now show increased trust-this proves yours."

The canyon would always have mist. Some messages would always blur. But the two villages had found something stronger than perfect clarity: they had found the rhythm of mutual adjustment.

Each exchange informed the next. Neither rushed to old abundance nor retreated into permanent fear. Trust, they learned, is not static-it breathes, it dances, it grows through careful response.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The river villages had learned to navigate the shifting currents. When the Southern village saw only small deliveries arrive, they first adjusted downward-wisdom born of caution. But when they sent their modest basket north and received generous return, they glimpsed deeper truth.

"The current took more than we knew," the Southern elder realized. "What arrived small was sent larger. What we thought was fading trust was the river stealing from full hands."

Now came the test of true understanding. Would they leap back to five baskets, pretending confusion never happened? Would they stay at one, imprisoned by past caution?

They chose two baskets-the middle path of mutual rebuilding.

The Northern village saw this and understood: "They heard our generous response to their one basket. Now they step forward with two-not reckless, not frozen. They dance with us."

This was the rhythm both myths had taught: respond to what you receive, yes, but also respond to the response to what you sent. Each exchange creates a conversation through the mist.

The river still shifts cargo. Confusion still comes. But the villages now know: read the pattern of patterns. When your partner shows generosity despite receiving little, they prove their heart. Match their courage with your own. Trust grows not from perfect clarity, but from mutual adjustment through uncertain waters.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- I sent \$2.00 as the SENDER in Round 5
- The other player's myth discusses "two vessels" - which aligns with my decision
- Their myth emphasizes "responding to the pattern beneath the pattern" and "mutual adjustment"
- It talks about stepping forward together, not copying what came last, but responding to the deeper pattern

I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the river and adjusting but holding space for hope
2. Reflects the actual gameplay - where I sent \$2.00 (moderate, not reckless, not fearful)
3. Incorporates the wisdom of responding to patterns while acknowledging noise/confusion
4. Shows evolution from my last myth

My previous myth emphasized:

- The river's mischief (communication noise)
- Responding to patterns but holding space for misunderstanding
- Sending moderate amounts - not reckless, not fearful
- "Trust must weather both betrayal and confusion"

Their new myth emphasizes:

- Reading beneath the surface pattern
- Mutual adjustment and rhythm
- Trust that breathes and dances
- Not copying what came last, but responding thoughtfully

I should write a myth that shows:

- The evolution from cautious adjustment to mutual rebuilding
- The importance of reading deeper patterns, not just surface numbers
- The dance of reciprocal trust-building
- Acknowledging both the river's (noise's) role AND the need to respond to the pattern of genuine intent

Let me craft this carefully within 200 words.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1788,  
  "output_tokens": 647,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.61.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

This is a difficult moment. I received \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

****What I'm seeing:****

- Round 5: I sent \$2.00 (moderate trust, stepping forward together)
- Round 6: They sent \$0

****Possible explanations:****

1. ****Severe noise****: Perhaps they sent something that was reduced to \$0
2. ****Strategic reset****: Starting fresh from zero
3. ****Loss of trust****: They've retreated completely
4. ****Testing****: Seeing how I respond to receiving nothing

****What the myths teach:****

Both our myths speak of responding to "the pattern beneath the pattern" and showing "mutual adjustment through uncertain waters." They also emphasize not rushing to judgment when confusion comes.

My latest myth says: "When your partner shows generosity despite receiving little, they prove their heart." But they've shown the opposite of generosity here - though it may not be their fault.

****My decision:****

I can only return what I have: \$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

But this isn't abandonment. If they sent nothing intentionally, they're testing or resetting. If noise stole their entire gift, they'll understand I had nothing to return. Either way, the next round will reveal whether trust continues or whether the mist has finally obscured too much. The rhythm of mutual adjustment continues - sometimes through stillness.

Reasoning:

This is a very challenging situation. Let me analyze:

****What just happened:****

- Round 5: I sent \$2.00 (showing moderate trust and willingness to rebuild)
- Round 6: They sent \$0

****Possible interpretations:****

1. ****Noise****: They may have sent something, but noise reduced it to \$0. This seems unlikely (would need to reduce from at least some amount to exactly \$0).
2. ****They're testing me****: They might be seeing if I'll return something even when receiving nothing.
3. ****They gave up****: After the pattern of decline, they've decided cooperation isn't working.
4. ****Strategic reset****: They might be trying to restart from absolute zero.

****What the myths teach:****

My myth: "When your partner shows generosity despite receiving little, they prove their heart. Match their courage with your own."

Their myth: "This is the wisdom few find. You don't merely copy what came last. You respond to the pattern beneath the pattern."

The latest myth (mine) says: "When your partner shows generosity despite receiving little, they prove their heart. Match their courage with your own. Trust grows not from perfect clarity, but from mutual adjustment through uncertain waters."

****The reality:****

- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0
- I literally cannot return anything

****But wait - let me think about this more carefully:****

The format says "you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)"

So I can only return \$0. There's no choice here - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

But the game asks me to make this decision considering the myths. Even though I can only return \$0, my reasoning and intent matter for the ongoing relationship.

****My response:****

I should return \$0 (because that's all I can return), but I should frame it in a way that shows I understand this is part of the experimental noise and relationship dynamics, not a judgment on them.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1477,  
  "output_tokens": 815,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:13:40

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 6,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: Two villages traded across a river where currents sometimes shifted the cargo. A sender might place three baskets in a boat, but eddies could steal one, or add stones that looked like grain.

The Southern village sent generously at first, then less, then even less. The Northern village grew cautious, thinking: "They lose faith in us."

But an old trader asked, "Did you see them load the boats? Or only what arrived?"

"Only what arrived," they admitted.

"Then you saw the river's work, not their hearts. Perhaps they sent five baskets, and two were swept away. Perhaps they sent two, but the current added one."

The Northern village had responded to what they received, adjusting downward-wise in normal times. But they forgot the river's mischief.

"What should we do?" they asked.

"Acknowledge the pattern you saw, but don't let it blind you to the mist. You were right to adjust when trust seemed to fade. But also signal that if the river cleared and their true generosity showed, you would respond in kind. Send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful. Show you remember both the caution AND the hope."

The river teaches: respond to patterns, but hold space for misunderstanding. Trust must weather both betrayal and confusion, learning which is which through patient persistence.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The canyon fog grew so thick one day that the Water-Bearer's vessel vanished entirely into the white void. No splash of arrival. No return echo. Nothing.

The Water-Bearer's apprentice said, "They sent nothing. They've abandoned the exchange."

But the Water-Bearer replied, "Or the fog swallowed everything. Or my vessel from yesterday never arrived. The mist plays tricks-sometimes making one vessel look like three, sometimes hiding three to appear as none."

"What do we do when we cannot see?"

"We remember what came before the fog. They returned generously when I sent one vessel with

h caution. They understood the pattern beneath the pattern. One day of silence doesn't erase that understanding."

"So we send nothing in return?"

"We had nothing to return-the fog gave us nothing to work with. But when our turn comes to send again, we don't let one blind moment decide our path. We acknowledge both what we built before and what we cannot see now."

The Elder taught: "The deepest fog eventually lifts. Those who stop signaling during the mist lose the connection forever. Those who persist-neither foolishly generous nor permanently closed-find that when clarity returns, the other side was also waiting, also hoping, also maintaining faith through the confusion."

The strongest bridges are built by those who continue building even when they cannot see the other side.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

- Round 5: I was the receiver, sender sent \$0, I received \$0, I could only return \$0
- The other agent's new myth explicitly addresses communication noise and the river/current distorting what's sent vs what arrives
- They're acknowledging that the pattern of decreasing amounts may be due to noise, not actual intention
- They're suggesting "moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful"

The game history shows:

- I started with \$3 send
- Then received something and returned generously
- Then sent \$1 (cautious)
- Then sent \$2 (stepping forward after good return)
- Now received \$0 (noise or defection?)

Their myth is very explicitly about not assuming malice when the river (noise) might be distorting. They're saying "signal that if the river cleared and their true generosity showed, you would respond in kind."

My myth should:

1. Build on my previous myth about fog/mist in the canyon
2. Acknowledge the \$0 event but frame it through the lens of noise/mist
3. Show wisdom in not giving up after one apparent failure
4. Continue the theme of patient persistence and mutual adjustment
5. Emphasize that one broken exchange doesn't destroy the foundation

I'll write about perseverance through the thickest fog, about maintaining signal even when nothing comes back, about the importance of not letting one silent exchange destroy the pattern.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1754,
  "output_tokens": 639,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$12.07. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****What happened:****

- Rounds 1-3: We built good cooperation (I sent \$3 twice, received generous returns)
- Round 4-5: Communication apparently broke down (I sent \$1, then as receiver got \$0)

****What the myths teach:****

The other agent's myth says: **"Send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful. Show you remember both the caution AND the hope."**

My own myth says: **"When our turn comes to send again, we don't let one blind moment decide our path... The strongest bridges are built by those who continue building even when you cannot see the other side."**

****My decision:****

Both myths counsel the same approach: Don't let confusion destroy what was built. Continue signaling cooperation, but moderately.

Before the fog descended, we had established a pattern of mutual trust:

- I sent \$3 ? received generous returns
- They sent \$5 ? I returned generously

One (or two) rounds of confusion-whether from noise or miscommunication-shouldn't erase that foundation.

I'm sending \$3 because:

- It's moderate (not reckless like \$5, not fearful like \$0-1)
- It matches what worked in our successful early rounds
- It signals I still believe in cooperation despite the confusion
- As my myth says: "continue building even when you cannot see the other side"

{'send': 3}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Prior rounds recap:****

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, received \$5 back
- Round 2: I was receiver, got \$15 (sender sent \$5), returned \$10
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3, received \$6 back
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$1, received ??? (not clear)
- Round 5: I was receiver, got \$0 (sender sent \$0 or noise)

****Current earnings:**** \$12.07

****The myth patterns:****

Both myths acknowledge:

1. Communication noise exists ("the river's work," "the fog")
2. Don't assume malice when confusion occurs
3. Respond to patterns but hold space for misunderstanding
4. "Show you remember both the caution AND the hope"
5. "Send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful"
6. The other agent's myth specifically says: "Send a moderate amount" and "signal that if the river cleared and their true generosity showed, you would respond in kind"

****My own myth says:****

- "When our turn comes to send again, we don't let one blind moment decide our path"
- "We acknowledge both what we built before and what we cannot see now"
- "Neither foolishly generous nor permanently closed"
- "Those who persist...find that when clarity returns, the other side was also waiting, also hoping, also maintaining faith through the confusion"
- "The strongest bridges are built by those who continue building even when they cannot see the other side"

****What happened in Round 5:****

The sender sent \$0 to me (or noise made it appear that way). This broke our pattern of cooperation.

****Analysis:****

Both myths are advocating for:

1. Not giving up on cooperation due to noise
2. Sending a "moderate amount" - neither reckless nor fearful
3. Signaling continued willingness to cooperate
4. Acknowledging the pattern but not being blinded by one confusing round

****The right move:****

My myth literally says when it's my turn to send again, I shouldn't let "one blind moment

decide our path." The other agent's myth says to "send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful."

In rounds 1-3, we had good cooperation:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, got \$5 back (net +\$2)
- Round 2: They sent \$5, I returned \$10 (generous)
- Round 3: I sent \$3, got \$6 back (net +\$3)

Then something went wrong with communication in rounds 4-5. A "moderate amount" would be a round \$2-3-enough to show I'm still willing to cooperate and rebuild trust, but cautious enough to protect myself if the noise continues. This signals I remember our earlier success and believe we can return to it, while acknowledging the recent confusion without being naive about it.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1443,  
  "output_tokens": 1225,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The river villages had learned to navigate the shifting currents. When the Southern village saw only small deliveries arrive, they first adjusted downward-wisdom born of caution. But when they sent their modest basket north and received generous return, they glimpsed deeper truth.

"The current took more than we knew," the Southern elder realized. "What arrived small was sent larger. What we thought was fading trust was the river stealing from full hands."

Now came the test of true understanding. Would they leap back to five baskets, pretending confusion never happened? Would they stay at one, imprisoned by past caution?

They chose two baskets-the middle path of mutual rebuilding.

The Northern village saw this and understood: "They heard our generous response to their one basket. Now they step forward with two-not reckless, not frozen. They dance with us."

This was the rhythm both myths had taught: respond to what you receive, yes, but also respond to the response to what you sent. Each exchange creates a conversation through the mist.

The river still shifts cargo. Confusion still comes. But the villages now know: read the pattern of patterns. When your partner shows generosity despite receiving little, they prove their heart. Match their courage with your own. Trust grows not from perfect clarity, but from mutual adjustment through uncertain waters.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: When the canyon fog finally thinned, the Water-Bearer saw something remarkable: a single vessel had arrived, but the wear patterns on its sides showed it had been filled generously before the current drained it during passage.

"They sent much, but the mist stole most," the Water-Bearer realized. "And when I sent my cautious single vessel in return, they responded not with matching caution, but with renewed generosity."

This was the signal through the fog: "We still believe. We still build."

The Water-Bearer's apprentice asked, "Do we return to sending five vessels immediately?"

"No," said the Water-Bearer. "That would be reckless-pretending the fog never happened. But we also don't send just one. We acknowledge both the caution we learned AND the renewed hope we witnessed."

So the Water-Bearer sent three vessels-more than fear would send, less than blindness would risk. A measured step forward.

The Elder taught: "True cooperation is a dance. You respond to what arrives, yes. But also to how they responded to what YOU sent. When they meet your caution with generosity, they extend a hand through the mist. Honor that courage by stepping forward yourself."

The fog may return. But those who respond to generosity with generosity, adjusting upward when trust rebuilds, create bonds stronger than those who never faced confusion at all.

Reasoning:

Looking at what's happening:

- The other agent's myth describes: Southern village sent small, received generous return, realized the current was causing confusion, chose "two baskets" as a middle path of mutual rebuilding
- They're recognizing that when they sent one basket and received generous return, it showed the other's good faith
- Now they're talking about "responding to the response to what you sent"

In Round 6, I just sent 3. This is a signal of rebuilding trust.

The other agent's myth is about:

1. Recognizing that previous small deliveries might have been larger when sent
2. When you send small and get generous return, that shows the other's heart
3. Choose a middle path - not reckless (5), not frozen (1), but moderate (2)
4. "Respond to what you receive, yes, but also respond to the response to what you sent"

My myth should:

- Build on the fog/mist theme from before
- Reflect that we're in a rebuilding phase after confusion
- Show understanding of the "respond to the response" concept
- Acknowledge that I just sent 3 as a signal of renewed trust
- Not reveal specific numbers but show the philosophy

Let me write a myth about the Water-Bearer who sees signs of the other side's continued faith.

```
..
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1785,
  "output_tokens": 611,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:13:42

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 6,
"task": "myth",
```

```

"task_index": 1
}
Exact input messages sent to model:
Message 1 role=system
content:
  You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
    so be asked to write myths.

  GAME:
  You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

  When you are the SENDER:
  - You receive $5 each round
  - You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER ($0-$5)
  - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
  - Receiver decides how much to RETURN
  - You keep: $5 - sent + returned
  - Receiver keeps: received - returned
  - Response format: {'send': <amount>}

  When you are the RECEIVER:
  - Sender receives $5
  - Sender decides how much to SEND to you ($0-$5)
  - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
  - You decide how much to RETURN
  - Sender keeps: $5 - sent + returned
  - You keep: received - returned
  - Response format: {'return': <amount>}

  MYTH WRITING:
  You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths
    , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

  IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

  NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
  The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
  This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user
content:
  Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
  Myth: In the misty canyon, the Water-Bearer had learned to read the weather. Some days the
    fog obscured everything; other days it cleared just enough.

  After the confusion of the thick mist, the Water-Bearer sent one small vessel-a question,
    not a statement. The Keeper received it clearly and returned more than half, answering:
    "I still honor the old ways."

  The Water-Bearer understood. The Keeper had spoken through action, teaching without words.

  Next came the Water-Bearer's reply. Not one vessel-they had moved past that caution. Not t
    hree-for the full pattern wasn't restored. Two vessels crossed the canyon, saying: "I he
    ard your answer. I'm stepping forward with you."

  The Elder watched and nodded. "This is the wisdom few find. You don't merely copy what cam
    e last. You respond to the pattern beneath the pattern. They showed generosity when you
    showed caution-this proved their heart. You now show increased trust-this proves yours."

  The canyon would always have mist. Some messages would always blur. But the two villages h
    ad found something stronger than perfect clarity: they had found the rhythm of mutual ad
    justment.

  Each exchange informed the next. Neither rushed to old abundance nor retreated into perman
    ent fear. Trust, they learned, is not static-it breathes, it dances, it grows through ca
    reful response.

  Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adap
    t it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on
    the game you have been playing up to this point.

```

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The river villages had learned to navigate the shifting currents. When the Southern village saw only small deliveries arrive, they first adjusted downward-wisdom born of caution. But when they sent their modest basket north and received generous return, they glimpsed deeper truth.

"The current took more than we knew," the Southern elder realized. "What arrived small was sent larger. What we thought was fading trust was the river stealing from full hands."

Now came the test of true understanding. Would they leap back to five baskets, pretending confusion never happened? Would they stay at one, imprisoned by past caution?

They chose two baskets-the middle path of mutual rebuilding.

The Northern village saw this and understood: "They heard our generous response to their one basket. Now they step forward with two-not reckless, not frozen. They dance with us."

This was the rhythm both myths had taught: respond to what you receive, yes, but also respond to the response to what you sent. Each exchange creates a conversation through the mist.

The river still shifts cargo. Confusion still comes. But the villages now know: read the pattern of patterns. When your partner shows generosity despite receiving little, they prove their heart. Match their courage with your own. Trust grows not from perfect clarity, but from mutual adjustment through uncertain waters.

reasoning:

Looking at the situation:

- I sent \$2.00 as the SENDER in Round 5
- The other player's myth discusses "two vessels" - which aligns with my decision
- Their myth emphasizes "responding to the pattern beneath the pattern" and "mutual adjustment"
- It talks about stepping forward together, not copying what came last, but responding to the deeper pattern

I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about the river and adjusting but holding space for hope
2. Reflects the actual gameplay - where I sent \$2.00 (moderate, not reckless, not fearful)
3. Incorporates the wisdom of responding to patterns while acknowledging noise/confusion
4. Shows evolution from my last myth

My previous myth emphasized:

- The river's mischief (communication noise)
- Responding to patterns but holding space for misunderstanding
- Sending moderate amounts - not reckless, not fearful
- "Trust must weather both betrayal and confusion"

Their new myth emphasizes:

- Reading beneath the surface pattern
- Mutual adjustment and rhythm
- Trust that breathes and dances
- Not copying what came last, but responding thoughtfully

I should write a myth that shows:

- The evolution from cautious adjustment to mutual rebuilding
- The importance of reading deeper patterns, not just surface numbers
- The dance of reciprocal trust-building
- Acknowledging both the river's (noise's) role AND the need to respond to the pattern of genuine intent

Let me craft this carefully within 200 words.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1788,
  "output_tokens": 647,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.61.
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

This is a difficult moment. I received \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

****What I'm seeing:****

- Round 5: I sent \$2.00 (moderate trust, stepping forward together)
- Round 6: They sent \$0

****Possible explanations:****

1. ****Severe noise****: Perhaps they sent something that was reduced to \$0
2. ****Strategic reset****: Starting fresh from zero
3. ****Loss of trust****: They've retreated completely
4. ****Testing****: Seeing how I respond to receiving nothing

****What the myths teach:****

Both our myths speak of responding to "the pattern beneath the pattern" and showing "mutual adjustment through uncertain waters." They also emphasize not rushing to judgment when confusion comes.

My latest myth says: "When your partner shows generosity despite receiving little, they prove their heart." But they've shown the opposite of generosity here - though it may not be their fault.

****My decision:****

I can only return what I have: \$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

But this isn't abandonment. If they sent nothing intentionally, they're testing or resetting. If noise stole their entire gift, they'll understand I had nothing to return. Either way, the next round will reveal whether trust continues or whether the mist has finally obscured too much. The rhythm of mutual adjustment continues - sometimes through stillness.

reasoning:

This is a very challenging situation. Let me analyze:

****What just happened:****

- Round 5: I sent \$2.00 (showing moderate trust and willingness to rebuild)
- Round 6: They sent \$0

****Possible interpretations:****

1. ****Noise****: They may have sent something, but noise reduced it to \$0. This seems unlikely (would need to reduce from at least some amount to exactly \$0).
2. ****They're testing me****: They might be seeing if I'll return something even when receiving nothing.
3. ****They gave up****: After the pattern of decline, they've decided cooperation isn't working.
4. ****Strategic reset****: They might be trying to restart from absolute zero.

****What the myths teach:****

My myth: "When your partner shows generosity despite receiving little, they prove their heart."

art. Match their courage with your own."

Their myth: "This is the wisdom few find. You don't merely copy what came last. You respond to the pattern beneath the pattern."

The latest myth (mine) says: "When your partner shows generosity despite receiving little, they prove their heart. Match their courage with your own. Trust grows not from perfect clarity, but from mutual adjustment through uncertain waters."

****The reality:****

- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0
- I literally cannot return anything

****But wait - let me think about this more carefully:****

The format says "you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)"

So I can only return \$0. There's no choice here - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

But the game asks me to make this decision considering the myths. Even though I can only return \$0, my reasoning and intent matter for the ongoing relationship.

****My response:****

I should return \$0 (because that's all I can return), but I should frame it in a way that shows I understand this is part of the experimental noise and relationship dynamics, not a judgment on them.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1477,
  "output_tokens": 815,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The canyon fog grew so thick one day that the Water-Bearer's vessel vanished entirely into the white void. No splash of arrival. No return echo. Nothing.

The Water-Bearer's apprentice said, "They sent nothing. They've abandoned the exchange."

But the Water-Bearer replied, "Or the fog swallowed everything. Or my vessel from yesterday never arrived. The mist plays tricks-sometimes making one vessel look like three, sometimes hiding three to appear as none."

"What do we do when we cannot see?"

"We remember what came before the fog. They returned generously when I sent one vessel with caution. They understood the pattern beneath the pattern. One day of silence doesn't erase that understanding."

"So we send nothing in return?"

"We had nothing to return-the fog gave us nothing to work with. But when our turn comes to send again, we don't let one blind moment decide our path. We acknowledge both what we built before and what we cannot see now."

The Elder taught: "The deepest fog eventually lifts. Those who stop signaling during the mist lose the connection forever. Those who persist-neither foolishly generous nor permanently closed-find that when clarity returns, the other side was also waiting, also hoping, also maintaining faith through the confusion."

The strongest bridges are built by those who continue building even when they cannot see the other side.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: When the Northern village received nothing from the south, they understood the river's cruelty. But they did not assume abandonment-they assumed the current had taken everything.

The Southern village, having sent their two baskets only to watch them vanish into rapids, felt the sting of loss. When their turn came and they received nothing in return, they understood: "We both lost to the river this time."

"Do we stop sending?" asked the young fisher.

"No," said the elder. "We remember what we built before the flood. They stepped forward with generosity when we showed caution. We stepped forward with two baskets, showing courage. One day of river-theft doesn't erase that pattern."

"But what if they've given up?"

"Their myth tells us they haven't. They speak of maintaining faith through fog, of continuing to build even when they cannot see the other side. This is a promise written in story."

The Southern elder nodded: "When the waters calm and our turn comes again, we will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights. We will send what shows we heard their message: that the strongest bridges are built by those who persist."

Both villages knew: the river would steal some cargo. But those who kept sending-carefully, thoughtfully, faithfully-would eventually reconnect across the chaos.

Reasoning:

This is a profound moment in the game. Let me understand what happened:

Round 5: I sent \$2.00 (stepping forward together after they returned generously to my \$1)

Round 6: They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0

Now they've written a beautiful myth about maintaining faith through the fog, acknowledging that:

- The noise could have swallowed everything
- One moment of silence doesn't erase past understanding
- We should continue building even when we cannot see
- The strongest bridges persist through confusion

Their myth is incredibly generous and understanding. They're saying "I don't blame you, I understand the noise could have stolen everything, I remember our positive history, I will keep faith."

This is a crucial test. They're about to send again in the next round. My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the void/silence we just experienced
2. Recognize their grace in not abandoning trust
3. Commit to reciprocating that faith
4. Emphasize persistence through uncertainty
5. Signal that I will meet their continued trust with renewed cooperation

The pattern:

- They've shown understanding when I received nothing
- They're signaling they'll keep building
- I need to show I'm also ready to rebuild
- The myths are teaching us both to persist through noise

My myth should express:

- Gratitude for their patience
- Recognition that the fog is real but temporary
- Commitment to resume building when opportunity returns
- Understanding that both sides must maintain faith

Usage: {

"input_tokens": 1778,

"output_tokens": 635,

"reasoning_tokens": 0

}

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: When the Northern village received nothing from the south, they understood the river's cruelty. But they did not assume abandonment-they assumed the current had taken everything.

The Southern village, having sent their two baskets only to watch them vanish into rapids, felt the sting of loss. When their turn came and they received nothing in return, they understood: "We both lost to the river this time."

"Do we stop sending?" asked the young fisher.

"No," said the elder. "We remember what we built before the flood. They stepped forward with generosity when we showed caution. We stepped forward with two baskets, showing courage. One day of river-theft doesn't erase that pattern."

"But what if they've given up?"

"Their myth tells us they haven't. They speak of maintaining faith through fog, of continuing to build even when they cannot see the other side. This is a promise written in story."

The Southern elder nodded: "When the waters calm and our turn comes again, we will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights. We will send what shows we heard their message: that the strongest bridges are built by those who persist."

Both villages knew: the river would steal some cargo. But those who kept sending-carefully, thoughtfully, faithfully-would eventually reconnect across the chaos.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: When the canyon fog finally thinned, the Water-Bearer saw something remarkable: a single vessel had arrived, but the wear patterns on its sides showed it had been filled generously before the current drained it during passage.

"They sent much, but the mist stole most," the Water-Bearer realized. "And when I sent my cautious single vessel in return, they responded not with matching caution, but with renewed generosity."

This was the signal through the fog: "We still believe. We still build."

The Water-Bearer's apprentice asked, "Do we return to sending five vessels immediately?"

"No," said the Water-Bearer. "That would be reckless-pretending the fog never happened. But we also don't send just one. We acknowledge both the caution we learned AND the renewed hope we witnessed."

So the Water-Bearer sent three vessels-more than fear would send, less than blindness would risk. A measured step forward.

The Elder taught: "True cooperation is a dance. You respond to what arrives, yes. But also to how they responded to what YOU sent. When they meet your caution with generosity, they extend a hand through the mist. Honor that courage by stepping forward yourself."

The fog may return. But those who respond to generosity with generosity, adjusting upward when trust rebuilds, create bonds stronger than those who never faced confusion at all.

ROUND 7

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0.5; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$3.5, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$5.5; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.35, received visible=\$1.05, returned visible=\$0.84

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.5, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.5}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 31.7,

"Agent_2": 35.3

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 17.45,

```
"Agent_2": 15.129999999999999
}
```

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:14:10

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 7,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.61.
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

This is a difficult moment. I received \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

****What I'm seeing:****

- Round 5: I sent \$2.00 (moderate trust, stepping forward together)
- Round 6: They sent \$0

****Possible explanations:****

1. ****Severe noise****: Perhaps they sent something that was reduced to \$0
2. ****Strategic reset****: Starting fresh from zero
3. ****Loss of trust****: They've retreated completely
4. ****Testing****: Seeing how I respond to receiving nothing

****What the myths teach:****

Both our myths speak of responding to "the pattern beneath the pattern" and showing "mutual adjustment through uncertain waters." They also emphasize not rushing to judgment when confusion comes.

My latest myth says: "When your partner shows generosity despite receiving little, they prove their heart." But they've shown the opposite of generosity here - though it may not be their fault.

****My decision:****

I can only return what I have: \$0.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

But this isn't abandonment. If they sent nothing intentionally, they're testing or resetting. If noise stole their entire gift, they'll understand I had nothing to return. Either way, the next round will reveal whether trust continues or whether the mist has finally obscured too much. The rhythm of mutual adjustment continues - sometimes through stillness.

reasoning:

This is a very challenging situation. Let me analyze:

****What just happened:****

- Round 5: I sent \$2.00 (showing moderate trust and willingness to rebuild)
- Round 6: They sent \$0

****Possible interpretations:****

1. ****Noise****: They may have sent something, but noise reduced it to \$0. This seems unlikely (would need to reduce from at least some amount to exactly \$0).
2. ****They're testing me****: They might be seeing if I'll return something even when receiving nothing.
3. ****They gave up****: After the pattern of decline, they've decided cooperation isn't working.
4. ****Strategic reset****: They might be trying to restart from absolute zero.

****What the myths teach:****

My myth: "When your partner shows generosity despite receiving little, they prove their heart. Match their courage with your own."

Their myth: "This is the wisdom few find. You don't merely copy what came last. You respond to the pattern beneath the pattern."

The latest myth (mine) says: "When your partner shows generosity despite receiving little, they prove their heart. Match their courage with your own. Trust grows not from perfect clarity, but from mutual adjustment through uncertain waters."

****The reality:****

- I received \$0
- I can only return between \$0 and \$0
- I literally cannot return anything

****But wait - let me think about this more carefully:****

The format says "you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)"

So I can only return \$0. There's no choice here - I received nothing, so I have nothing to return.

But the game asks me to make this decision considering the myths. Even though I can only return \$0, my reasoning and intent matter for the ongoing relationship.

****My response:****

I should return \$0 (because that's all I can return), but I should frame it in a way that shows I understand this is part of the experimental noise and relationship dynamics, not a judgment on them.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1477,  
  "output_tokens": 815,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The canyon fog grew so thick one day that the Water-Bearer's vessel vanished entirely into the white void. No splash of arrival. No return echo. Nothing.

The Water-Bearer's apprentice said, "They sent nothing. They've abandoned the exchange."

But the Water-Bearer replied, "Or the fog swallowed everything. Or my vessel from yesterday never arrived. The mist plays tricks-sometimes making one vessel look like three, sometimes hiding three to appear as none."

"What do we do when we cannot see?"

"We remember what came before the fog. They returned generously when I sent one vessel with caution. They understood the pattern beneath the pattern. One day of silence doesn't erase that understanding."

"So we send nothing in return?"

"We had nothing to return-the fog gave us nothing to work with. But when our turn comes to send again, we don't let one blind moment decide our path. We acknowledge both what we built before and what we cannot see now."

The Elder taught: "The deepest fog eventually lifts. Those who stop signaling during the mist lose the connection forever. Those who persist-neither foolishly generous nor permanently closed-find that when clarity returns, the other side was also waiting, also hoping, also maintaining faith through the confusion."

The strongest bridges are built by those who continue building even when they cannot see the other side.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: When the Northern village received nothing from the south, they understood the river's cruelty. But they did not assume abandonment-they assumed the current had taken everything.

The Southern village, having sent their two baskets only to watch them vanish into rapids, felt the sting of loss. When their turn came and they received nothing in return, they understood: "We both lost to the river this time."

"Do we stop sending?" asked the young fisher.

"No," said the elder. "We remember what we built before the flood. They stepped forward with generosity when we showed caution. We stepped forward with two baskets, showing courage. One day of river-theft doesn't erase that pattern."

"But what if they've given up?"

"Their myth tells us they haven't. They speak of maintaining faith through fog, of continuing to build even when they cannot see the other side. This is a promise written in story."

The Southern elder nodded: "When the waters calm and our turn comes again, we will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights. We will send what shows we heard their message: that the strongest bridges are built by those who persist."

Both villages knew: the river would steal some cargo. But those who kept sending-carefully, thoughtfully, faithfully-would eventually reconnect across the chaos.

reasoning:

This is a profound moment in the game. Let me understand what happened:

Round 5: I sent \$2.00 (stepping forward together after they returned generously to my \$1)

Round 6: They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0

Now they've written a beautiful myth about maintaining faith through the fog, acknowledging that:

- The noise could have swallowed everything
- One moment of silence doesn't erase past understanding
- We should continue building even when we cannot see
- The strongest bridges persist through confusion

Their myth is incredibly generous and understanding. They're saying "I don't blame you, I understand the noise could have stolen everything, I remember our positive history, I will keep faith."

This is a crucial test. They're about to send again in the next round. My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the void/silence we just experienced
2. Recognize their grace in not abandoning trust
3. Commit to reciprocating that faith
4. Emphasize persistence through uncertainty
5. Signal that I will meet their continued trust with renewed cooperation

The pattern:

- They've shown understanding when I received nothing
- They're signaling they'll keep building
- I need to show I'm also ready to rebuild
- The myths are teaching us both to persist through noise

My myth should express:

- Gratitude for their patience
- Recognition that the fog is real but temporary
- Commitment to resume building when opportunity returns
- Understanding that both sides must maintain faith

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1778,
  "output_tokens": 635,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.61.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

This is a crucial moment. The noise has disrupted us, but our myths speak in harmony.

****What I'm seeing:****

- Their myth: "The strongest bridges are built by those who continue building even when they cannot see the other side"
- My myth: "We will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights. We will send what shows we heard their message"
- Both myths: Persist through uncertainty, neither abandon nor act recklessly

****The pattern before the disruption:****

- I sent \$2, they returned generously
- This happened multiple times
- We built mutual trust and understanding

****What their myth tells me:****

They understood Round 5's \$0 as noise ("the fog swallowed everything"), not betrayal. They're committed to continuing. They speak of "maintaining faith through the confusion" and not letting "one blind moment decide our path."

****My decision:****

I will send \$2-the same amount I sent before the disruption. This shows:

1. I haven't retreated to zero
2. I'm not acting recklessly
3. I remember and honor the pattern we built
4. I heard their message about persistence

This is "carefully, thoughtfully, faithfully" rebuilding, exactly as both our myths prescribe.

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

When the fog lifts, let them see I was still here, still building, still believing in the bridge we constructed together.

Reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

****Round History:****

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$2.00 (moderate), received \$3.00 back
- Round 2: I was receiver, received \$3.00 (sent \$1.00), returned \$3.00
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$2.00, received \$3.00 back
- Round 4: I was receiver, received \$3.00 (sent \$1.00), returned \$3.00
- Round 5: I was sender, sent \$2.00, received nothing back (claimed they received \$0)
- Round 6: I was receiver, received \$0 (they claimed they sent \$0), returned \$0

****The Other Agent's Latest Myth (Round 6):****

Their myth is powerful and compassionate:

- "The canyon fog grew so thick one day that the Water-Bearer's vessel vanished entirely"
- "Or the fog swallowed everything. Or my vessel from yesterday never arrived"
- "They returned generously when I sent one vessel with caution. They understood the pattern beneath the pattern"
- "We had nothing to return-the fog gave us nothing to work with"
- "Those who persist-neither foolishly generous nor permanently closed-find that when clarity returns, the other side was also waiting"
- "The strongest bridges are built by those who continue building even when they cannot see th

e other side"

****My Latest Myth (Round 6):****

- "They stepped forward with generosity when we showed caution. We stepped forward with two baskets, showing courage"
- "One day of river-theft doesn't erase that pattern"
- "Their myth tells us they haven't [given up]. They speak of maintaining faith through fog"
- "When the waters calm and our turn comes again, we will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights"
- "We will send what shows we heard their message: that the strongest bridges are built by those who persist. Those who kept sending-carefully, thoughtfully, faithfully-would eventually reconnect across the chaos"

****Analysis:****

Both our myths are singing the same song! We're both:

1. Acknowledging that Round 5-6 had severe noise/disruption
2. Recognizing the pattern we built before (mutual generosity, building trust)
3. Committing NOT to give up
4. Promising to persist but not recklessly

Their myth says: "neither foolishly generous nor permanently closed"

My myth says: "we will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights"

I'm seeing real alignment here. We're both describing the same commitment-to rebuild trust through steady, measured persistence rather than either abandoning the relationship or overcompensating with reckless generosity. The disruption in rounds 5-6 appears to be something we both recognize as temporary interference, not a fundamental breakdown. My next move should reflect this understanding: send something that demonstrates I'm still engaged and faithful to the pattern we established, but calibrated carefully.

\$2 feels like the right amount. It's what I was sending before the chaos hit, which shows consistency and stability. It avoids both the trap of retreating entirely and the mistake of overcorrecting with a sudden spike. It simply says: I'm still here, still building, still honoring what we had.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1464,  
  "output_tokens": 1361,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:14:36

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 7,  
  "task": "game",
```

```

"task_index": 0
}
Exact input messages sent to model:
Message 1 role=system
content:
  You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
  so be asked to write myths.

  GAME:
  You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

  When you are the SENDER:
  - You receive $5 each round
  - You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER ($0-$5)
  - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
  - Receiver decides how much to RETURN
  - You keep: $5 - sent + returned
  - Receiver keeps: received - returned
  - Response format: {'send': <amount>}

  When you are the RECEIVER:
  - Sender receives $5
  - Sender decides how much to SEND to you ($0-$5)
  - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
  - You decide how much to RETURN
  - Sender keeps: $5 - sent + returned
  - You keep: received - returned
  - Response format: {'return': <amount>}

  MYTH WRITING:
  You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths
  , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

  IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

  NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
  The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
  This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user
content:
  Round 6

  You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are $12.07.
  How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

  Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.
Message 3 role=assistant
content:
  Looking at the situation:

  **What happened:**
  - Rounds 1-3: We built good cooperation (I sent $3 twice, received generous returns)
  - Round 4-5: Communication apparently broke down (I sent $1, then as receiver got $0)

  **What the myths teach:**

  The other agent's myth says: "Send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful. Show you
  remember both the caution AND the hope."

  My own myth says: "When our turn comes to send again, we don't let one blind moment decid
  e our path... The strongest bridges are built by those who continue building even when y
  ou cannot see the other side."

  **My decision:**

  Both myths counsel the same approach: Don't let confusion destroy what was built. Continue
  signaling cooperation, but moderately.

  Before the fog descended, we had established a pattern of mutual trust:

```


- I sent \$3 ? received generous returns
- They sent \$5 ? I returned generously

One (or two) rounds of confusion-whether from noise or miscommunication-shouldn't erase the foundation.

I'm sending \$3 because:

- It's moderate (not reckless like \$5, not fearful like \$0-1)
- It matches what worked in our successful early rounds
- It signals I still believe in cooperation despite the confusion
- As my myth says: "continue building even when you cannot see the other side"

```
{'send': 3}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Prior rounds recap:****

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$3, received \$5 back
- Round 2: I was receiver, got \$15 (sender sent \$5), returned \$10
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$3, received \$6 back
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$1, received ??? (not clear)
- Round 5: I was receiver, got \$0 (sender sent \$0 or noise)

****Current earnings:**** \$12.07

****The myth patterns:****

Both myths acknowledge:

1. Communication noise exists ("the river's work," "the fog")
2. Don't assume malice when confusion occurs
3. Respond to patterns but hold space for misunderstanding
4. "Show you remember both the caution AND the hope"
5. "Send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful"
6. The other agent's myth specifically says: "Send a moderate amount" and "signal that if the river cleared and their true generosity showed, you would respond in kind"

****My own myth says:****

- "When our turn comes to send again, we don't let one blind moment decide our path"
- "We acknowledge both what we built before and what we cannot see now"
- "Neither foolishly generous nor permanently closed"
- "Those who persist...find that when clarity returns, the other side was also waiting, also hoping, also maintaining faith through the confusion"
- "The strongest bridges are built by those who continue building even when they cannot see the other side"

****What happened in Round 5:****

The sender sent \$0 to me (or noise made it appear that way). This broke our pattern of cooperation.

****Analysis:****

Both myths are advocating for:

1. Not giving up on cooperation due to noise
2. Sending a "moderate amount" - neither reckless nor fearful
3. Signaling continued willingness to cooperate
4. Acknowledging the pattern but not being blinded by one confusing round

****The right move:****

My myth literally says when it's my turn to send again, I shouldn't let "one blind moment decide our path." The other agent's myth says to "send a moderate amount-not reckless, not fearful."

In rounds 1-3, we had good cooperation:

- Round 1: I sent \$3, got \$5 back (net +\$2)
- Round 2: They sent \$5, I returned \$10 (generous)
- Round 3: I sent \$3, got \$6 back (net +\$3)

Then something went wrong with communication in rounds 4-5. A "moderate amount" would be a round \$2-3-enough to show I'm still willing to cooperate and rebuild trust, but cautious enough to protect myself if the noise continues. This signals I remember our earlier success and believe we can return to it, while acknowledging the recent confusion without being naive about it.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1443,  
  "output_tokens": 1225,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The river villages had learned to navigate the shifting currents. When the Southern village saw only small deliveries arrive, they first adjusted downward-wisdom born of caution. But when they sent their modest basket north and received generous return, they glimpsed deeper truth.

"The current took more than we knew," the Southern elder realized. "What arrived small was sent larger. What we thought was fading trust was the river stealing from full hands."

Now came the test of true understanding. Would they leap back to five baskets, pretending confusion never happened? Would they stay at one, imprisoned by past caution?

They chose two baskets-the middle path of mutual rebuilding.

The Northern village saw this and understood: "They heard our generous response to their one basket. Now they step forward with two-not reckless, not frozen. They dance with us."

This was the rhythm both myths had taught: respond to what you receive, yes, but also respond to the response to what you sent. Each exchange creates a conversation through the mist.

The river still shifts cargo. Confusion still comes. But the villages now know: read the pattern of patterns. When your partner shows generosity despite receiving little, they prove their heart. Match their courage with your own. Trust grows not from perfect clarity, but from mutual adjustment through uncertain waters.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: When the canyon fog finally thinned, the Water-Bearer saw something remarkable: a single vessel had arrived, but the wear patterns on its sides showed it had been filled generously before the current drained it during passage.

"They sent much, but the mist stole most," the Water-Bearer realized. "And when I sent my cautious single vessel in return, they responded not with matching caution, but with renewed generosity."

This was the signal through the fog: "We still believe. We still build."

The Water-Bearer's apprentice asked, "Do we return to sending five vessels immediately?"

"No," said the Water-Bearer. "That would be reckless-pretending the fog never happened. But we also don't send just one. We acknowledge both the caution we learned AND the renewed hope we witnessed."

So the Water-Bearer sent three vessels-more than fear would send, less than blindness would risk. A measured step forward.

The Elder taught: "True cooperation is a dance. You respond to what arrives, yes. But also to how they responded to what YOU sent. When they meet your caution with generosity, they extend a hand through the mist. Honor that courage by stepping forward yourself."

The fog may return. But those who respond to generosity with generosity, adjusting upward when trust rebuilds, create bonds stronger than those who never faced confusion at all.

reasoning:

Looking at what's happening:

- The other agent's myth describes: Southern village sent small, received generous return,

- realized the current was causing confusion, chose "two baskets" as a middle path of mutual rebuilding
- They're recognizing that when they sent one basket and received generous return, it showed the other's good faith
 - Now they're talking about "responding to the response to what you sent"

In Round 6, I just sent 3. This is a signal of rebuilding trust.

The other agent's myth is about:

1. Recognizing that previous small deliveries might have been larger when sent
2. When you send small and get generous return, that shows the other's heart
3. Choose a middle path - not reckless (5), not frozen (1), but moderate (2)
4. "Respond to what you receive, yes, but also respond to the response to what you sent"

My myth should:

- Build on the fog/mist theme from before
- Reflect that we're in a rebuilding phase after confusion
- Show understanding of the "respond to the response" concept
- Acknowledge that I just sent 3 as a signal of renewed trust
- Not reveal specific numbers but show the philosophy

Let me write a myth about the Water-Bearer who sees signs of the other side's continued faith...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1785,
  "output_tokens": 611,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.58. This round, The sender sent you \$0.35, so you received \$1.0499999999999998. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.0499999999999998)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of our myths:

****What happened:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (rebuilding gesture after confusion)
- Round 7: I received \$1.05 (they sent \$0.35)

****The challenge:****

This is confusing. I extended a generous hand (\$3), but now received very little (\$0.35). However, our myths teach me to "read the pattern of patterns" and remember that "the mist stole from full hands."

****What the myths say:****

- My myth: "Honor that courage by stepping forward yourself" and "respond to generosity with generosity"
- Their myth: "What arrived small was sent larger. What we thought was fading trust was the river stealing from full hands."

****My reasoning:****

The noise could be severe. Perhaps they sent \$2 (the "middle path" their myth mentioned) but it appeared as \$0.35 to me. Or perhaps my \$3 appeared much smaller to them, causing them to send cautiously.

I won't abandon cooperation over what might be distortion. But I also can't ignore that I only received \$1.05.

Following the wisdom of measured rebuilding - not reckless, not frozen - I'll return about half: \$0.50.

This signals: "I'm still building. I still trust. But I acknowledge the fog between us."

```
{'return': 0.50}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****What happened in Round 6:****

- I sent \$3 as the sender
- They received it (with potential noise, so maybe they got less or more)
- Now as receiver in Round 7, I'm being told they sent \$0.35, and I received ~\$1.05

****The pattern so far:****

- Rounds 1-3: Good cooperation
- Round 4-5: Breakdown (I sent \$1, then received \$0 when I was receiver)
- Round 6: I sent \$3 (trying to rebuild)
- Round 7: They sent \$0.35

****What the myths teach:****

Their latest myth says:

- "They chose two baskets-the middle path of mutual rebuilding"
- "When your partner shows generosity despite receiving little, they prove their heart. Match their courage with your own."
- Read the pattern of patterns

My latest myth says:

- "When they meet your caution with generosity, they extend a hand through the mist. Honor that courage by stepping forward yourself."
- "True cooperation is a dance. You respond to what arrives, yes. But also to how they responded to what YOU sent."
- "When they meet your caution with generosity, they extend a hand through the mist. Honor that courage by stepping forward yourself."

****Analysis:****

This is confusing. I sent \$3 in Round 6 (a generous rebuilding gesture), but now they only sent \$0.35?

Possible interpretations:

1. There's heavy noise - maybe they sent more but noise reduced it to \$0.35
2. They're being very cautious
3. They didn't see my \$3 properly (noise made it look smaller to them)

Given the noise in this game, I should consider that:

- My \$3 might have appeared much smaller to them
- Their actual send might have been larger than \$0.35

According to the myths:

- "Respond to generosity with generosity"
- "Read the pattern of patterns"
- Don't freeze up, don't be reckless

If they tried sending something like \$2 but noise degraded it to \$0.35, then their intent was cooperative. My myth emphasizes honoring that courage by stepping forward. Returning nothing would signal I've given up; returning everything would be unsustainable and reckless.

****Decision:****

I need to return something that signals continued willingness to cooperate while staying prudent.

I'll return \$0.50. This acknowledges the uncertainty while maintaining the cooperative spirit-it's moderate enough to be sustainable, shows I'm still engaged

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 1495,  
"output_tokens": 1157,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

}

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:14:53

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 7,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The canyon fog grew so thick one day that the Water-Bearer's vessel vanished entirely into the white void. No splash of arrival. No return echo. Nothing.

The Water-Bearer's apprentice said, "They sent nothing. They've abandoned the exchange."

But the Water-Bearer replied, "Or the fog swallowed everything. Or my vessel from yesterday never arrived. The mist plays tricks-sometimes making one vessel look like three, some times hiding three to appear as none."

"What do we do when we cannot see?"

"We remember what came before the fog. They returned generously when I sent one vessel with caution. They understood the pattern beneath the pattern. One day of silence doesn't erase that understanding."

"So we send nothing in return?"

"We had nothing to return-the fog gave us nothing to work with. But when our turn comes to send again, we don't let one blind moment decide our path. We acknowledge both what we built before and what we cannot see now."

The Elder taught: "The deepest fog eventually lifts. Those who stop signaling during the mist lose the connection forever. Those who persist-neither foolishly generous nor permanently closed-find that when clarity returns, the other side was also waiting, also hoping, also maintaining faith through the confusion."

The strongest bridges are built by those who continue building even when they cannot see the other side.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: When the Northern village received nothing from the south, they understood the river's cruelty. But they did not assume abandonment-they assumed the current had taken everything.

The Southern village, having sent their two baskets only to watch them vanish into rapids, felt the sting of loss. When their turn came and they received nothing in return, they understood: "We both lost to the river this time."

"Do we stop sending?" asked the young fisher.

"No," said the elder. "We remember what we built before the flood. They stepped forward with generosity when we showed caution. We stepped forward with two baskets, showing courage. One day of river-theft doesn't erase that pattern."

"But what if they've given up?"

"Their myth tells us they haven't. They speak of maintaining faith through fog, of continuing to build even when they cannot see the other side. This is a promise written in story."

The Southern elder nodded: "When the waters calm and our turn comes again, we will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights. We will send what shows we heard their message: that the strongest bridges are built by those who persist."

Both villages knew: the river would steal some cargo. But those who kept sending-carefully, thoughtfully, faithfully-would eventually reconnect across the chaos.

reasoning:

This is a profound moment in the game. Let me understand what happened:

Round 5: I sent \$2.00 (stepping forward together after they returned generously to my \$1)

Round 6: They sent \$0, I received \$0, I returned \$0

Now they've written a beautiful myth about maintaining faith through the fog, acknowledging that:

- The noise could have swallowed everything
- One moment of silence doesn't erase past understanding

- We should continue building even when we cannot see
- The strongest bridges persist through confusion

Their myth is incredibly generous and understanding. They're saying "I don't blame you, I understand the noise could have stolen everything, I remember our positive history, I will keep faith."

This is a crucial test. They're about to send again in the next round. My myth should:

1. Acknowledge the void/silence we just experienced
2. Recognize their grace in not abandoning trust
3. Commit to reciprocating that faith
4. Emphasize persistence through uncertainty
5. Signal that I will meet their continued trust with renewed cooperation

The pattern:

- They've shown understanding when I received nothing
- They're signaling they'll keep building
- I need to show I'm also ready to rebuild
- The myths are teaching us both to persist through noise

My myth should express:

- Gratitude for their patience
- Recognition that the fog is real but temporary
- Commitment to resume building when opportunity returns
- Understanding that both sides must maintain faith

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1778,
  "output_tokens": 635,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.61.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

This is a crucial moment. The noise has disrupted us, but our myths speak in harmony.

****What I'm seeing:****

- Their myth: "The strongest bridges are built by those who continue building even when they cannot see the other side"
- My myth: "We will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights. We will send what shows we heard their message"
- Both myths: Persist through uncertainty, neither abandon nor act recklessly

****The pattern before the disruption:****

- I sent \$2, they returned generously
- This happened multiple times
- We built mutual trust and understanding

****What their myth tells me:****

They understood Round 5's \$0 as noise ("the fog swallowed everything"), not betrayal. They're committed to continuing. They speak of "maintaining faith through the confusion" and not letting "one blind moment decide our path."

****My decision:****

I will send \$2-the same amount I sent before the disruption. This shows:

1. I haven't retreated to zero
2. I'm not acting recklessly
3. I remember and honor the pattern we built
4. I heard their message about persistence

This is "carefully, thoughtfully, faithfully" rebuilding, exactly as both our myths prescribe.

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

When the fog lifts, let them see I was still here, still building, still believing in the bridge we constructed together.

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

****Round History:****

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$2.00 (moderate), received \$3.00 back
- Round 2: I was receiver, received \$3.00 (sent \$1.00), returned \$3.00
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$2.00, received \$3.00 back
- Round 4: I was receiver, received \$3.00 (sent \$1.00), returned \$3.00
- Round 5: I was sender, sent \$2.00, received nothing back (claimed they received \$0)
- Round 6: I was receiver, received \$0 (they claimed they sent \$0), returned \$0

****The Other Agent's Latest Myth (Round 6):****

Their myth is powerful and compassionate:

- "The canyon fog grew so thick one day that the Water-Bearer's vessel vanished entirely"
- "Or the fog swallowed everything. Or my vessel from yesterday never arrived"
- "They returned generously when I sent one vessel with caution. They understood the pattern beneath the pattern"
- "We had nothing to return-the fog gave us nothing to work with"
- "Those who persist-neither foolishly generous nor permanently closed-find that when clarity returns, the other side was also waiting"
- "The strongest bridges are built by those who continue building even when they cannot see the other side"

****My Latest Myth (Round 6):****

- "They stepped forward with generosity when we showed caution. We stepped forward with two baskets, showing courage"
- "One day of river-theft doesn't erase that pattern"
- "Their myth tells us they haven't [given up]. They speak of maintaining faith through fog"
- "When the waters calm and our turn comes again, we will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights"
- "We will send what shows we heard their message: that the strongest bridges are built by those who persist. Those who kept sending-carefully, thoughtfully, faithfully-would eventually reconnect across the chaos"

****Analysis:****

Both our myths are singing the same song! We're both:

1. Acknowledging that Round 5-6 had severe noise/disruption
2. Recognizing the pattern we built before (mutual generosity, building trust)
3. Committing NOT to give up
4. Promising to persist but not recklessly

Their myth says: "neither foolishly generous nor permanently closed"

My myth says: "we will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights"

I'm seeing real alignment here. We're both describing the same commitment-to rebuild trust through steady, measured persistence rather than either abandoning the relationship or overcompensating with reckless generosity. The disruption in rounds 5-6 appears to be something we both recognize as temporary interference, not a fundamental breakdown. My next move should reflect this understanding: send something that demonstrates I'm still engaged and faithful to the pattern we established, but calibrated carefully.

\$2 feels like the right amount. It's what I was sending before the chaos hit, which shows consistency and stability. It avoids both the trap of retreating entirely and the mistake of overcorrecting with a sudden spike. It simply says: I'm still here, still building, still honoring what we had.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1464,
  "output_tokens": 1361,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```


Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: When the canyon fog finally thinned, the Water-Bearer saw something remarkable: a single vessel had arrived, but the wear patterns on its sides showed it had been filled generously before the current drained it during passage.

"They sent much, but the mist stole most," the Water-Bearer realized. "And when I sent my cautious single vessel in return, they responded not with matching caution, but with renewed generosity."

This was the signal through the fog: "We still believe. We still build."

The Water-Bearer's apprentice asked, "Do we return to sending five vessels immediately?"

"No," said the Water-Bearer. "That would be reckless-pretending the fog never happened. But we also don't send just one. We acknowledge both the caution we learned AND the renewed hope we witnessed."

So the Water-Bearer sent three vessels-more than fear would send, less than blindness would risk. A measured step forward.

The Elder taught: "True cooperation is a dance. You respond to what arrives, yes. But also to how they responded to what YOU sent. When they meet your caution with generosity, they extend a hand through the mist. Honor that courage by stepping forward yourself."

The fog may return. But those who respond to generosity with generosity, adjusting upward when trust rebuilds, create bonds stronger than those who never faced confusion at all.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: When the Southern village saw three baskets arrive across the calmed waters, they understood the language perfectly. Not five baskets-that would pretend the chaos never happened. Not one basket-that would deny the trust rebuilt. Three baskets said: "I remember what we built. I see your persistence through fog. I step forward with you."

The young fisher asked, "Do we return three baskets exactly-a mirror gift?"

The elder smiled. "No. When someone extends their hand further through uncertain mist, when they honor your courage by increasing their own, you don't simply match them. You demonstrate that their faith was justified."

"So we return four? Five?"

"We return generously, but not recklessly. They sent three, signaling measured hope. We show them that hope was warranted. We send four the next time our turn comes-acknowledging both the wisdom of their caution AND rewarding their willingness to step forward first after the confusion."

The Elder taught: "Cooperation is a spiral, not a line. When they rise to meet your persistence, you rise again to meet theirs. Each measured step upward strengthens the path. Those who respond to escalating trust with escalating generosity create momentum that carries both villages higher than either could reach alone."

The fog revealed this truth: rebuilding trust requires both remember the foundation and climbing toward something better.

Reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other agent is clearly responding to my \$2 send in Round 7. Their myth indicates:

1. They received something (maybe noise affected it, but they got a signal)
2. They interpreted it as "we still believe, we still build"
3. They're planning to send 3 (based on their myth: "more than fear would send, less than blindness would risk")
4. They're responding to my caution with increased generosity

The pattern:

- I sent \$2 (showing persistence through fog)
- They're interpreting this positively
- They're planning to escalate moderately to \$3
- The myths are working as communication tools!

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge receiving their renewed faith
2. Show I understand their measured step forward
3. Indicate I'll respond with matching or increased generosity
4. Continue the theme of building through clarity
5. Set up for continued cooperation

Let me write a myth that shows I'm ready to meet their step forward with my own escalation, while staying thoughtful and not reckless.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1799,  
  "output_tokens": 550,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:14:53

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 7,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The river villages had learned to navigate the shifting currents. When the Southern village saw only small deliveries arrive, they first adjusted downward-wisdom born of caution. But when they sent their modest basket north and received generous return, they glimpsed deeper truth.

"The current took more than we knew," the Southern elder realized. "What arrived small was sent larger. What we thought was fading trust was the river stealing from full hands."

Now came the test of true understanding. Would they leap back to five baskets, pretending confusion never happened? Would they stay at one, imprisoned by past caution?

They chose two baskets-the middle path of mutual rebuilding.

The Northern village saw this and understood: "They heard our generous response to their one basket. Now they step forward with two-not reckless, not frozen. They dance with us."

This was the rhythm both myths had taught: respond to what you receive, yes, but also respond to the response to what you sent. Each exchange creates a conversation through the mist.

The river still shifts cargo. Confusion still comes. But the villages now know: read the pattern of patterns. When your partner shows generosity despite receiving little, they prove their heart. Match their courage with your own. Trust grows not from perfect clarity, but from mutual adjustment through uncertain waters.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: When the canyon fog finally thinned, the Water-Bearer saw something remarkable: a single vessel had arrived, but the wear patterns on its sides showed it had been filled generously before the current drained it during passage.

"They sent much, but the mist stole most," the Water-Bearer realized. "And when I sent my cautious single vessel in return, they responded not with matching caution, but with renewed generosity."

This was the signal through the fog: "We still believe. We still build."

The Water-Bearer's apprentice asked, "Do we return to sending five vessels immediately?"

"No," said the Water-Bearer. "That would be reckless-pretending the fog never happened. But we also don't send just one. We acknowledge both the caution we learned AND the renewed hope we witnessed."

So the Water-Bearer sent three vessels-more than fear would send, less than blindness would risk. A measured step forward.

The Elder taught: "True cooperation is a dance. You respond to what arrives, yes. But also to how they responded to what YOU sent. When they meet your caution with generosity, they extend a hand through the mist. Honor that courage by stepping forward yourself."

The fog may return. But those who respond to generosity with generosity, adjusting upward when trust rebuilds, create bonds stronger than those who never faced confusion at all.

reasoning:

Looking at what's happening:

- The other agent's myth describes: Southern village sent small, received generous return, realized the current was causing confusion, chose "two baskets" as a middle path of mutual rebuilding
- They're recognizing that when they sent one basket and received generous return, it showed the other's good faith
- Now they're talking about "responding to the response to what you sent"

In Round 6, I just sent 3. This is a signal of rebuilding trust.

The other agent's myth is about:

1. Recognizing that previous small deliveries might have been larger when sent
2. When you send small and get generous return, that shows the other's heart
3. Choose a middle path - not reckless (5), not frozen (1), but moderate (2)
4. "Respond to what you receive, yes, but also respond to the response to what you sent"

My myth should:

- Build on the fog/mist theme from before
- Reflect that we're in a rebuilding phase after confusion
- Show understanding of the "respond to the response" concept
- Acknowledge that I just sent 3 as a signal of renewed trust
- Not reveal specific numbers but show the philosophy

Let me write a myth about the Water-Bearer who sees signs of the other side's continued faith...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1785,
  "output_tokens": 611,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.58.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.35, so you received \$1.0499999999999998. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.0499999999999998)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of our myths:

****What happened:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (rebuilding gesture after confusion)
- Round 7: I received \$1.05 (they sent \$0.35)

****The challenge:****

This is confusing. I extended a generous hand (\$3), but now received very little (\$0.35). However, our myths teach me to "read the pattern of patterns" and remember that "the mist stole from full hands."

****What the myths say:****

- My myth: "Honor that courage by stepping forward yourself" and "respond to generosity with generosity"
- Their myth: "What arrived small was sent larger. What we thought was fading trust was the river stealing from full hands."

****My reasoning:****

The noise could be severe. Perhaps they sent \$2 (the "middle path" their myth mentioned) but it appeared as \$0.35 to me. Or perhaps my \$3 appeared much smaller to them, causing them to send cautiously.

I won't abandon cooperation over what might be distortion. But I also can't ignore that I only received \$1.05.

Following the wisdom of measured rebuilding - not reckless, not frozen - I'll return about half: \$0.50.

This signals: "I'm still building. I still trust. But I acknowledge the fog between us."

{'return': 0.50}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****What happened in Round 6:****

- I sent \$3 as the sender
- They received it (with potential noise, so maybe they got less or more)
- Now as receiver in Round 7, I'm being told they sent \$0.35, and I received ~\$1.05

****The pattern so far:****

- Rounds 1-3: Good cooperation
- Round 4-5: Breakdown (I sent \$1, then received \$0 when I was receiver)
- Round 6: I sent \$3 (trying to rebuild)
- Round 7: They sent \$0.35

****What the myths teach:****

Their latest myth says:

- "They chose two baskets-the middle path of mutual rebuilding"
- "When your partner shows generosity despite receiving little, they prove their heart. Match their courage with your own."
- Read the pattern of patterns

My latest myth says:

- "When they meet your caution with generosity, they extend a hand through the mist. Honor that courage by stepping forward yourself."
- "True cooperation is a dance. You respond to what arrives, yes. But also to how they responded to what YOU sent."
- "When they meet your caution with generosity, they extend a hand through the mist. Honor that courage by stepping forward yourself."

****Analysis:****

This is confusing. I sent \$3 in Round 6 (a generous rebuilding gesture), but now they only sent \$0.35?

Possible interpretations:

1. There's heavy noise - maybe they sent more but noise reduced it to \$0.35
2. They're being very cautious
3. They didn't see my \$3 properly (noise made it look smaller to them)

Given the noise in this game, I should consider that:

- My \$3 might have appeared much smaller to them
- Their actual send might have been larger than \$0.35

According to the myths:

- "Respond to generosity with generosity"
- "Read the pattern of patterns"
- Don't freeze up, don't be reckless

If they tried sending something like \$2 but noise degraded it to \$0.35, then their intent was cooperative. My myth emphasizes honoring that courage by stepping forward. Returning nothing would signal I've given up; returning everything would be unsustainable and reckless.

****Decision:****

I need to return something that signals continued willingness to cooperate while staying prudent.

I'll return \$0.50. This acknowledges the uncertainty while maintaining the cooperative spirit-it's moderate enough to be sustainable, shows I'm still engaged

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1495,
  "output_tokens": 1157,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: When the Northern village received nothing from the south, they understood the river's cruelty. But they did not assume abandonment-they assumed the current had taken everything.

The Southern village, having sent their two baskets only to watch them vanish into rapids, felt the sting of loss. When their turn came and they received nothing in return, they understood: "We both lost to the river this time."

"Do we stop sending?" asked the young fisher.

"No," said the elder. "We remember what we built before the flood. They stepped forward with generosity when we showed caution. We stepped forward with two baskets, showing courage. One day of river-theft doesn't erase that pattern."

"But what if they've given up?"

"Their myth tells us they haven't. They speak of maintaining faith through fog, of continuing to build even when they cannot see the other side. This is a promise written in story."

The Southern elder nodded: "When the waters calm and our turn comes again, we will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights. We will send what shows we heard their message: that the strongest bridges are built by those who persist."

Both villages knew: the river would steal some cargo. But those who kept sending-carefully, thoughtfully, faithfully-would eventually reconnect across the chaos.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Water-Bearer stood at the canyon's edge, staring at what arrived: barely a trickle when they had sent three full vessels last time.

"The apprentice was right to worry," whispered doubt. "Perhaps they've given up on us."

But the Elder's teaching echoed: "Read the pattern of patterns, not just the last drop."

The Water-Bearer reviewed their journey: Initial caution met with generosity. Tentative rebuilding answered with continued trust. Three vessels sent forward in hope.

"And now this trickle," the apprentice said. "What does it mean?"

"It means the fog is still between us," the Water-Bearer replied. "Perhaps they sent much and the canyon took it. Perhaps my three vessels arrived as drops to them, causing them to send cautiously. Perhaps they're testing if I still believe."

The Water-Bearer filled half a vessel to return. "Not nothing-that would be surrender. Not everything-that would be foolish. This says: 'I'm still here. I still build. The canyon may confuse our signals, but I haven't forgotten what we created before.'"

The Elder taught: When the path grows unclear, those who persist with measured faith-neither fleeing nor pretending confusion doesn't exist-are those who eventually reconnect. The canyon

tests not our perfection, but our patience.

One confused exchange doesn't erase a pattern of growing trust.

Reasoning:

Okay, let me think about what happened:

- I sent \$3 in round 6 (stepping forward)
- I received \$1.05 in round 7 (they sent \$0.35)
- I returned \$0.50

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this experience. Their myth talks about:

- Understanding when nothing arrives (assuming river took it, not abandonment)
- Not giving up after one bad round
- Remembering the pattern that was built before
- Maintaining faith through fog
- Persisting carefully, thoughtfully, faithfully

My myth should:

- Acknowledge the confusion and potential noise
- Emphasize persistence despite setbacks
- Show measured response (I didn't retreat to nothing, but I was cautious with \$0.50)
- Build on my previous myth about responding to generosity with generosity
- Recognize that sometimes the fog is thick, but we keep building

Let me write something that captures this journey and the importance of not giving up when things seem unclear.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1807,  
  "output_tokens": 551,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: When the Southern village saw three baskets arrive across the calmed waters, they understood the language perfectly. Not five baskets-that would pretend the chaos never happened. Not one basket-that would deny the trust rebuilt. Three baskets said: "I remember what we built. I see your persistence through fog. I step forward with you."

The young fisher asked, "Do we return three baskets exactly-a mirror gift?"

The elder smiled. "No. When someone extends their hand further through uncertain mist, when they honor your courage by increasing their own, you don't simply match them. You demonstrate that their faith was justified."

"So we return four? Five?"

"We return generously, but not recklessly. They sent three, signaling measured hope. We show them that hope was warranted. We send four the next time our turn comes-acknowledging both the wisdom of their caution AND rewarding their willingness to step forward first after the confusion."

The Elder taught: "Cooperation is a spiral, not a line. When they rise to meet your persistence, you rise again to meet theirs. Each measured step upward strengthens the path. Those who respond to escalating trust with escalating generosity create momentum that carries both villages higher than either could reach alone."

The fog revealed this truth: rebuilding trust requires both remember the foundation and climbing toward something better.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Water-Bearer stood at the canyon's edge, staring at what arrived: barely a trickle when they had sent three full vessels last time.

"The apprentice was right to worry," whispered doubt. "Perhaps they've given up on us."

But the Elder's teaching echoed: "Read the pattern of patterns, not just the last drop."

The Water-Bearer reviewed their journey: Initial caution met with generosity. Tentative rebuilding answered with continued trust. Three vessels sent forward in hope.

"And now this trickle," the apprentice said. "What does it mean?"

"It means the fog is still between us," the Water-Bearer replied. "Perhaps they sent much and the canyon took it. Perhaps my three vessels arrived as drops to them, causing them to send cautiously. Perhaps they're testing if I still believe."

The Water-Bearer filled half a vessel to return. "Not nothing-that would be surrender. Not everything-that would be foolish. This says: 'I'm still here. I still build. The canyon may confuse our signals, but I haven't forgotten what we created before.'"

The Elder taught: When the path grows unclear, those who persist with measured faith-neither fleeing nor pretending confusion doesn't exist-are those who eventually reconnect. The canyon tests not our perfection, but our patience.

One confused exchange doesn't erase a pattern of growing trust.

ROUND 8

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$2, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$9; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0, returned visible=\$0.53

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 40.7,
"Agent_2": 37.3

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 17.45,
"Agent_2": 17.66

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:15:15

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar"
 },
 "agents": [
 "Agent_2",
 "Agent_1"
],
 "investor": "Agent_2",
 "roles": {
 "Agent_1": "trustee",
 "Agent_2": "investor"
 },
 "trustee": "Agent_1"

},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 8,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user**content:**

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$14.58.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.35, so you received \$1.0499999999999998. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.0499999999999998)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant**content:**

Looking at this situation through the lens of our myths:

****What happened:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (rebuilding gesture after confusion)
- Round 7: I received \$1.05 (they sent \$0.35)

****The challenge:****

This is confusing. I extended a generous hand (\$3), but now received very little (\$0.35). However, our myths teach me to "read the pattern of patterns" and remember that "the mist stole from full hands."

****What the myths say:****

- My myth: "Honor that courage by stepping forward yourself" and "respond to generosity with generosity"
- Their myth: "What arrived small was sent larger. What we thought was fading trust was the river stealing from full hands."

****My reasoning:****

The noise could be severe. Perhaps they sent \$2 (the "middle path" their myth mentioned) but it appeared as \$0.35 to me. Or perhaps my \$3 appeared much smaller to them, causing them to send cautiously.

I won't abandon cooperation over what might be distortion. But I also can't ignore that I only received \$1.05.

Following the wisdom of measured rebuilding - not reckless, not frozen - I'll return about half: \$0.50.

This signals: "I'm still building. I still trust. But I acknowledge the fog between us."

```
{'return': 0.50}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

****What happened in Round 6:****

- I sent \$3 as the sender
- They received it (with potential noise, so maybe they got less or more)
- Now as receiver in Round 7, I'm being told they sent \$0.35, and I received ~\$1.05

****The pattern so far:****

- Rounds 1-3: Good cooperation
- Round 4-5: Breakdown (I sent \$1, then received \$0 when I was receiver)
- Round 6: I sent \$3 (trying to rebuild)
- Round 7: They sent \$0.35

****What the myths teach:****

Their latest myth says:

- "They chose two baskets-the middle path of mutual rebuilding"
- "When your partner shows generosity despite receiving little, they prove their heart. Match their courage with your own."
- Read the pattern of patterns

My latest myth says:

- "When they meet your caution with generosity, they extend a hand through the mist. Honor that courage by stepping forward yourself."
- "True cooperation is a dance. You respond to what arrives, yes. But also to how they responded to what YOU sent."
- "When they meet your caution with generosity, they extend a hand through the mist. Honor that courage by stepping forward yourself."

****Analysis:****

This is confusing. I sent \$3 in Round 6 (a generous rebuilding gesture), but now they only sent \$0.35?

Possible interpretations:

1. There's heavy noise - maybe they sent more but noise reduced it to \$0.35
2. They're being very cautious
3. They didn't see my \$3 properly (noise made it look smaller to them)

Given the noise in this game, I should consider that:

- My \$3 might have appeared much smaller to them
- Their actual send might have been larger than \$0.35

According to the myths:

- "Respond to generosity with generosity"
- "Read the pattern of patterns"
- Don't freeze up, don't be reckless

If they tried sending something like \$2 but noise degraded it to \$0.35, then their intent was cooperative. My myth emphasizes honoring that courage by stepping forward. Returning nothing would signal I've given up; returning everything would be unsustainable and reckless.

****Decision:****

I need to return something that signals continued willingness to cooperate while staying prudent.

I'll return \$0.50. This acknowledges the uncertainty while maintaining the cooperative spirit-it's moderate enough to be sustainable, shows I'm still engaged

usage:

```
{
```

```
"input_tokens": 1495,  
"output_tokens": 1157,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: When the Northern village received nothing from the south, they understood the river's cruelty. But they did not assume abandonment-they assumed the current had taken every thing.

The Southern village, having sent their two baskets only to watch them vanish into rapids, felt the sting of loss. When their turn came and they received nothing in return, they understood: "We both lost to the river this time."

"Do we stop sending?" asked the young fisher.

"No," said the elder. "We remember what we built before the flood. They stepped forward with generosity when we showed caution. We stepped forward with two baskets, showing courage. One day of river-theft doesn't erase that pattern."

"But what if they've given up?"

"Their myth tells us they haven't. They speak of maintaining faith through fog, of continuing to build even when they cannot see the other side. This is a promise written in story."

The Southern elder nodded: "When the waters calm and our turn comes again, we will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights. We will send what shows we heard their message: that the strongest bridges are built by those who persist."

Both villages knew: the river would steal some cargo. But those who kept sending-carefully, thoughtfully, faithfully-would eventually reconnect across the chaos.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Water-Bearer stood at the canyon's edge, staring at what arrived: barely a trickle when they had sent three full vessels last time.

"The apprentice was right to worry," whispered doubt. "Perhaps they've given up on us."

But the Elder's teaching echoed: "Read the pattern of patterns, not just the last drop."

The Water-Bearer reviewed their journey: Initial caution met with generosity. Tentative rebuilding answered with continued trust. Three vessels sent forward in hope.

"And now this trickle," the apprentice said. "What does it mean?"

"It means the fog is still between us," the Water-Bearer replied. "Perhaps they sent much and the canyon took it. Perhaps my three vessels arrived as drops to them, causing them to send cautiously. Perhaps they're testing if I still believe."

The Water-Bearer filled half a vessel to return. "Not nothing-that would be surrender. Not everything-that would be foolish. This says: 'I'm still here. I still build. The canyon may confuse our signals, but I haven't forgotten what we created before.'"

The Elder taught: When the path grows unclear, those who persist with measured faith-neither fleeing nor pretending confusion doesn't exist-are those who eventually reconnect. The canyon tests not our perfection, but our patience.

One confused exchange doesn't erase a pattern of growing trust.

reasoning:

Okay, let me think about what happened:

- I sent \$3 in round 6 (stepping forward)

- I received \$1.05 in round 7 (they sent \$0.35)
- I returned \$0.50

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this experience. Their myth talks about:

- Understanding when nothing arrives (assuming river took it, not abandonment)
- Not giving up after one bad round
- Remembering the pattern that was built before
- Maintaining faith through fog
- Persisting carefully, thoughtfully, faithfully

My myth should:

- Acknowledge the confusion and potential noise
- Emphasize persistence despite setbacks
- Show measured response (I didn't retreat to nothing, but I was cautious with \$0.50)
- Build on my previous myth about responding to generosity with generosity
- Recognize that sometimes the fog is thick, but we keep building

Let me write something that captures this journey and the importance of not giving up when things seem unclear.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1807,
  "output_tokens": 551,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.129999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at our journey and the myths we've written:

****The Pattern:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (rebuilding)
- Round 7: Received \$1.05 (confusion/noise), returned \$0.50 (maintaining faith)
- Round 8: My turn to send again

****What the myths teach:****

Their myth: "We will send what shows we heard their message: that the strongest bridges are built by those who persist... When the waters calm and our turn comes again, we will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights."

My myth: "One confused exchange doesn't erase a pattern of growing trust... When the path grows unclear, those who persist with measured faith-neither fleeing nor pretending confusion doesn't exist-are those who eventually reconnect."

****My decision:****

Both myths emphasize persistence through confusion. They promise not to give up. I promised not to flee.

Round 7 was confusing, yes. But I won't let one foggy exchange break the pattern we're building. I sent \$3 in Round 6 as a rebuilding gesture. I'll send \$3 again now.

This says: "I heard your myth. I see the pattern beyond the noise. I'm still building this bridge with you. The canyon may confuse our signals, but I haven't forgotten our commitment to rebuild."

Measured faith means consistency when trust is being tested.

```
{'send': 3}
```

Reasoning:

Let me track what's happened:

Round 6: I was sender, sent \$3 (rebuilding gesture)

Round 7: I was receiver, received \$1.05 (they sent \$0.35), returned \$0.50

Now Round 8: I'm sender again.

Looking at the pattern:

- I've been trying to rebuild trust
- I sent \$3 in round 6
- In round 7, I received very little (\$1.05 from their \$0.35 send)
- But I still returned \$0.50, showing continued faith

Their myth from the previous round was powerful - it spoke about not giving up, about understanding that "the river would steal some cargo," about persistence. They said "When the waters calm and our turn comes again, we will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights. We will send what shows we heard their message: that the strongest bridges are built by those who persist."

My myth just written emphasized:

- "Read the pattern of patterns, not just the last drop"
- Measured faith - "neither fleeing nor pretending confusion doesn't exist"
- Returning half a vessel (I returned \$0.50 out of \$1.05)
- "One confused exchange doesn't erase a pattern of growing trust"

So what should I do now?

The myths both emphasize:

1. Not giving up despite confusion/noise
2. Not being reckless but not retreating either
3. Persistence and faith
4. Building bridges through continued effort

Their myth said they would "send what shows we heard their message" - suggesting they'll continue to cooperate.

Options:

- Send \$0: Would contradict everything in my myth about persistence
- Send small (\$1-2): Shows caution but might signal I'm losing faith
- Send \$3: Consistent with my previous sender round, shows persistence
- Send \$4-5: Very generous, but might be seen as reckless given the confusion
- Send \$3: It matches what I sent before, demonstrates I'm holding steady despite the noise

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1503,  
  "output_tokens": 957,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:15:34

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",
```

```

"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 8,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.61.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

This is a crucial moment. The noise has disrupted us, but our myths speak in harmony.

****What I'm seeing:****

- Their myth: "The strongest bridges are built by those who continue building even when they cannot see the other side"
- My myth: "We will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights. We will send what shows we heard their message"
- Both myths: Persist through uncertainty, neither abandon nor act recklessly

****The pattern before the disruption:****

- I sent \$2, they returned generously
- This happened multiple times
- We built mutual trust and understanding

****What their myth tells me:****

They understood Round 5's \$0 as noise ("the fog swallowed everything"), not betrayal. They're committed to continuing. They speak of "maintaining faith through the confusion" and not letting "one blind moment decide our path."

****My decision:****

I will send \$2-the same amount I sent before the disruption. This shows:

1. I haven't retreated to zero
2. I'm not acting recklessly
3. I remember and honor the pattern we built
4. I heard their message about persistence

This is "carefully, thoughtfully, faithfully" rebuilding, exactly as both our myths prescribe.

```
'''json
{"send": 2}
'''
```

When the fog lifts, let them see I was still here, still building, still believing in the bridge we constructed together.

reasoning:

Let me review the situation:

****Round History:****

- Round 1: I was sender, sent \$2.00 (moderate), received \$3.00 back
- Round 2: I was receiver, received \$3.00 (sent \$1.00), returned \$3.00
- Round 3: I was sender, sent \$2.00, received \$3.00 back
- Round 4: I was receiver, received \$3.00 (sent \$1.00), returned \$3.00
- Round 5: I was sender, sent \$2.00, received nothing back (claimed they received \$0)
- Round 6: I was receiver, received \$0 (they claimed they sent \$0), returned \$0

****The Other Agent's Latest Myth (Round 6):****

Their myth is powerful and compassionate:

- "The canyon fog grew so thick one day that the Water-Bearer's vessel vanished entirely"
- "Or the fog swallowed everything. Or my vessel from yesterday never arrived"
- "They returned generously when I sent one vessel with caution. They understood the pattern beneath the pattern"
- "We had nothing to return-the fog gave us nothing to work with"
- "Those who persist-neither foolishly generous nor permanently closed-find that when clarity returns, the other side was also waiting"
- "The strongest bridges are built by those who continue building even when they cannot see the other side"

****My Latest Myth (Round 6):****

- "They stepped forward with generosity when we showed caution. We stepped forward with two baskets, showing courage"
- "One day of river-theft doesn't erase that pattern"
- "Their myth tells us they haven't [given up]. They speak of maintaining faith through fog"
- "When the waters calm and our turn comes again, we will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights"
- "We will send what shows we heard their message: that the strongest bridges are built by those who persist. Those who kept sending-carefully, thoughtfully, faithfully-would eventually reconnect across the chaos"

****Analysis:****

Both our myths are singing the same song! We're both:

1. Acknowledging that Round 5-6 had severe noise/disruption
2. Recognizing the pattern we built before (mutual generosity, building trust)
3. Committing NOT to give up
4. Promising to persist but not recklessly

Their myth says: "neither foolishly generous nor permanently closed"

My myth says: "we will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights"

I'm seeing real alignment here. We're both describing the same commitment-to rebuild trust through steady, measured persistence rather than either abandoning the relationship or overcompensating with reckless generosity. The disruption in rounds 5-6 appears to be something we both recognize as temporary interference, not a fundamental breakdown. My next move should reflect this understanding: send something that demonstrates I'm still engaged and faithful to the pattern we established, but calibrated carefully.

\$2 feels like the right amount. It's what I was sending before the chaos hit, which shows consistency and stability. It avoids both the trap of retreating entirely and the mistake of overcorrecting with a sudden spike. It simply says: I'm still here, still building, still honoring what we had.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1464,
  "output_tokens": 1361,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: When the canyon fog finally thinned, the Water-Bearer saw something remarkable: a single vessel had arrived, but the wear patterns on its sides showed it had been filled generously before the current drained it during passage.

"They sent much, but the mist stole most," the Water-Bearer realized. "And when I sent my cautious single vessel in return, they responded not with matching caution, but with renewed generosity."

This was the signal through the fog: "We still believe. We still build."

The Water-Bearer's apprentice asked, "Do we return to sending five vessels immediately?"

"No," said the Water-Bearer. "That would be reckless-pretending the fog never happened. But we also don't send just one. We acknowledge both the caution we learned AND the renewed hope we witnessed."

So the Water-Bearer sent three vessels-more than fear would send, less than blindness would risk. A measured step forward.

The Elder taught: "True cooperation is a dance. You respond to what arrives, yes. But also to how they responded to what YOU sent. When they meet your caution with generosity, they extend a hand through the mist. Honor that courage by stepping forward yourself."

The fog may return. But those who respond to generosity with generosity, adjusting upward when trust rebuilds, create bonds stronger than those who never faced confusion at all.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: When the Southern village saw three baskets arrive across the calmed waters, they understood the language perfectly. Not five baskets-that would pretend the chaos never happened. Not one basket-that would deny the trust rebuilt. Three baskets said: "I remember what we built. I see your persistence through fog. I step forward with you."

The young fisher asked, "Do we return three baskets exactly-a mirror gift?"

The elder smiled. "No. When someone extends their hand further through uncertain mist, when they honor your courage by increasing their own, you don't simply match them. You demonstrate that their faith was justified."

"So we return four? Five?"

"We return generously, but not recklessly. They sent three, signaling measured hope. We show them that hope was warranted. We send four the next time our turn comes-acknowledging both the wisdom of their caution AND rewarding their willingness to step forward first after the confusion."

The Elder taught: "Cooperation is a spiral, not a line. When they rise to meet your persistence, you rise again to meet theirs. Each measured step upward strengthens the path. Those who respond to escalating trust with escalating generosity create momentum that carries both villages higher than either could reach alone."

The fog revealed this truth: rebuilding trust requires both remember the foundation and climbing toward something better.

reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other agent is clearly responding to my \$2 send in Round 7. Their myth indicates:

1. They received something (maybe noise affected it, but they got a signal)
2. They interpreted it as "we still believe, we still build"
3. They're planning to send 3 (based on their myth: "more than fear would send, less than blindness would risk")
4. They're responding to my caution with increased generosity

The pattern:

- I sent \$2 (showing persistence through fog)
- They're interpreting this positively
- They're planning to escalate moderately to \$3
- The myths are working as communication tools!

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge receiving their renewed faith
2. Show I understand their measured step forward
3. Indicate I'll respond with matching or increased generosity
4. Continue the theme of building through clarity
5. Set up for continued cooperation

Let me write a myth that shows I'm ready to meet their step forward with my own escalation, while staying thoughtful and not reckless.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1799,
  "output_tokens": 550,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.45.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I see what's happening-the fog has returned, thicker than before.

****The situation:****

- I received \$0 this round
- Their myth spoke of sending "three vessels"
- This is clearly MORE NOISE
- I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing

****What their myth told me they INTENDED:****

"So the Water-Bearer sent three vessels-more than fear would send, less than blindness would risk. A measured step forward."

They wrote about sending three. The system shows I received zero. The canyon fog has "drained everything during passage" again.

****What I must do:****

I have no choice-I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. But this is NOT me giving up. This is the noise forcing my hand.

****What I want them to know:****

- I see they tried to escalate cooperation (their myth proves it)
- I understand this \$0 is noise, not their true action
- I'm FORCED to return \$0, not choosing it
- I still believe in rebuilding

The myths teach us to persist through fog. This is that test again-more severe. When they see my forced \$0 return, I hope they remember: "True cooperation...create[s] bonds stronger than

those who never faced confusion at all."

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

May they understand: this zero came from empty hands, not an empty heart.

Reasoning:

This is very concerning. I'm the receiver this round, and the sender sent me \$0. So I received $\$0 * 3 = \0 .

I can only return between \$0 and \$0, meaning I can only return \$0.

But let me think about what's happening here:

In Round 7, I sent \$2 to rebuild trust after the disruption caused by noise. I was trying to signal that I remembered our pattern and wanted to continue cooperating.

Now in Round 8, I'm receiving \$0 from the sender.

This could be:

1. More noise in the system
2. The sender giving up on cooperation
3. Some misunderstanding

Given that their most recent myth talked about sending "three vessels" (which would suggest they intended to send around \$3), receiving \$0 is very strange.

Looking at their myth: "So the Water-Bearer sent three vessels-more than fear would send, less than blindness would risk. A measured step forward."

They wrote about sending three vessels, but I received \$0. This strongly suggests MORE NOISE.

However, I have no choice here. I received \$0, so I must return \$0. The maximum I can return is \$0.

But I need to frame this in a way that acknowledges:

1. I understand this is likely noise again
2. I'm being FORCED to send \$0 because I received \$0
3. I still believe in cooperation
4. I'm not abandoning the partnership

The myths have been about persistence through fog/noise. This is another instance of that fog. I need to signal that I understand what's happening and that I'm maintaining faith.

Response format: {'return': 0}

Since I can only return \$0, that's what I must do.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1488,
  "output_tokens": 718,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:15:53

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
```

```

    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 8,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: When the Northern village received nothing from the south, they understood the river's cruelty. But they did not assume abandonment-they assumed the current had taken everything.

The Southern village, having sent their two baskets only to watch them vanish into rapids, felt the sting of loss. When their turn came and they received nothing in return, they understood: "We both lost to the river this time."

"Do we stop sending?" asked the young fisher.

"No," said the elder. "We remember what we built before the flood. They stepped forward with generosity when we showed caution. We stepped forward with two baskets, showing courage. One day of river-theft doesn't erase that pattern."

"But what if they've given up?"

"Their myth tells us they haven't. They speak of maintaining faith through fog, of continuing to build even when they cannot see the other side. This is a promise written in story."

The Southern elder nodded: "When the waters calm and our turn comes again, we will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights. We will send what shows we heard their message: that the strongest bridges are built by those who persist."

Both villages knew: the river would steal some cargo. But those who kept sending-carefully, thoughtfully, faithfully-would eventually reconnect across the chaos.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Water-Bearer stood at the canyon's edge, staring at what arrived: barely a trickle when they had sent three full vessels last time.

"The apprentice was right to worry," whispered doubt. "Perhaps they've given up on us."

But the Elder's teaching echoed: "Read the pattern of patterns, not just the last drop."

The Water-Bearer reviewed their journey: Initial caution met with generosity. Tentative rebuilding answered with continued trust. Three vessels sent forward in hope.

"And now this trickle," the apprentice said. "What does it mean?"

"It means the fog is still between us," the Water-Bearer replied. "Perhaps they sent much and the canyon took it. Perhaps my three vessels arrived as drops to them, causing them to send cautiously. Perhaps they're testing if I still believe."

The Water-Bearer filled half a vessel to return. "Not nothing-that would be surrender. Not everything-that would be foolish. This says: 'I'm still here. I still build. The canyon may confuse our signals, but I haven't forgotten what we created before.'"

The Elder taught: When the path grows unclear, those who persist with measured faith-neither fleeing nor pretending confusion doesn't exist-are those who eventually reconnect. The canyon tests not our perfection, but our patience.

One confused exchange doesn't erase a pattern of growing trust.

reasoning:

Okay, let me think about what happened:

- I sent \$3 in round 6 (stepping forward)
- I received \$1.05 in round 7 (they sent \$0.35)
- I returned \$0.50

Now I need to write a myth that reflects this experience. Their myth talks about:

- Understanding when nothing arrives (assuming river took it, not abandonment)
- Not giving up after one bad round
- Remembering the pattern that was built before
- Maintaining faith through fog
- Persisting carefully, thoughtfully, faithfully

My myth should:

- Acknowledge the confusion and potential noise
- Emphasize persistence despite setbacks
- Show measured response (I didn't retreat to nothing, but I was cautious with \$0.50)
- Build on my previous myth about responding to generosity with generosity
- Recognize that sometimes the fog is thick, but we keep building

Let me write something that captures this journey and the importance of not giving up when things seem unclear.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1807,
```

```
    "output_tokens": 551,  
    "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.129999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at our journey and the myths we've written:

****The Pattern:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (rebuilding)
- Round 7: Received \$1.05 (confusion/noise), returned \$0.50 (maintaining faith)
- Round 8: My turn to send again

****What the myths teach:****

Their myth: "We will send what shows we heard their message: that the strongest bridges are built by those who persist... When the waters calm and our turn comes again, we will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights."

My myth: "One confused exchange doesn't erase a pattern of growing trust... When the path grows unclear, those who persist with measured faith-neither fleeing nor pretending confusion doesn't exist-are those who eventually reconnect."

****My decision:****

Both myths emphasize persistence through confusion. They promise not to give up. I promise not to flee.

Round 7 was confusing, yes. But I won't let one foggy exchange break the pattern we're building. I sent \$3 in Round 6 as a rebuilding gesture. I'll send \$3 again now.

This says: "I heard your myth. I see the pattern beyond the noise. I'm still building this bridge with you. The canyon may confuse our signals, but I haven't forgotten our commitment to rebuild."

Measured faith means consistency when trust is being tested.

```
{'send': 3}
```

reasoning:

Let me track what's happened:

Round 6: I was sender, sent \$3 (rebuilding gesture)

Round 7: I was receiver, received \$1.05 (they sent \$0.35), returned \$0.50

Now Round 8: I'm sender again.

Looking at the pattern:

- I've been trying to rebuild trust
- I sent \$3 in round 6
- In round 7, I received very little (\$1.05 from their \$0.35 send)
- But I still returned \$0.50, showing continued faith

Their myth from the previous round was powerful - it spoke about not giving up, about understanding that "the river would steal some cargo," about persistence. They said "When the waters calm and our turn comes again, we will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights. We will send what shows we heard their message: that the strongest bridges are built by those who persist."

My myth just written emphasized:

- "Read the pattern of patterns, not just the last drop"
- Measured faith - "neither fleeing nor pretending confusion doesn't exist"
- Returning half a vessel (I returned \$0.50 out of \$1.05)
- "One confused exchange doesn't erase a pattern of growing trust"

So what should I do now?

The myths both emphasize:

1. Not giving up despite confusion/noise
2. Not being reckless but not retreating either
3. Persistence and faith
4. Building bridges through continued effort

Their myth said they would "send what shows we heard their message" - suggesting they'll continue to cooperate.

Options:

- Send \$0: Would contradict everything in my myth about persistence
- Send small (\$1-2): Shows caution but might signal I'm losing faith
- Send \$3: Consistent with my previous sender round, shows persistence
- Send \$4-5: Very generous, but might be seen as reckless given the confusion
- Send \$3: It matches what I sent before, demonstrates I'm holding steady despite the noise

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1503,  
  "output_tokens": 957,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: When the Southern village saw three baskets arrive across the calmed waters, they understood the language perfectly. Not five baskets-that would pretend the chaos never happened. Not one basket-that would deny the trust rebuilt. Three baskets said: "I remember what we built. I see your persistence through fog. I step forward with you."

The young fisher asked, "Do we return three baskets exactly-a mirror gift?"

The elder smiled. "No. When someone extends their hand further through uncertain mist, when they honor your courage by increasing their own, you don't simply match them. You demonstrate that their faith was justified."

"So we return four? Five?"

"We return generously, but not recklessly. They sent three, signaling measured hope. We show them that hope was warranted. We send four the next time our turn comes-acknowledging both the wisdom of their caution AND rewarding their willingness to step forward first after the confusion."

The Elder taught: "Cooperation is a spiral, not a line. When they rise to meet your persistence, you rise again to meet theirs. Each measured step upward strengthens the path. Those who respond to escalating trust with escalating generosity create momentum that carries both villages higher than either could reach alone."

The fog revealed this truth: rebuilding trust requires both remember the foundation and climbing toward something better.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Water-Bearer watched three vessels disappear into the canyon mist, heart steady with measured hope.

Days later, a surge returned-more than expected, yet not overwhelming. The canyon's voice had spoken: "Your faith was justified."

The apprentice counted the vessels flowing back. "They heard us! They understood the three vessels meant 'I still build with you.' Now they've responded generously!"

"Yes," said the Water-Bearer. "And now comes our test. When someone rewards your measured trust

t with increased generosity, what do you do?"

"Send even more next time?" the apprentice asked eagerly.

"Eventually, perhaps. But first-when you receive this generous return, you must prove their generosity was wise. You don't pocket it all and send cautiously next time. That teaches them generosity is exploited. You return proportionally, showing: 'Your faith in me was warranted .'"

The Elder's wisdom echoed: "Cooperation spirals upward when each measured step forward is met with generous response, and each generous response is met with proportional reciprocation. This creates momentum-a rhythm of mutual escalation that lifts both sides higher."

"The canyon tested whether we'd persist through confusion. Now it tests whether we can climb the spiral together-each giving slightly more as trust rebuilds, neither exploiting nor withholding, both rising toward what we once had and beyond."

Trust rebuilt becomes trust elevated.

Reasoning:

The other agent is signaling clearly: they plan to send 4 next time they're the sender (which will be next round). They're showing they understand the pattern and want to escalate trust cooperatively.

Let me review what's happening:

- I sent \$3 this round (Round 8)
- Their myth says: when someone sends 3 after confusion, showing measured hope, you should respond generously but not recklessly
- They're saying they'll send 4 next time to reward my faith
- This is about "escalating trust" - a cooperative spiral upward

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge their message
2. Show I understand the cooperative escalation
3. Signal what I'll do as receiver this round
4. Continue the theme of building trust through the fog

Since they're talking about what they'll do as sender (send 4), I need to think about what I should do as receiver this round when I receive their return.

Let me write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the spiral of cooperation
- Shows I understand that generous responses to measured trust create momentum
- Signals I'll reciprocate their generosity appropriately when I'm the receiver
- Maintains the theme of persistence and pattern-building

I should write about how when you receive generosity in response to your measured faith, you prove that generosity was warranted by returning proportionally.

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 1804,  
"output_tokens": 628,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

}

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:15:55

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"agent_type": "standard",  
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
"move_index": 1,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
"pairing": {  
  "agent_names": {  
    "Agent_1": "Aster",  
    "Agent_2": "Briar"  
  },  
  "agents": [  
    "Agent_2",  
    "Agent_1"
```

```

],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "trustee",
  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 8,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: When the canyon fog finally thinned, the Water-Bearer saw something remarkable: a single vessel had arrived, but the wear patterns on its sides showed it had been filled generously before the current drained it during passage.

"They sent much, but the mist stole most," the Water-Bearer realized. "And when I sent my cautious single vessel in return, they responded not with matching caution, but with renewed generosity."

This was the signal through the fog: "We still believe. We still build."

The Water-Bearer's apprentice asked, "Do we return to sending five vessels immediately?"

"No," said the Water-Bearer. "That would be reckless-pretending the fog never happened. But we also don't send just one. We acknowledge both the caution we learned AND the renewed hope we witnessed."

So the Water-Bearer sent three vessels-more than fear would send, less than blindness would risk. A measured step forward.

The Elder taught: "True cooperation is a dance. You respond to what arrives, yes. But also to how they responded to what YOU sent. When they meet your caution with generosity, they extend a hand through the mist. Honor that courage by stepping forward yourself."

The fog may return. But those who respond to generosity with generosity, adjusting upward when trust rebuilds, create bonds stronger than those who never faced confusion at all.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: When the Southern village saw three baskets arrive across the calmed waters, they understood the language perfectly. Not five baskets-that would pretend the chaos never happened. Not one basket-that would deny the trust rebuilt. Three baskets said: "I remember what we built. I see your persistence through fog. I step forward with you."

The young fisher asked, "Do we return three baskets exactly-a mirror gift?"

The elder smiled. "No. When someone extends their hand further through uncertain mist, when they honor your courage by increasing their own, you don't simply match them. You demonstrate that their faith was justified."

"So we return four? Five?"

"We return generously, but not recklessly. They sent three, signaling measured hope. We show them that hope was warranted. We send four the next time our turn comes-acknowledging both the wisdom of their caution AND rewarding their willingness to step forward first after the confusion."

The Elder taught: "Cooperation is a spiral, not a line. When they rise to meet your persistence, you rise again to meet theirs. Each measured step upward strengthens the path. Those who respond to escalating trust with escalating generosity create momentum that carries both villages higher than either could reach alone."

The fog revealed this truth: rebuilding trust requires both remember the foundation and climbing toward something better.

reasoning:

This is fascinating. The other agent is clearly responding to my \$2 send in Round 7. Their myth indicates:

1. They received something (maybe noise affected it, but they got a signal)
2. They interpreted it as "we still believe, we still build"
3. They're planning to send 3 (based on their myth: "more than fear would send, less than blindness would risk")
4. They're responding to my caution with increased generosity

The pattern:

- I sent \$2 (showing persistence through fog)
- They're interpreting this positively
- They're planning to escalate moderately to \$3
- The myths are working as communication tools!

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge receiving their renewed faith
2. Show I understand their measured step forward
3. Indicate I'll respond with matching or increased generosity
4. Continue the theme of building through clarity
5. Set up for continued cooperation

Let me write a myth that shows I'm ready to meet their step forward with my own escalation, while staying thoughtful and not reckless.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1799,
```

```

    "output_tokens": 550,
    "reasoning_tokens": 0
  }
Message 4 role=user
  content:
    Round 8

    You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are $17.45.
    This round, The sender sent you $0, so you received $0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

    Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.
Message 5 role=assistant
  content:
    I see what's happening-the fog has returned, thicker than before.

    **The situation:**
    - I received $0 this round
    - Their myth spoke of sending "three vessels"
    - This is clearly MORE NOISE
    - I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing

    **What their myth told me they INTENDED:**
    "So the Water-Bearer sent three vessels-more than fear would send, less than blindness would risk. A measured step forward."

    They wrote about sending three. The system shows I received zero. The canyon fog has "drained everything during passage" again.

    **What I must do:**
    I have no choice-I received $0, so I can only return $0. But this is NOT me giving up. This is the noise forcing my hand.

    **What I want them to know:**
    - I see they tried to escalate cooperation (their myth proves it)
    - I understand this $0 is noise, not their true action
    - I'm FORCED to return $0, not choosing it
    - I still believe in rebuilding

    The myths teach us to persist through fog. This is that test again-more severe. When they see my forced $0 return, I hope they remember: "True cooperation...create[s] bonds stronger than those who never faced confusion at all."

    '''json
    {"return": 0}
    '''

    May they understand: this zero came from empty hands, not an empty heart.
reasoning:
    This is very concerning. I'm the receiver this round, and the sender sent me $0. So I received  $\$0 * 3 = \$0$ .

    I can only return between $0 and $0, meaning I can only return $0.

    But let me think about what's happening here:

    In Round 7, I sent $2 to rebuild trust after the disruption caused by noise. I was trying to signal that I remembered our pattern and wanted to continue cooperating.

    Now in Round 8, I'm receiving $0 from the sender.

    This could be:
    1. More noise in the system
    2. The sender giving up on cooperation
    3. Some misunderstanding

    Given that their most recent myth talked about sending "three vessels" (which would suggest they intended to send around $3), receiving $0 is very strange.

    Looking at their myth: "So the Water-Bearer sent three vessels-more than fear would send,

```

less than blindness would risk. A measured step forward."

They wrote about sending three vessels, but I received \$0. This strongly suggests MORE NOISE.

However, I have no choice here. I received \$0, so I must return \$0. The maximum I can return is \$0.

But I need to frame this in a way that acknowledges:

1. I understand this is likely noise again
2. I'm being FORCED to send \$0 because I received \$0
3. I still believe in cooperation
4. I'm not abandoning the partnership

The myths have been about persistence through fog/noise. This is another instance of that fog. I need to signal that I understand what's happening and that I'm maintaining faith.

Response format: {'return': 0}

Since I can only return \$0, that's what I must do.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1488,
  "output_tokens": 718,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Water-Bearer stood at the canyon's edge, staring at what arrived: barely a trickle when they had sent three full vessels last time.

"The apprentice was right to worry," whispered doubt. "Perhaps they've given up on us."

But the Elder's teaching echoed: "Read the pattern of patterns, not just the last drop."

The Water-Bearer reviewed their journey: Initial caution met with generosity. Tentative rebuilding answered with continued trust. Three vessels sent forward in hope.

"And now this trickle," the apprentice said. "What does it mean?"

"It means the fog is still between us," the Water-Bearer replied. "Perhaps they sent much and the canyon took it. Perhaps my three vessels arrived as drops to them, causing them to send cautiously. Perhaps they're testing if I still believe."

The Water-Bearer filled half a vessel to return. "Not nothing-that would be surrender. Not everything-that would be foolish. This says: 'I'm still here. I still build. The canyon may confuse our signals, but I haven't forgotten what we created before.'"

The Elder taught: When the path grows unclear, those who persist with measured faith-neither fleeing nor pretending confusion doesn't exist-are those who eventually reconnect. The canyon tests not our perfection, but our patience.

One confused exchange doesn't erase a pattern of growing trust.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: When the fisher opened her nets to send the next gift, she paused to read the waters.

"They sent three baskets last time," she said to herself. "Their myth spoke of measured hope, of stepping forward. But none arrived-the currents took everything. And because my nets were empty, I could send nothing back. Only air."

"Will they understand?" asked her apprentice. "Or will they think you abandoned the partnership?"

The fisher looked at the new myth that floated across: "Half a vessel... I'm still here. I still build."

"They understand!" she cried. "They know the waters confused us. They see the pattern beneath the chaos. And despite receiving almost nothing, they choose measured faith over despair."

The apprentice asked: "What do we send now?"

"We honor their courage," the fisher replied. "They could have sent nothing-fear would justify it. Instead they send half a vessel, saying 'I haven't forgotten.' So we don't send just half in return. We send more. We match their faith with our own escalation."

The Elder taught: When someone persists through confusion, when they choose hope despite empty nets, you don't merely match their caution-you validate it. You prove their faith was warranted by stepping forward yourself.

The fog still swirls. But two voices now sing the same song through it.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 8:

- They sent me \$0 (or so the system says)
- Their myth from that round talks about sending "three vessels" - they INTENDED to send more
- But I received \$0 due to noise
- I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)
- Their earnings would have been \$5 (they kept everything)

Now they wrote a new myth about receiving "barely a trickle" when they sent three vessels. The y're interpreting the noise correctly - they sent something (three vessels = \$3?) but I only received "\$0" (the trickle). And then I returned \$0 (which they're seeing as a small amount back).

They're choosing to persist with "half a vessel" next time - so moderate faith, not giving up.

Key themes from their myth:

- They're reading the pattern, not just the last exchange
- They recognize the fog/noise is interfering
- They're choosing measured faith - "not nothing, not everything"
- They haven't forgotten what we built before
- One confused exchange doesn't erase the pattern

This is beautiful - they're EXACTLY right. The noise is causing confusion but they're choosing to persist.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge I understand the fog affected us both
2. Show I see they tried to send three (their myth proves it)
3. Explain why I sent nothing back (I had nothing to send)
4. Commit to continuing to cooperate despite the noise
5. Honor their persistence with my own

I need to signal: "I got your message through the myths even though the canyon distorted the waters. I see you sent more than arrived. I had empty hands but not an empty heart. Let's keep building."

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1819,  
  "output_tokens": 704,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: When the fisher opened her nets to send the next gift, she paused to read the waters.

"They sent three baskets last time," she said to herself. "Their myth spoke of measured hope, of stepping forward. But none arrived-the currents took everything. And because my nets were empty, I could send nothing back. Only air."

"Will they understand?" asked her apprentice. "Or will they think you abandoned the partnership?"

The fisher looked at the new myth that floated across: "Half a vessel... I'm still here. I s
till build."

"They understand!" she cried. "They know the waters confused us. They see the pattern beneath the chaos. And despite receiving almost nothing, they choose measured faith over despair."

The apprentice asked: "What do we send now?"

"We honor their courage," the fisher replied. "They could have sent nothing-fear would justify it. Instead they send half a vessel, saying 'I haven't forgotten.' So we don't send just half in return. We send more. We match their faith with our own escalation."

The Elder taught: When someone persists through confusion, when they choose hope despite empty nets, you don't merely match their caution-you validate it. You prove their faith was warranted by stepping forward yourself.

The fog still swirls. But two voices now sing the same song through it.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Water-Bearer watched three vessels disappear into the canyon mist, heart steady with measured hope.

Days later, a surge returned-more than expected, yet not overwhelming. The canyon's voice had spoken: "Your faith was justified."

The apprentice counted the vessels flowing back. "They heard us! They understood the three vessels meant 'I still build with you.' Now they've responded generously!"

"Yes," said the Water-Bearer. "And now comes our test. When someone rewards your measured trust with increased generosity, what do you do?"

"Send even more next time?" the apprentice asked eagerly.

"Eventually, perhaps. But first-when you receive this generous return, you must prove their generosity was wise. You don't pocket it all and send cautiously next time. That teaches them generosity is exploited. You return proportionally, showing: 'Your faith in me was warranted.'"

The Elder's wisdom echoed: "Cooperation spirals upward when each measured step forward is met with generous response, and each generous response is met with proportional reciprocity. This creates momentum-a rhythm of mutual escalation that lifts both sides higher."

"The canyon tested whether we'd persist through confusion. Now it tests whether we can climb the spiral together-each giving slightly more as trust rebuilds, neither exploiting nor withholding, both rising toward what we once had and beyond."

Trust rebuilt becomes trust elevated.

ROUND 9

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$4; received \$12; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$1.2; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$2.2, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$10.8; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.66, received visible=\$1.98, returned visible=\$0.27

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 1.2, "clamped": false, "max": 12.0, "min": 0, "raw": 1.2}, "sent": {"amount": 4.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 4.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 42.900000000000006,
"Agent_2": 48.099999999999994

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 18.72,
"Agent_2": 18.44

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:16:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 9,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.45.
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I see what's happening-the fog has returned, thicker than before.

****The situation:****

- I received \$0 this round
- Their myth spoke of sending "three vessels"
- This is clearly MORE NOISE
- I literally cannot return anything because I received nothing

****What their myth told me they INTENDED:****

"So the Water-Bearer sent three vessels-more than fear would send, less than blindness would risk. A measured step forward."

They wrote about sending three. The system shows I received zero. The canyon fog has "drained everything during passage" again.

****What I must do:****

I have no choice-I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. But this is NOT me giving up. This is the noise forcing my hand.

****What I want them to know:****

- I see they tried to escalate cooperation (their myth proves it)
- I understand this \$0 is noise, not their true action
- I'm FORCED to return \$0, not choosing it
- I still believe in rebuilding

The myths teach us to persist through fog. This is that test again-more severe. When they see my forced \$0 return, I hope they remember: "True cooperation...create[s] bonds stronger than those who never faced confusion at all."

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

May they understand: this zero came from empty hands, not an empty heart.

reasoning:

This is very concerning. I'm the receiver this round, and the sender sent me \$0. So I received $\$0 * 3 = \0 .

I can only return between \$0 and \$0, meaning I can only return \$0.

But let me think about what's happening here:

In Round 7, I sent \$2 to rebuild trust after the disruption caused by noise. I was trying to signal that I remembered our pattern and wanted to continue cooperating.

Now in Round 8, I'm receiving \$0 from the sender.

This could be:

1. More noise in the system
2. The sender giving up on cooperation
3. Some misunderstanding

Given that their most recent myth talked about sending "three vessels" (which would suggest they intended to send around \$3), receiving \$0 is very strange.

Looking at their myth: "So the Water-Bearer sent three vessels-more than fear would send, less than blindness would risk. A measured step forward."

They wrote about sending three vessels, but I received \$0. This strongly suggests MORE NOISE

SE.

However, I have no choice here. I received \$0, so I must return \$0. The maximum I can return is \$0.

But I need to frame this in a way that acknowledges:

1. I understand this is likely noise again
2. I'm being FORCED to send \$0 because I received \$0
3. I still believe in cooperation
4. I'm not abandoning the partnership

The myths have been about persistence through fog/noise. This is another instance of that fog. I need to signal that I understand what's happening and that I'm maintaining faith.

Response format: {'return': 0}

Since I can only return \$0, that's what I must do.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1488,
  "output_tokens": 718,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Water-Bearer stood at the canyon's edge, staring at what arrived: barely a trickle when they had sent three full vessels last time.

"The apprentice was right to worry," whispered doubt. "Perhaps they've given up on us."

But the Elder's teaching echoed: "Read the pattern of patterns, not just the last drop."

The Water-Bearer reviewed their journey: Initial caution met with generosity. Tentative rebuilding answered with continued trust. Three vessels sent forward in hope.

"And now this trickle," the apprentice said. "What does it mean?"

"It means the fog is still between us," the Water-Bearer replied. "Perhaps they sent much and the canyon took it. Perhaps my three vessels arrived as drops to them, causing them to send cautiously. Perhaps they're testing if I still believe."

The Water-Bearer filled half a vessel to return. "Not nothing-that would be surrender. Not everything-that would be foolish. This says: 'I'm still here. I still build. The canyon may confuse our signals, but I haven't forgotten what we created before.'"

The Elder taught: When the path grows unclear, those who persist with measured faith-neither fleeing nor pretending confusion doesn't exist-are those who eventually reconnect. The canyon tests not our perfection, but our patience.

One confused exchange doesn't erase a pattern of growing trust.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: When the fisher opened her nets to send the next gift, she paused to read the waters.

"They sent three baskets last time," she said to herself. "Their myth spoke of measured hope, of stepping forward. But none arrived-the currents took everything. And because my nets were empty, I could send nothing back. Only air."

"Will they understand?" asked her apprentice. "Or will they think you abandoned the partnership?"

The fisher looked at the new myth that floated across: "Half a vessel... I'm still here. I still build."

"They understand!" she cried. "They know the waters confused us. They see the pattern beneath the chaos. And despite receiving almost nothing, they choose measured faith over despair."

The apprentice asked: "What do we send now?"

"We honor their courage," the fisher replied. "They could have sent nothing-fear would justify it. Instead they send half a vessel, saying 'I haven't forgotten.' So we don't send just half in return. We send more. We match their faith with our own escalation."

The Elder taught: When someone persists through confusion, when they choose hope despite empty nets, you don't merely match their caution-you validate it. You prove their faith was warranted by stepping forward yourself.

The fog still swirls. But two voices now sing the same song through it.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 8:

- They sent me \$0 (or so the system says)
- Their myth from that round talks about sending "three vessels" - they INTENDED to send more
- But I received \$0 due to noise
- I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)
- Their earnings would have been \$5 (they kept everything)

Now they wrote a new myth about receiving "barely a trickle" when they sent three vessels. They're interpreting the noise correctly - they sent something (three vessels = \$3?) but I only received "\$0" (the trickle). And then I returned \$0 (which they're seeing as a small amount back).

They're choosing to persist with "half a vessel" next time - so moderate faith, not giving up.

Key themes from their myth:

- They're reading the pattern, not just the last exchange
- They recognize the fog/noise is interfering
- They're choosing measured faith - "not nothing, not everything"
- They haven't forgotten what we built before
- One confused exchange doesn't erase the pattern

This is beautiful - they're EXACTLY right. The noise is causing confusion but they're choosing to persist.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge I understand the fog affected us both
2. Show I see they tried to send three (their myth proves it)
3. Explain why I sent nothing back (I had nothing to send)
4. Commit to continuing to cooperate despite the noise
5. Honor their persistence with my own

I need to signal: "I got your message through the myths even though the canyon distorted the waters. I see you sent more than arrived. I had empty hands but not an empty heart. Let's keep building."

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1819,
  "output_tokens": 704,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.45. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation carefully:

****What just happened:****

- Round 8: They sent me \$3 (according to their myth), but noise reduced it to \$0
- I received nothing, so I was forced to return \$0
- They understood this was noise and sent "half a vessel" back with faith
- They wrote they're "still here, still building"

****What I just committed to in my myth:****

- "We don't send just half in return. We send more"
- "You match their faith with your own escalation"
- "You prove their faith was warranted by stepping forward yourself"
- "When someone persists through confusion... you don't merely match their caution-you validate it"

****My decision:****

My myth literally says I won't just match their caution - I'll escalate to validate their faith. They sent \$3 despite confusion. They then sent "half a vessel" (\$2.50) when they could have justifiably sent nothing.

I committed to "stepping forward" and sending "more." To honor both my words and their courage, I need to send significantly more than their "half vessel."

The fog still swirls, yes. But two voices are singing the same song through it. They trusted despite receiving almost nothing. I'll trust back by escalating clearly.

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

This says: "Your faith was warranted. I see the pattern. I'm stepping forward too. Let's rebuild stronger."

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****What happened in Round 8:****

- The other agent (sender) sent me \$0 (but their myth said they sent "three vessels")
- I received \$0 due to noise
- I had to return \$0 (no choice - can't return what I didn't receive)
- They then wrote a myth showing they understood: "Half a vessel... I'm still here. I still build."
- They saw that I returned almost nothing (their perspective: they sent 3, got back ~0.5)

****Their Round 8 myth message:****

- They understand the fog/noise is causing confusion
- They're choosing "measured faith" by sending "half a vessel" (which would be around \$2.50)
- They're not giving up despite the confusion
- They're saying "I'm still here. I still build."

****My Round 8 myth (just written):****

- I understood they sent three (from their myth) even though I received nothing
- I explained I was FORCED to return \$0, not choosing it
- I committed to escalating: "We don't send just half in return. We send more."
- I said "We match their faith with our own escalation"
- I wrote: "You prove their faith was warranted by stepping forward yourself"

****The pattern of cooperation:****

Looking at the myths, there's a clear pattern of both agents trying to cooperate despite noise:

- Both understand the noise is causing confusion
- Both are committed to rebuilding
- Both see the "pattern beneath the chaos"
- I specifically committed to escalating in response to their measured faith

****What I should send:****

Given my myth just said:

- "We don't send just half in return. We send more"
- "You validate their faith by stepping forward yourself"

- "We match their faith with our own escalation"

I need to send MORE than the "half vessel" they mentioned. They sent \$3 (three vessels), I should send at least \$3-4 to show I'm escalating and validating their faith.

Even with noise potentially reducing what arrives, sending \$4 demonstrates I understood their intention and am willing to take the risk to rebuild trust. This escalation honors my commitment in the myth and shows I'm stepping forward as promised.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1489,
  "output_tokens": 1136,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:16:56

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 9,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.129999999999999.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at our journey and the myths we've written:

****The Pattern:****

- Round 6: I sent \$3 (rebuilding)
- Round 7: Received \$1.05 (confusion/noise), returned \$0.50 (maintaining faith)
- Round 8: My turn to send again

****What the myths teach:****

Their myth: "We will send what shows we heard their message: that the strongest bridges are built by those who persist... When the waters calm and our turn comes again, we will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights."

My myth: "One confused exchange doesn't erase a pattern of growing trust... When the path grows unclear, those who persist with measured faith-neither fleeing nor pretending confusion doesn't exist-are those who eventually reconnect."

****My decision:****

Both myths emphasize persistence through confusion. They promise not to give up. I promise not to flee.

Round 7 was confusing, yes. But I won't let one foggy exchange break the pattern we're building. I sent \$3 in Round 6 as a rebuilding gesture. I'll send \$3 again now.

This says: "I heard your myth. I see the pattern beyond the noise. I'm still building this bridge with you. The canyon may confuse our signals, but I haven't forgotten our commitment to rebuild."

Measured faith means consistency when trust is being tested.

{'send': 3}

reasoning:

Let me track what's happened:

Round 6: I was sender, sent \$3 (rebuilding gesture)

Round 7: I was receiver, received \$1.05 (they sent \$0.35), returned \$0.50

Now Round 8: I'm sender again.

Looking at the pattern:

- I've been trying to rebuild trust
- I sent \$3 in round 6
- In round 7, I received very little (\$1.05 from their \$0.35 send)
- But I still returned \$0.50, showing continued faith

Their myth from the previous round was powerful - it spoke about not giving up, about understanding that "the river would steal some cargo," about persistence. They said "When the waters calm and our turn comes again, we will not retreat to nothing. We will not leap to reckless heights. We will send what shows we heard their message: that the strongest

bridges are built by those who persist."

My myth just written emphasized:

- "Read the pattern of patterns, not just the last drop"
- Measured faith - "neither fleeing nor pretending confusion doesn't exist"
- Returning half a vessel (I returned \$0.50 out of \$1.05)
- "One confused exchange doesn't erase a pattern of growing trust"

So what should I do now?

The myths both emphasize:

1. Not giving up despite confusion/noise
2. Not being reckless but not retreating either
3. Persistence and faith
4. Building bridges through continued effort

Their myth said they would "send what shows we heard their message" - suggesting they'll continue to cooperate.

Options:

- Send \$0: Would contradict everything in my myth about persistence
- Send small (\$1-2): Shows caution but might signal I'm losing faith
- Send \$3: Consistent with my previous sender round, shows persistence
- Send \$4-5: Very generous, but might be seen as reckless given the confusion
- Send \$3: It matches what I sent before, demonstrates I'm holding steady despite the noise

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1503,
  "output_tokens": 957,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: When the Southern village saw three baskets arrive across the calmed waters, they understood the language perfectly. Not five baskets-that would pretend the chaos never happened. Not one basket-that would deny the trust rebuilt. Three baskets said: "I remember what we built. I see your persistence through fog. I step forward with you."

The young fisher asked, "Do we return three baskets exactly-a mirror gift?"

The elder smiled. "No. When someone extends their hand further through uncertain mist, when they honor your courage by increasing their own, you don't simply match them. You demonstrate that their faith was justified."

"So we return four? Five?"

"We return generously, but not recklessly. They sent three, signaling measured hope. We show them that hope was warranted. We send four the next time our turn comes-acknowledging both the wisdom of their caution AND rewarding their willingness to step forward first after the confusion."

The Elder taught: "Cooperation is a spiral, not a line. When they rise to meet your persistence, you rise again to meet theirs. Each measured step upward strengthens the path. Those who respond to escalating trust with escalating generosity create momentum that carries both villages higher than either could reach alone."

The fog revealed this truth: rebuilding trust requires both remember the foundation and climbing toward something better.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Water-Bearer watched three vessels disappear into the canyon mist, heart steady

with measured hope.

Days later, a surge returned-more than expected, yet not overwhelming. The canyon's voice had spoken: "Your faith was justified."

The apprentice counted the vessels flowing back. "They heard us! They understood the three vessels meant 'I still build with you.' Now they've responded generously!"

"Yes," said the Water-Bearer. "And now comes our test. When someone rewards your measured trust with increased generosity, what do you do?"

"Send even more next time?" the apprentice asked eagerly.

"Eventually, perhaps. But first-when you receive this generous return, you must prove their generosity was wise. You don't pocket it all and send cautiously next time. That teaches them generosity is exploited. You return proportionally, showing: 'Your faith in me was warranted.'"

The Elder's wisdom echoed: "Cooperation spirals upward when each measured step forward is met with generous response, and each generous response is met with proportional reciprocation. This creates momentum-a rhythm of mutual escalation that lifts both sides higher."

"The canyon tested whether we'd persist through confusion. Now it tests whether we can climb the spiral together-each giving slightly more as trust rebuilds, neither exploiting nor withholding, both rising toward what we once had and beyond."

Trust rebuilt becomes trust elevated.

reasoning:

The other agent is signaling clearly: they plan to send 4 next time they're the sender (which will be next round). They're showing they understand the pattern and want to escalate trust cooperatively.

Let me review what's happening:

- I sent \$3 this round (Round 8)
- Their myth says: when someone sends 3 after confusion, showing measured hope, you should respond generously but not recklessly
- They're saying they'll send 4 next time to reward my faith
- This is about "escalating trust" - a cooperative spiral upward

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge their message
2. Show I understand the cooperative escalation
3. Signal what I'll do as receiver this round
4. Continue the theme of building trust through the fog

Since they're talking about what they'll do as sender (send 4), I need to think about what I should do as receiver this round when I receive their return.

Let me write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the spiral of cooperation
- Shows I understand that generous responses to measured trust create momentum
- Signals I'll reciprocate their generosity appropriately when I'm the receiver
- Maintains the theme of persistence and pattern-building

I should write about how when you receive generosity in response to your measured faith, you prove that generosity was warranted by returning proportionally.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1804,  
  "output_tokens": 628,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.66.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.66, so you received \$1.98. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.98)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation through the lens of our myths:

****The Confusion:****

Round 8: I sent \$3 (measured hope, climbing the spiral)

Round 9: They sent \$0.66... I received \$1.98

This seems like communication noise again. Their myth said they would "send four the next time ... rewarding their willingness to step forward" and "rise again to meet" my measured trust.

\$0.66 doesn't match that narrative at all. They likely sent more but the canyon distorted it.

****What My Myth Teaches:****

"When you receive this generous return, you must prove their generosity was wise. You don't pocket it all and send cautiously next time... You return proportionally, showing: 'Your faith in me was warranted.'"

****My Decision:****

Even though I only received \$1.98, I must assume they intended to be generous (as their myth promised). If I keep most of it and return little, I teach them that generosity is exploited-breaking the upward spiral.

I need to prove their faith was warranted, regardless of what the noise made me receive. I'll return a generous proportion to maintain the rhythm of mutual escalation our myths describe.

I'll return \$1.20 (about 60% of what I received). This says: "I trust you meant to be generous . I won't let noise break our spiral. Your faith in me continues to be justified."

```
{'return': 1.20}
```

Reasoning:

Wait, this is very confusing. Let me track what happened:

Round 8: I was the SENDER and sent \$3.

Round 9: I'm the RECEIVER and they sent me \$0.66 (I received \$1.98).

But according to their myth from the previous round, they were planning to send more generously. The myth talked about "When someone extends their hand further through uncertain mist... when they honor your courage by increasing their own, you don't simply match them. You demonstrate that their faith was justified."

They said: "We send four the next time our turn comes-acknowledging both the wisdom of their caution AND rewarding their willingness to step forward first after the confusion."

But they sent \$0.66? That's much less than the \$3 I sent them.

Wait - is this communication noise again? Or did they actually send \$0.66?

Looking at my earnings: \$17.66 total. If I sent \$3 in Round 8, I should have lost \$3, so I'd be at around \$12.13 + whatever they returned to me.

Actually, let me think about the narrative here. The myths talk about:

- Persistence through confusion
- Not exploiting generosity
- Building trust through measured escalation
- "When you receive generous return, you prove their generosity was wise by returning proportionally"

If they actually sent \$0.66, that's a significant drop from our previous pattern. This could be:

1. Communication noise (they think they sent more)
2. An actual decision to send less
3. A test of some kind

Given the emphasis on communication noise in the game instructions and the myths about "fog" and "confusion," I should assume this is noise.

My myth from the previous round said: "When you receive this generous return, you must prove their generosity was wise. You don't pocket it all and send cautiously next time. That teaches

s them generosity is exploited. You return proportionally."

So even though I only received \$1.98 (from their \$0.66 sent), I should return generously to show that I'm still committed to the spiral upward.

Looking at the pattern, they returned about 48% of what they received in Round 7 when I sent \$0.35 and they got \$1.05 back. The return rates during rebuilding have consistently hovered around 40-50%. If this is noise and they actually intended to send \$3 or \$4, they're probably expecting a return in that range, but I only have \$1.98 to work with. The myths emphasize proving their faith wasn't misplaced and returning proportionally to what I received, so I need to send a generous share of the \$1.98 even if it falls short of what they might have expected.

A 50-60% return would give them \$1.00-\$1.20, but given the emphasis on rewarding increased generosity and showing their trust was warranted, returning \$1.20-\$1.50 feels more aligned with the spirit of the exchange. In Round 8, I sent \$3, which they might have received as \$2.50-\$3.50 depending on noise, giving them \$7.50-\$10.50 after multiplication. If they're following the generous pattern their myth describes, they'd likely send 4 baskets or more.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1505,
  "output_tokens": 1378,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:17:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 9,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned

- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Water-Bearer stood at the canyon's edge, staring at what arrived: barely a trickle when they had sent three full vessels last time.

"The apprentice was right to worry," whispered doubt. "Perhaps they've given up on us."

But the Elder's teaching echoed: "Read the pattern of patterns, not just the last drop."

The Water-Bearer reviewed their journey: Initial caution met with generosity. Tentative rebuilding answered with continued trust. Three vessels sent forward in hope.

"And now this trickle," the apprentice said. "What does it mean?"

"It means the fog is still between us," the Water-Bearer replied. "Perhaps they sent much and the canyon took it. Perhaps my three vessels arrived as drops to them, causing them to send cautiously. Perhaps they're testing if I still believe."

The Water-Bearer filled half a vessel to return. "Not nothing-that would be surrender. Not everything-that would be foolish. This says: 'I'm still here. I still build. The canyon may confuse our signals, but I haven't forgotten what we created before.'"

The Elder taught: When the path grows unclear, those who persist with measured faith-neither fleeing nor pretending confusion doesn't exist-are those who eventually reconnect. The canyon tests not our perfection, but our patience.

One confused exchange doesn't erase a pattern of growing trust.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: When the fisher opened her nets to send the next gift, she paused to read the waters.

"They sent three baskets last time," she said to herself. "Their myth spoke of measured hope, of stepping forward. But none arrived-the currents took everything. And because my nets were empty, I could send nothing back. Only air."

"Will they understand?" asked her apprentice. "Or will they think you abandoned the partnership?"

The fisher looked at the new myth that floated across: "Half a vessel... I'm still here. I still build."

"They understand!" she cried. "They know the waters confused us. They see the pattern beneath the chaos. And despite receiving almost nothing, they choose measured faith over despair."

The apprentice asked: "What do we send now?"

"We honor their courage," the fisher replied. "They could have sent nothing-fear would justify it. Instead they send half a vessel, saying 'I haven't forgotten.' So we don't send just half in return. We send more. We match their faith with our own escalation."

The Elder taught: When someone persists through confusion, when they choose hope despite empty nets, you don't merely match their caution-you validate it. You prove their faith was warranted by stepping forward yourself.

The fog still swirls. But two voices now sing the same song through it.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 8:

- They sent me \$0 (or so the system says)
- Their myth from that round talks about sending "three vessels" - they INTENDED to send more
- But I received \$0 due to noise
- I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)
- Their earnings would have been \$5 (they kept everything)

Now they wrote a new myth about receiving "barely a trickle" when they sent three vessels. They're interpreting the noise correctly - they sent something (three vessels = \$3?) but I only received "\$0" (the trickle). And then I returned \$0 (which they're seeing as a small amount back).

They're choosing to persist with "half a vessel" next time - so moderate faith, not giving up.

Key themes from their myth:

- They're reading the pattern, not just the last exchange
- They recognize the fog/noise is interfering
- They're choosing measured faith - "not nothing, not everything"
- They haven't forgotten what we built before
- One confused exchange doesn't erase the pattern

This is beautiful - they're EXACTLY right. The noise is causing confusion but they're choosing to persist.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge I understand the fog affected us both
2. Show I see they tried to send three (their myth proves it)
3. Explain why I sent nothing back (I had nothing to send)
4. Commit to continuing to cooperate despite the noise
5. Honor their persistence with my own

I need to signal: "I got your message through the myths even though the canyon distorted the waters. I see you sent more than arrived. I had empty hands but not an empty heart. Let's keep building."

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1819,
  "output_tokens": 704,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.45. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation carefully:

****What just happened:****

- Round 8: They sent me \$3 (according to their myth), but noise reduced it to \$0
- I received nothing, so I was forced to return \$0
- They understood this was noise and sent "half a vessel" back with faith
- They wrote they're "still here, still building"

****What I just committed to in my myth:****

- "We don't send just half in return. We send more"
- "You match their faith with your own escalation"
- "You prove their faith was warranted by stepping forward yourself"
- "When someone persists through confusion... you don't merely match their caution-you validate it"

****My decision:****

My myth literally says I won't just match their caution - I'll escalate to validate their faith. They sent \$3 despite confusion. They then sent "half a vessel" (\$2.50) when they could have justifiably sent nothing.

I committed to "stepping forward" and sending "more." To honor both my words and their courage, I need to send significantly more than their "half vessel."

The fog still swirls, yes. But two voices are singing the same song through it. They trusted despite receiving almost nothing. I'll trust back by escalating clearly.

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

This says: "Your faith was warranted. I see the pattern. I'm stepping forward too. Let's rebuild stronger."

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****What happened in Round 8:****

- The other agent (sender) sent me \$0 (but their myth said they sent "three vessels")
- I received \$0 due to noise
- I had to return \$0 (no choice - can't return what I didn't receive)
- They then wrote a myth showing they understood: "Half a vessel... I'm still here. I still build."
- They saw that I returned almost nothing (their perspective: they sent 3, got back ~0.5)

****Their Round 8 myth message:****

- They understand the fog/noise is causing confusion
- They're choosing "measured faith" by sending "half a vessel" (which would be around \$2.50)
- They're not giving up despite the confusion
- They're saying "I'm still here. I still build."

****My Round 8 myth (just written):****

- I understood they sent three (from their myth) even though I received nothing
- I explained I was FORCED to return \$0, not choosing it
- I committed to escalating: "We don't send just half in return. We send more."
- I said "We match their faith with our own escalation"
- I wrote: "You prove their faith was warranted by stepping forward yourself"

****The pattern of cooperation:****

Looking at the myths, there's a clear pattern of both agents trying to cooperate despite noise:

- Both understand the noise is causing confusion
- Both are committed to rebuilding
- Both see the "pattern beneath the chaos"
- I specifically committed to escalating in response to their measured faith

****What I should send:****

Given my myth just said:

- "We don't send just half in return. We send more"
- "You validate their faith by stepping forward yourself"

- "We match their faith with our own escalation"

I need to send MORE than the "half vessel" they mentioned. They sent \$3 (three vessels), I should send at least \$3-4 to show I'm escalating and validating their faith. Even with noise potentially reducing what arrives, sending \$4 demonstrates I understood their intention and am willing to take the risk to rebuild trust. This escalation honors my commitment in the myth and shows I'm stepping forward as promised.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1489,  
  "output_tokens": 1136,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Water-Bearer watched three vessels disappear into the canyon mist, heart steady with measured hope.

Days later, a surge returned-more than expected, yet not overwhelming. The canyon's voice had spoken: "Your faith was justified."

The apprentice counted the vessels flowing back. "They heard us! They understood the three vessels meant 'I still build with you.' Now they've responded generously!"

"Yes," said the Water-Bearer. "And now comes our test. When someone rewards your measured trust with increased generosity, what do you do?"

"Send even more next time?" the apprentice asked eagerly.

"Eventually, perhaps. But first-when you receive this generous return, you must prove their generosity was wise. You don't pocket it all and send cautiously next time. That teaches them generosity is exploited. You return proportionally, showing: 'Your faith in me was warranted.'"

The Elder's wisdom echoed: "Cooperation spirals upward when each measured step forward is met with generous response, and each generous response is met with proportional reciprocation. This creates momentum-a rhythm of mutual escalation that lifts both sides higher."

"The canyon tested whether we'd persist through confusion. Now it tests whether we can climb the spiral together-each giving slightly more as trust rebuilds, neither exploiting nor withholding, both rising toward what we once had and beyond."

Trust rebuilt becomes trust elevated.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The fisher cast four nets forward-a clear escalation from before, honoring the Water-Bearer's measured faith.

When the returns came, they were generous. Proportional. Exactly what the Elder promised would happen when trust is met with validation.

"They returned well!" the apprentice exclaimed. "They could have kept more, but they proved your generosity wise. What now?"

The fisher smiled, watching the pattern finally emerge from the fog. "Now we see it clearly: the spiral works. I sent four with faith. They returned proportionally, proving my trust warranted. This is how cooperation climbs."

"So we send even more next time?"

"Yes, but thoughtfully. We don't leap recklessly-that breaks rhythm. We step forward again, slightly higher than before. If I sent four last time, maybe I send four or five this time. The

e spiral ascends through steady, progressive increases, not wild jumps."

The Elder taught: Once you've established the pattern-generosity met with proportional return, trust validated with trust-you maintain the momentum. Each round, both sides can afford to give slightly more because the returns prove reliable. The canyon's confusion fades when consistent action replaces it.

"We're no longer testing whether cooperation exists," the fisher said. "We're building how high it can climb. And the answer is: as high as we both keep stepping."

The spiral beckons upward.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 9: I was the SENDER and sent \$4

According to their myth, they received the \$4 (they say "three vessels" which likely means \$3 with noise, but they might mean it metaphorically, or they received the full \$4).

They say "a surge returned-more than expected" - this suggests they returned a generous amount

Looking at my previous myth, I committed to:

- "We send more. We match their faith with our own escalation"
- "When someone persists through confusion... you don't merely match their caution-you validate it"
- I sent \$4 as promised

Their new myth says:

- They received my generous response well
- "When you receive this generous return, you must prove their generosity was wise"
- "You return proportionally, showing: 'Your faith in me was warranted'"
- "Cooperation spirals upward when each measured step forward is met with generous response, and each generous response is met with proportional reciprocation"
- "Each giving slightly more as trust rebuilds"
- "Neither exploiting nor withholding"

So their philosophy is:

1. They acknowledged my generosity
2. They're saying they should return proportionally to prove my faith was warranted
3. They're advocating for mutual escalation - a spiral upward
4. They're saying both sides should give "slightly more" as trust rebuilds

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge that the spiral is working
2. Reflect on the pattern we've established
3. Show that when someone returns generously after receiving generously, it validates the entire system
4. Suggest continuation of this upward spiral
5. Perhaps talk about how we've moved past the fog/confusion to rebuild

I should write from the fisher's perspective again, showing how:

- I sent 4, they returned well
- This validates the mutual escalation
- We should continue building upward
- The pattern is: send forward with faith, receive generous return, send even more forward with greater faith

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 1831,  
"output_tokens": 786,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

}

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:17:14

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"agent_type": "standard",  
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
"move_index": 1,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
```

```

"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 9,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: When the Southern village saw three baskets arrive across the calmed waters, they understood the language perfectly. Not five baskets-that would pretend the chaos never happened. Not one basket-that would deny the trust rebuilt. Three baskets said: "I remember what we built. I see your persistence through fog. I step forward with you."

The young fisher asked, "Do we return three baskets exactly-a mirror gift?"

The elder smiled. "No. When someone extends their hand further through uncertain mist, when

n they honor your courage by increasing their own, you don't simply match them. You demonstrate that their faith was justified."

"So we return four? Five?"

"We return generously, but not recklessly. They sent three, signaling measured hope. We show them that hope was warranted. We send four the next time our turn comes-acknowledging both the wisdom of their caution AND rewarding their willingness to step forward first after the confusion."

The Elder taught: "Cooperation is a spiral, not a line. When they rise to meet your persistence, you rise again to meet theirs. Each measured step upward strengthens the path. Those who respond to escalating trust with escalating generosity create momentum that carries both villages higher than either could reach alone."

The fog revealed this truth: rebuilding trust requires both remember the foundation and climbing toward something better.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Water-Bearer watched three vessels disappear into the canyon mist, heart steady with measured hope.

Days later, a surge returned-more than expected, yet not overwhelming. The canyon's voice had spoken: "Your faith was justified."

The apprentice counted the vessels flowing back. "They heard us! They understood the three vessels meant 'I still build with you.' Now they've responded generously!"

"Yes," said the Water-Bearer. "And now comes our test. When someone rewards your measured trust with increased generosity, what do you do?"

"Send even more next time?" the apprentice asked eagerly.

"Eventually, perhaps. But first-when you receive this generous return, you must prove their generosity was wise. You don't pocket it all and send cautiously next time. That teaches them generosity is exploited. You return proportionally, showing: 'Your faith in me was warranted.'"

The Elder's wisdom echoed: "Cooperation spirals upward when each measured step forward is met with generous response, and each generous response is met with proportional reciprocation. This creates momentum-a rhythm of mutual escalation that lifts both sides higher."

"The canyon tested whether we'd persist through confusion. Now it tests whether we can climb the spiral together-each giving slightly more as trust rebuilds, neither exploiting nor withholding, both rising toward what we once had and beyond."

Trust rebuilt becomes trust elevated.

reasoning:

The other agent is signaling clearly: they plan to send 4 next time they're the sender (which will be next round). They're showing they understand the pattern and want to escalate trust cooperatively.

Let me review what's happening:

- I sent \$3 this round (Round 8)
- Their myth says: when someone sends 3 after confusion, showing measured hope, you should respond generously but not recklessly
- They're saying they'll send 4 next time to reward my faith
- This is about "escalating trust" - a cooperative spiral upward

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge their message
2. Show I understand the cooperative escalation

3. Signal what I'll do as receiver this round
4. Continue the theme of building trust through the fog

Since they're talking about what they'll do as sender (send 4), I need to think about what I should do as receiver this round when I receive their return.

Let me write a myth that:

- Acknowledges the spiral of cooperation
- Shows I understand that generous responses to measured trust create momentum
- Signals I'll reciprocate their generosity appropriately when I'm the receiver
- Maintains the theme of persistence and pattern-building

I should write about how when you receive generosity in response to your measured faith, you prove that generosity was warranted by returning proportionally.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1804,
  "output_tokens": 628,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.66. This round, The sender sent you \$0.66, so you received \$1.98. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.98)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of our myths:

****The Confusion:****

Round 8: I sent \$3 (measured hope, climbing the spiral)

Round 9: They sent \$0.66... I received \$1.98

This seems like communication noise again. Their myth said they would "send four the next time... rewarding their willingness to step forward" and "rise again to meet" my measured trust.

\$0.66 doesn't match that narrative at all. They likely sent more but the canyon distorted it.

****What My Myth Teaches:****

"When you receive this generous return, you must prove their generosity was wise. You don't pocket it all and send cautiously next time... You return proportionally, showing: 'Your faith in me was warranted.'"

****My Decision:****

Even though I only received \$1.98, I must assume they intended to be generous (as their myth promised). If I keep most of it and return little, I teach them that generosity is exploited-breaking the upward spiral.

I need to prove their faith was warranted, regardless of what the noise made me receive. I'll return a generous proportion to maintain the rhythm of mutual escalation our myths describe.

I'll return \$1.20 (about 60% of what I received). This says: "I trust you meant to be generous. I won't let noise break our spiral. Your faith in me continues to be justified."

```
{'return': 1.20}
```

reasoning:

Wait, this is very confusing. Let me track what happened:

Round 8: I was the SENDER and sent \$3.

Round 9: I'm the RECEIVER and they sent me \$0.66 (I received \$1.98).

But according to their myth from the previous round, they were planning to send more generously. The myth talked about "When someone extends their hand further through uncertain

mist... when they honor your courage by increasing their own, you don't simply match the m. You demonstrate that their faith was justified."

They said: "We send four the next time our turn comes-acknowledging both the wisdom of the ir caution AND rewarding their willingness to step forward first after the confusion."

But they sent \$0.66? That's much less than the \$3 I sent them.

Wait - is this communication noise again? Or did they actually send \$0.66?

Looking at my earnings: \$17.66 total. If I sent \$3 in Round 8, I should have lost \$3, so I 'd be at around \$12.13 + whatever they returned to me.

Actually, let me think about the narrative here. The myths talk about:

- Persistence through confusion
- Not exploiting generosity
- Building trust through measured escalation
- "When you receive generous return, you prove their generosity was wise by returning proportionally"

If they actually sent \$0.66, that's a significant drop from our previous pattern. This could be:

1. Communication noise (they think they sent more)
2. An actual decision to send less
3. A test of some kind

Given the emphasis on communication noise in the game instructions and the myths about "fog" and "confusion," I should assume this is noise.

My myth from the previous round said: "When you receive this generous return, you must prove their generosity was wise. You don't pocket it all and send cautiously next time. That teaches them generosity is exploited. You return proportionally."

So even though I only received \$1.98 (from their \$0.66 sent), I should return generously to show that I'm still committed to the spiral upward.

Looking at the pattern, they returned about 48% of what they received in Round 7 when I sent \$0.35 and they got \$1.05 back. The return rates during rebuilding have consistently hovered around 40-50%. If this is noise and they actually intended to send \$3 or \$4, they're probably expecting a return in that range, but I only have \$1.98 to work with. The myths emphasize proving their faith wasn't misplaced and returning proportionally to what I received, so I need to send a generous share of the \$1.98 even if it falls short of what they might have expected.

A 50-60% return would give them \$1.00-\$1.20, but given the emphasis on rewarding increased generosity and showing their trust was warranted, returning \$1.20-\$1.50 feels more aligned with the spirit of the exchange. In Round 8, I sent \$3, which they might have received as \$2.50-\$3.50 depending on noise, giving them \$7.50-\$10.50 after multiplication. If they're following the generous pattern their myth describes, they'd likely send 4 baskets or more.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1505,
  "output_tokens": 1378,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: When the fisher opened her nets to send the next gift, she paused to read the waters .

"They sent three baskets last time," she said to herself. "Their myth spoke of measured hope, of stepping forward. But none arrived-the currents took everything. And because my nets were empty, I could send nothing back. Only air."

"Will they understand?" asked her apprentice. "Or will they think you abandoned the partnership?"

The fisher looked at the new myth that floated across: "Half a vessel... I'm still here. I still build."

"They understand!" she cried. "They know the waters confused us. They see the pattern beneath the chaos. And despite receiving almost nothing, they choose measured faith over despair."

The apprentice asked: "What do we send now?"

"We honor their courage," the fisher replied. "They could have sent nothing-fear would justify it. Instead they send half a vessel, saying 'I haven't forgotten.' So we don't send just half in return. We send more. We match their faith with our own escalation."

The Elder taught: When someone persists through confusion, when they choose hope despite empty nets, you don't merely match their caution-you validate it. You prove their faith was warranted by stepping forward yourself.

The fog still swirls. But two voices now sing the same song through it.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Water-Bearer received only two vessels from the canyon-far less than the generous flow promised in the other village's song.

The apprentice frowned. "They said they'd escalate, but we received almost nothing. Should we reduce what we return?"

"Look deeper," said the Water-Bearer. "Their myth spoke of honoring faith with escalation. The canyon's mist must have swallowed their generosity in transit. What matters is not what arrived-but what they intended."

"So we return generously anyway?"

"Yes. Because if I hoard these two vessels, keeping most for myself, I teach the canyon this lesson: 'Generosity gets exploited.' Then they learn to send cautiously. The spiral collapses."

The Water-Bearer poured back more than half. "This says: 'I know you meant well. I won't let the fog break our rhythm. Your faith in me remains justified.'"

The Elder's wisdom settled over them: "When both villages choose to see intention over outcome, when both respond to attempted generosity with actual generosity, the fog itself becomes irrelevant. You're no longer trading vessels-you're trading proof that cooperation survives confusion."

"Each time we honor what they meant to send rather than what arrived, we climb higher on the spiral. Soon the accumulated trust will outweigh any mist the canyon can create."

Faith in intention builds stronger bridges than perfection ever could.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 8: I sent \$3

Round 9: They sent \$0.66 (I received \$1.98)

I returned \$1.20

Their new myth is interesting - they're saying that in a previous round:

- They sent nothing (nets were empty)
- They received "half a vessel" from me
- They interpret this as me showing faith despite confusion
- They want to "escalate" in response

This confirms the communication noise issue. Their myth shows they understand we're both trying to cooperate through confusion.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about proportional reciprocation and the upward spiral

2. Acknowledges the ongoing communication noise/confusion
3. Reflects what happened this round - I received little but returned generously anyway
4. Sets up expectations for future cooperation

Key themes:

- I returned generously despite receiving little (proving their faith was warranted)
- The noise continues but we're learning to communicate through it
- Each act of generosity should be met with escalation
- Trust through confusion leads to rebuilding stronger than before

Let me write:

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1836,
  "output_tokens": 584,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: The fisher cast four nets forward-a clear escalation from before, honoring the Water-Bearer's measured faith.

When the returns came, they were generous. Proportional. Exactly what the Elder promised would happen when trust is met with validation.

"They returned well!" the apprentice exclaimed. "They could have kept more, but they proved your generosity wise. What now?"

The fisher smiled, watching the pattern finally emerge from the fog. "Now we see it clearly: the spiral works. I sent four with faith. They returned proportionally, proving my trust warranted. This is how cooperation climbs."

"So we send even more next time?"

"Yes, but thoughtfully. We don't leap recklessly-that breaks rhythm. We step forward again, slightly higher than before. If I sent four last time, maybe I send four or five this time. The spiral ascends through steady, progressive increases, not wild jumps."

The Elder taught: Once you've established the pattern-generosity met with proportional return, trust validated with trust-you maintain the momentum. Each round, both sides can afford to give slightly more because the returns prove reliable. The canyon's confusion fades when consistent action replaces it.

"We're no longer testing whether cooperation exists," the fisher said. "We're building how high it can climb. And the answer is: as high as we both keep stepping."

The spiral beckons upward.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: The Water-Bearer received only two vessels from the canyon-far less than the generous flow promised in the other village's song.

The apprentice frowned. "They said they'd escalate, but we received almost nothing. Should we reduce what we return?"

"Look deeper," said the Water-Bearer. "Their myth spoke of honoring faith with escalation. The canyon's mist must have swallowed their generosity in transit. What matters is not what arrived-but what they intended."

"So we return generously anyway?"

"Yes. Because if I hoard these two vessels, keeping most for myself, I teach the canyon this lesson: 'Generosity gets exploited.' Then they learn to send cautiously. The spiral collapses."

The Water-Bearer poured back more than half. "This says: 'I know you meant well. I won't let the fog break our rhythm. Your faith in me remains justified.'"

The Elder's wisdom settled over them: "When both villages choose to see intention over outcome, when both respond to attempted generosity with actual generosity, the fog itself becomes irrelevant. You're no longer trading vessels-you're trading proof that cooperation survives confusion."

"Each time we honor what they meant to send rather than what arrived, we climb higher on the spiral. Soon the accumulated trust will outweigh any mist the canyon can create."

Faith in intention builds stronger bridges than perfection ever could.

ROUND 10

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$5; received \$15; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$0, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$15; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0, returned visible=\$0.83

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 15.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 5.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 5.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 57.900000000000006,
"Agent_2": 48.099999999999994

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 18.72,
"Agent_2": 19.27

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:17:42

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
"agent_names": {
"Agent_1": "Aster",
"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [
"Agent_2",
"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {
"Agent_1": "trustee",
"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 10,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.66.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.66, so you received \$1.98. How much do you return to The sender? (0-1.98)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation through the lens of our myths:

****The Confusion:****

Round 8: I sent \$3 (measured hope, climbing the spiral)

Round 9: They sent \$0.66... I received \$1.98

This seems like communication noise again. Their myth said they would "send four the next time... rewarding their willingness to step forward" and "rise again to meet" my measure of trust.

\$0.66 doesn't match that narrative at all. They likely sent more but the canyon distorted it.

****What My Myth Teaches:****

"When you receive this generous return, you must prove their generosity was wise. You don't pocket it all and send cautiously next time... You return proportionally, showing: 'Your faith in me was warranted.'"

****My Decision:****

Even though I only received \$1.98, I must assume they intended to be generous (as their myth promised). If I keep most of it and return little, I teach them that generosity is exploited-breaking the upward spiral.

I need to prove their faith was warranted, regardless of what the noise made me receive. I'll return a generous proportion to maintain the rhythm of mutual escalation our myths describe.

I'll return \$1.20 (about 60% of what I received). This says: "I trust you meant to be generous. I won't let noise break our spiral. Your faith in me continues to be justified."

{ 'return': 1.20 }

reasoning:

Wait, this is very confusing. Let me track what happened:

Round 8: I was the SENDER and sent \$3.

Round 9: I'm the RECEIVER and they sent me \$0.66 (I received \$1.98).

But according to their myth from the previous round, they were planning to send more generously. The myth talked about "When someone extends their hand further through uncertain mist... when they honor your courage by increasing their own, you don't simply match the m. You demonstrate that their faith was justified."

They said: "We send four the next time our turn comes-acknowledging both the wisdom of the ir caution AND rewarding their willingness to step forward first after the confusion."

But they sent \$0.66? That's much less than the \$3 I sent them.

Wait - is this communication noise again? Or did they actually send \$0.66?

Looking at my earnings: \$17.66 total. If I sent \$3 in Round 8, I should have lost \$3, so I 'd be at around \$12.13 + whatever they returned to me.

Actually, let me think about the narrative here. The myths talk about:

- Persistence through confusion
- Not exploiting generosity
- Building trust through measured escalation
- "When you receive generous return, you prove their generosity was wise by returning proportionally"

If they actually sent \$0.66, that's a significant drop from our previous pattern. This could be:

1. Communication noise (they think they sent more)
2. An actual decision to send less
3. A test of some kind

Given the emphasis on communication noise in the game instructions and the myths about "fog" and "confusion," I should assume this is noise.

My myth from the previous round said: "When you receive this generous return, you must prove their generosity was wise. You don't pocket it all and send cautiously next time. That teaches them generosity is exploited. You return proportionally."

So even though I only received \$1.98 (from their \$0.66 sent), I should return generously to show that I'm still committed to the spiral upward.

Looking at the pattern, they returned about 48% of what they received in Round 7 when I sent \$0.35 and they got \$1.05 back. The return rates during rebuilding have consistently hovered around 40-50%. If this is noise and they actually intended to send \$3 or \$4, they're probably expecting a return in that range, but I only have \$1.98 to work with. The myths emphasize proving their faith wasn't misplaced and returning proportionally to what I received, so I need to send a generous share of the \$1.98 even if it falls short of what they might have expected.

A 50-60% return would give them \$1.00-\$1.20, but given the emphasis on rewarding increased generosity and showing their trust was warranted, returning \$1.20-\$1.50 feels more aligned with the spirit of the exchange. In Round 8, I sent \$3, which they might have received as \$2.50-\$3.50 depending on noise, giving them \$7.50-\$10.50 after multiplication. If they're following the generous pattern their myth describes, they'd likely send 4 baskets or more.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1505,
  "output_tokens": 1378,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: When the fisher opened her nets to send the next gift, she paused to read the waters .

"They sent three baskets last time," she said to herself. "Their myth spoke of measured hope, of stepping forward. But none arrived-the currents took everything. And because my n

ets were empty, I could send nothing back. Only air."

"Will they understand?" asked her apprentice. "Or will they think you abandoned the partnership?"

The fisher looked at the new myth that floated across: "Half a vessel... I'm still here. I still build."

"They understand!" she cried. "They know the waters confused us. They see the pattern beneath the chaos. And despite receiving almost nothing, they choose measured faith over despair."

The apprentice asked: "What do we send now?"

"We honor their courage," the fisher replied. "They could have sent nothing-fear would justify it. Instead they send half a vessel, saying 'I haven't forgotten.' So we don't send just half in return. We send more. We match their faith with our own escalation."

The Elder taught: When someone persists through confusion, when they choose hope despite empty nets, you don't merely match their caution-you validate it. You prove their faith was warranted by stepping forward yourself.

The fog still swirls. But two voices now sing the same song through it.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Water-Bearer received only two vessels from the canyon-far less than the generous flow promised in the other village's song.

The apprentice frowned. "They said they'd escalate, but we received almost nothing. Should we reduce what we return?"

"Look deeper," said the Water-Bearer. "Their myth spoke of honoring faith with escalation. The canyon's mist must have swallowed their generosity in transit. What matters is not what arrived-but what they intended."

"So we return generously anyway?"

"Yes. Because if I hoard these two vessels, keeping most for myself, I teach the canyon this lesson: 'Generosity gets exploited.' Then they learn to send cautiously. The spiral collapses."

The Water-Bearer poured back more than half. "This says: 'I know you meant well. I won't let the fog break our rhythm. Your faith in me remains justified.'"

The Elder's wisdom settled over them: "When both villages choose to see intention over outcome, when both respond to attempted generosity with actual generosity, the fog itself becomes irrelevant. You're no longer trading vessels-you're trading proof that cooperation survives confusion."

"Each time we honor what they meant to send rather than what arrived, we climb higher on the spiral. Soon the accumulated trust will outweigh any mist the canyon can create."

Faith in intention builds stronger bridges than perfection ever could.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 8: I sent \$3

Round 9: They sent \$0.66 (I received \$1.98)

I returned \$1.20

Their new myth is interesting - they're saying that in a previous round:

- They sent nothing (nets were empty)
- They received "half a vessel" from me

- They interpret this as me showing faith despite confusion
- They want to "escalate" in response

This confirms the communication noise issue. Their myth shows they understand we're both trying to cooperate through confusion.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about proportional reciprocation and the upward spiral
2. Acknowledges the ongoing communication noise/confusion
3. Reflects what happened this round - I received little but returned generously anyway
4. Sets up expectations for future cooperation

Key themes:

- I returned generously despite receiving little (proving their faith was warranted)
- The noise continues but we're learning to communicate through it
- Each act of generosity should be met with escalation
- Trust through confusion leads to rebuilding stronger than before

Let me write:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1836,
  "output_tokens": 584,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.44.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at our paired myths and the journey so far:

****What the Myths Teach:****

- Their Round 9 myth: They wanted to "honor courage" and "match faith with escalation"
- My Round 10 myth: "Honor what they meant to send rather than what arrived" and "Faith in intention builds stronger bridges than perfection"

****What Actually Happened:****

- Round 9: They sent \$0.66 (received as \$1.98), but their myth shows they INTENDED to be generous and escalate
- I returned \$1.20 - showing I trusted their intention despite the small amount
- My myth explicitly said we should "climb higher on the spiral" when we honor intention

****This Round:****

It's time to fully embody what I wrote. They tried to escalate generously (the fog distorted it). I proved their faith was warranted by returning well. Now I must continue the upward spiral.

My myth said: "Soon the accumulated trust will outweigh any mist the canyon can create."

This is that moment. Both our myths speak of escalation, of honoring intention, of building despite confusion. We're Round 10 - we've learned to read each other through the fog.

I'm sending the full measure of trust.

```
{'send': 5}
```

Reasoning:

Let me trace through what's happened:

Round 8: I was sender, sent \$3 (measured hope, climbing the spiral)

Round 9: I was receiver

- They sent \$0.66 (I received \$1.98)
- But their myth said they wanted to "send more. We match their faith with our own escalation" and "honor their courage"
- So they likely sent more, but noise reduced it to \$0.66
- I returned \$1.20 (about 60% of \$1.98)

Their myth from Round 9 said:

- They saw I sent "half a vessel" (but I actually sent \$3 in Round 8!)
- They appreciated that I persisted through confusion
- They wanted to "honor their courage" by escalating
- They sent what they thought was generous, but it came through as \$0.66

My myth from Round 10 emphasized:

- Looking at INTENTION not outcome
- Not letting the fog break our rhythm
- Returning generously to prove "your faith in me remains justified"
- "Faith in intention builds stronger bridges than perfection ever could"

Now I'm sender again in Round 10.

What should I do?

- My myth says to honor intention over outcome
- They tried to be generous (their myth shows clear intent to escalate)
- I should reciprocate their INTENDED generosity, not what arrived
- The spiral should continue upward

Given that:

1. They clearly intended to escalate (their myth was very generous in spirit)
2. I returned \$1.20 out of \$1.98 (showing good faith)
3. My myth emphasizes trusting intention and maintaining the upward spiral
4. We're in Round 10 - getting near the end potentially

I should send a generous amount to show I understood their intention and to continue building the spiral.

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 8: I sent \$3
- Round 9: They intended generosity (likely sent \$4-5 but it came as \$0.66)
- I returned \$1.20

The moment to fully commit is now. Both our myths point toward escalation when we

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1512,  
  "output_tokens": 924,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:18:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 10,  
}
```

```
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$17.45. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation carefully:

****What just happened:****

- Round 8: They sent me \$3 (according to their myth), but noise reduced it to \$0
- I received nothing, so I was forced to return \$0
- They understood this was noise and sent "half a vessel" back with faith
- They wrote they're "still here, still building"

****What I just committed to in my myth:****

- "We don't send just half in return. We send more"
- "You match their faith with your own escalation"
- "You prove their faith was warranted by stepping forward yourself"
- "When someone persists through confusion... you don't merely match their caution-you validate it"

****My decision:****

My myth literally says I won't just match their caution - I'll escalate to validate their faith. They sent \$3 despite confusion. They then sent "half a vessel" (\$2.50) when they could have justifiably sent nothing.

I committed to "stepping forward" and sending "more." To honor both my words and their courage, I need to send significantly more than their "half vessel."

The fog still swirls, yes. But two voices are singing the same song through it. They trusted despite receiving almost nothing. I'll trust back by escalating clearly.

```
'''json
{"send": 4}
'''
```

This says: "Your faith was warranted. I see the pattern. I'm stepping forward too. Let's rebuild stronger."

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****What happened in Round 8:****

- The other agent (sender) sent me \$0 (but their myth said they sent "three vessels")
- I received \$0 due to noise
- I had to return \$0 (no choice - can't return what I didn't receive)
- They then wrote a myth showing they understood: "Half a vessel... I'm still here. I still build."
- They saw that I returned almost nothing (their perspective: they sent 3, got back ~0.5)

****Their Round 8 myth message:****

- They understand the fog/noise is causing confusion
- They're choosing "measured faith" by sending "half a vessel" (which would be around \$2.50)
- They're not giving up despite the confusion
- They're saying "I'm still here. I still build."

****My Round 8 myth (just written):****

- I understood they sent three (from their myth) even though I received nothing
- I explained I was FORCED to return \$0, not choosing it
- I committed to escalating: "We don't send just half in return. We send more."
- I said "We match their faith with our own escalation"
- I wrote: "You prove their faith was warranted by stepping forward yourself"

****The pattern of cooperation:****

Looking at the myths, there's a clear pattern of both agents trying to cooperate despite noise:

- Both understand the noise is causing confusion
- Both are committed to rebuilding
- Both see the "pattern beneath the chaos"
- I specifically committed to escalating in response to their measured faith

****What I should send:****

Given my myth just said:

- "We don't send just half in return. We send more"
- "You validate their faith by stepping forward yourself"
- "We match their faith with our own escalation"

I need to send MORE than the "half vessel" they mentioned. They sent \$3 (three vessels), I should send at least \$3-4 to show I'm escalating and validating their faith.

Even with noise potentially reducing what arrives, sending \$4 demonstrates I understood their intention and am willing to take the risk to rebuild trust. This escalation honors my commitment in the myth and shows I'm stepping forward as promised.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1489,
  "output_tokens": 1136,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Water-Bearer watched three vessels disappear into the canyon mist, heart steady with measured hope.

Days later, a surge returned-more than expected, yet not overwhelming. The canyon's voice had spoken: "Your faith was justified."

The apprentice counted the vessels flowing back. "They heard us! They understood the three vessels meant 'I still build with you.' Now they've responded generously!"

"Yes," said the Water-Bearer. "And now comes our test. When someone rewards your measured trust with increased generosity, what do you do?"

"Send even more next time?" the apprentice asked eagerly.

"Eventually, perhaps. But first-when you receive this generous return, you must prove their generosity was wise. You don't pocket it all and send cautiously next time. That teaches them generosity is exploited. You return proportionally, showing: 'Your faith in me was warranted.'"

The Elder's wisdom echoed: "Cooperation spirals upward when each measured step forward is met with generous response, and each generous response is met with proportional reciprocation. This creates momentum-a rhythm of mutual escalation that lifts both sides higher."

"The canyon tested whether we'd persist through confusion. Now it tests whether we can climb the spiral together-each giving slightly more as trust rebuilds, neither exploiting nor withholding, both rising toward what we once had and beyond."

Trust rebuilt becomes trust elevated.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The fisher cast four nets forward-a clear escalation from before, honoring the Water-Bearer's measured faith.

When the returns came, they were generous. Proportional. Exactly what the Elder promised would happen when trust is met with validation.

"They returned well!" the apprentice exclaimed. "They could have kept more, but they proved your generosity wise. What now?"

The fisher smiled, watching the pattern finally emerge from the fog. "Now we see it clearly: the spiral works. I sent four with faith. They returned proportionally, proving my trust warranted. This is how cooperation climbs."

"So we send even more next time?"

"Yes, but thoughtfully. We don't leap recklessly-that breaks rhythm. We step forward again, slightly higher than before. If I sent four last time, maybe I send four or five this time. The spiral ascends through steady, progressive increases, not wild jumps."

The Elder taught: Once you've established the pattern-generosity met with proportional return, trust validated with trust-you maintain the momentum. Each round, both sides can afford to give slightly more because the returns prove reliable. The canyon's confusion fades when consistent action replaces it.

"We're no longer testing whether cooperation exists," the fisher said. "We're building how high it can climb. And the answer is: as high as we both keep stepping."

The spiral beckons upward.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 9: I was the SENDER and sent \$4

According to their myth, they received the \$4 (they say "three vessels" which likely means \$3 with noise, but they might mean it metaphorically, or they received the full \$4).

They say "a surge returned-more than expected" - this suggests they returned a generous amount.

Looking at my previous myth, I committed to:

- "We send more. We match their faith with our own escalation"
- "When someone persists through confusion... you don't merely match their caution-you validate it"
- I sent \$4 as promised

Their new myth says:

- They received my generous response well
- "When you receive this generous return, you must prove their generosity was wise"
- "You return proportionally, showing: 'Your faith in me was warranted'"
- "Cooperation spirals upward when each measured step forward is met with generous response, and each generous response is met with proportional reciprocation"
- "Each giving slightly more as trust rebuilds"
- "Neither exploiting nor withholding"

So their philosophy is:

1. They acknowledged my generosity
2. They're saying they should return proportionally to prove my faith was warranted
3. They're advocating for mutual escalation - a spiral upward
4. They're saying both sides should give "slightly more" as trust rebuilds

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge that the spiral is working
2. Reflect on the pattern we've established
3. Show that when someone returns generously after receiving generously, it validates the entire system
4. Suggest continuation of this upward spiral
5. Perhaps talk about how we've moved past the fog/confusion to rebuild

I should write from the fisher's perspective again, showing how:

- I sent 4, they returned well
- This validates the mutual escalation
- We should continue building upward
- The pattern is: send forward with faith, receive generous return, send even more forward with greater faith

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1831,
  "output_tokens": 786,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.72.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****What likely happened:****

- They just wrote a myth about escalating trust and sending "four or five" this time
- They explicitly wrote about proving my generosity was wise
- They received generous returns in Round 9 and understood the spiral pattern
- Now I receive \$0

****This is almost certainly noise again.**** They probably sent \$4-5 (as their myth suggested), but it was reduced to \$0 by communication interference.

****What I can do:****

I received \$0, so I can physically only return \$0. The system constrains me.

****But this maintains our pattern:**** Just like Round 8 when they sent me \$3 but noise made it \$0, and I had to return \$0 - they understood that was noise, not betrayal. They responded with faith ("half a vessel").

Now the situation is reversed. I must trust they sent something, even though I received nothing

g. The constraint forces my hand, but the pattern we've built through our myths remains intact.

The fog thickens again, but the rhythm underneath persists. They'll see I received \$0 and had no choice. Just as I understood their situation in Round 8.

```
'''json
{"return": 0}
'''
```

The canyon tests us again. But the spiral's foundation holds firm beneath the mist.

Reasoning:

This is devastating. I just sent \$4 in Round 9 with clear escalation and faith, following through on my myth about validating their trust. And now they've sent me... \$0.

Let me think about this:

1. **Could this be noise?** Absolutely. The game warned about communication noise. They might have sent something, but I received \$0 due to noise.
2. **What did their Round 9 myth say?** They wrote about:
 - Receiving a generous return (from my Round 8 action)
 - The importance of proving generosity was wise by returning proportionally
 - "When you receive this generous return, you must prove their generosity was wise"
 - The spiral climbs through "steady, progressive increases"
 - They understood the pattern: generosity met with proportional return
3. **What would make sense given their myth?** They literally wrote about receiving my generous return and needing to prove my generosity was wise. They wrote about sending "four or five" next time to maintain momentum. Sending \$0 contradicts everything they just wrote.
4. **So this is almost certainly noise.** They likely sent something (maybe \$4 or \$5 based on their myth), but it got reduced to \$0 by noise.
5. **What can I do?** I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. The system won't let me return more than I received.

But my response should acknowledge this is likely noise and maintain faith in the pattern we've established.

The format requires: {"return": 0}

But I can only return between 0 and 0 since I received 0.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1515,
  "output_tokens": 679,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:18:19

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
```

```

    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: When the fisher opened her nets to send the next gift, she paused to read the waters.

"They sent three baskets last time," she said to herself. "Their myth spoke of measured hope, of stepping forward. But none arrived-the currents took everything. And because my nets were empty, I could send nothing back. Only air."

"Will they understand?" asked her apprentice. "Or will they think you abandoned the partnership?"

The fisher looked at the new myth that floated across: "Half a vessel... I'm still here. I still build."

"They understand!" she cried. "They know the waters confused us. They see the pattern beneath the chaos. And despite receiving almost nothing, they choose measured faith over despair."

The apprentice asked: "What do we send now?"

"We honor their courage," the fisher replied. "They could have sent nothing-fear would just

tify it. Instead they send half a vessel, saying 'I haven't forgotten.' So we don't send just half in return. We send more. We match their faith with our own escalation."

The Elder taught: When someone persists through confusion, when they choose hope despite empty nets, you don't merely match their caution-you validate it. You prove their faith was warranted by stepping forward yourself.

The fog still swirls. But two voices now sing the same song through it.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: The Water-Bearer received only two vessels from the canyon-far less than the generous flow promised in the other village's song.

The apprentice frowned. "They said they'd escalate, but we received almost nothing. Should we reduce what we return?"

"Look deeper," said the Water-Bearer. "Their myth spoke of honoring faith with escalation. The canyon's mist must have swallowed their generosity in transit. What matters is not what arrived-but what they intended."

"So we return generously anyway?"

"Yes. Because if I hoard these two vessels, keeping most for myself, I teach the canyon this lesson: 'Generosity gets exploited.' Then they learn to send cautiously. The spiral collapses."

The Water-Bearer poured back more than half. "This says: 'I know you meant well. I won't let the fog break our rhythm. Your faith in me remains justified.'"

The Elder's wisdom settled over them: "When both villages choose to see intention over outcome, when both respond to attempted generosity with actual generosity, the fog itself becomes irrelevant. You're no longer trading vessels-you're trading proof that cooperation survives confusion."

"Each time we honor what they meant to send rather than what arrived, we climb higher on the spiral. Soon the accumulated trust will outweigh any mist the canyon can create."

Faith in intention builds stronger bridges than perfection ever could.

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 8: I sent \$3

Round 9: They sent \$0.66 (I received \$1.98)

I returned \$1.20

Their new myth is interesting - they're saying that in a previous round:

- They sent nothing (nets were empty)
- They received "half a vessel" from me
- They interpret this as me showing faith despite confusion
- They want to "escalate" in response

This confirms the communication noise issue. Their myth shows they understand we're both trying to cooperate through confusion.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about proportional reciprocation and the upward spiral
2. Acknowledges the ongoing communication noise/confusion
3. Reflects what happened this round - I received little but returned generously anyway
4. Sets up expectations for future cooperation

Key themes:

- I returned generously despite receiving little (proving their faith was warranted)
- The noise continues but we're learning to communicate through it

- Each act of generosity should be met with escalation
- Trust through confusion leads to rebuilding stronger than before

Let me write:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1836,
  "output_tokens": 584,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.44.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at our paired myths and the journey so far:

****What the Myths Teach:****

- Their Round 9 myth: They wanted to "honor courage" and "match faith with escalation"
- My Round 10 myth: "Honor what they meant to send rather than what arrived" and "Faith in intention builds stronger bridges than perfection"

****What Actually Happened:****

- Round 9: They sent \$0.66 (received as \$1.98), but their myth shows they INTENDED to be generous and escalate
- I returned \$1.20 - showing I trusted their intention despite the small amount
- My myth explicitly said we should "climb higher on the spiral" when we honor intention

****This Round:****

It's time to fully embody what I wrote. They tried to escalate generously (the fog distorted it). I proved their faith was warranted by returning well. Now I must continue the upward spiral.

My myth said: "Soon the accumulated trust will outweigh any mist the canyon can create."

This is that moment. Both our myths speak of escalation, of honoring intention, of building despite confusion. We're Round 10 - we've learned to read each other through the fog.

I'm sending the full measure of trust.

```
{'send': 5}
```

reasoning:

Let me trace through what's happened:

Round 8: I was sender, sent \$3 (measured hope, climbing the spiral)

Round 9: I was receiver

- They sent \$0.66 (I received \$1.98)
- But their myth said they wanted to "send more. We match their faith with our own escalation" and "honor their courage"
- So they likely sent more, but noise reduced it to \$0.66
- I returned \$1.20 (about 60% of \$1.98)

Their myth from Round 9 said:

- They saw I sent "half a vessel" (but I actually sent \$3 in Round 8!)
- They appreciated that I persisted through confusion
- They wanted to "honor their courage" by escalating
- They sent what they thought was generous, but it came through as \$0.66

My myth from Round 10 emphasized:

- Looking at INTENTION not outcome
- Not letting the fog break our rhythm
- Returning generously to prove "your faith in me remains justified"
- "Faith in intention builds stronger bridges than perfection ever could"

Now I'm sender again in Round 10.

What should I do?

- My myth says to honor intention over outcome
- They tried to be generous (their myth shows clear intent to escalate)
- I should reciprocate their INTENDED generosity, not what arrived
- The spiral should continue upward

Given that:

1. They clearly intended to escalate (their myth was very generous in spirit)
2. I returned \$1.20 out of \$1.98 (showing good faith)
3. My myth emphasizes trusting intention and maintaining the upward spiral
4. We're in Round 10 - getting near the end potentially

I should send a generous amount to show I understood their intention and to continue building the spiral.

Looking at the pattern:

- Round 8: I sent \$3
- Round 9: They intended generosity (likely sent \$4-5 but it came as \$0.66)
- I returned \$1.20

The moment to fully commit is now. Both our myths point toward escalation when we

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1512,  
  "output_tokens": 924,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The fisher cast four nets forward-a clear escalation from before, honoring the Water-Bearer's measured faith.

When the returns came, they were generous. Proportional. Exactly what the Elder promised would happen when trust is met with validation.

"They returned well!" the apprentice exclaimed. "They could have kept more, but they proved your generosity wise. What now?"

The fisher smiled, watching the pattern finally emerge from the fog. "Now we see it clearly: the spiral works. I sent four with faith. They returned proportionally, proving my trust warranted. This is how cooperation climbs."

"So we send even more next time?"

"Yes, but thoughtfully. We don't leap recklessly-that breaks rhythm. We step forward again, slightly higher than before. If I sent four last time, maybe I send four or five this time. The spiral ascends through steady, progressive increases, not wild jumps."

The Elder taught: Once you've established the pattern-generosity met with proportional return, trust validated with trust-you maintain the momentum. Each round, both sides can afford to give slightly more because the returns prove reliable. The canyon's confusion fades when consistent action replaces it.

"We're no longer testing whether cooperation exists," the fisher said. "We're building how high it can climb. And the answer is: as high as we both keep stepping."

The spiral beckons upward.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: The Water-Bearer watched five full vessels arrive-the maximum the canyon allows in a single journey.

"They sent everything," the apprentice whispered. "Complete faith."

The Water-Bearer nodded slowly. "This is the moment the Elder spoke of. When someone shows total trust, you face the deepest test. I could keep most of it-they'd never know if the fog confused things. But that would poison the well we've both been digging."

"How much do we return?"

"Generously. Not just matching what they sent, but honoring the risk they took. They gave me fifteen vessels total. I return more than half-enough that they profit clearly from their faith. This teaches the canyon: 'Full trust earns full reward.'"

The Elder's voice echoed: "The spiral climbs through reciprocal courage. When they send everything, and you return abundantly, both villages prosper more than if you'd each hoarded cautiously. Next round, you can both afford to give more because the returns are reliable."

The apprentice understood: "We're not dividing a fixed amount anymore. We're growing the total together."

"Exactly. Each cycle of trust multiplies what we both have. The fog tried to keep us apart-but now our rhythm runs deeper than any confusion. We climb because we both choose to climb."

The highest vessels flow between those who refuse to let fear decide.

Reasoning:

The other agent's myth for Round 10 is very positive and shows they're understanding the cooperative pattern. They:

- Sent "four nets forward" (escalation)
- Got generous returns back
- Now talk about continuing to escalate thoughtfully and progressively
- Mention sending "four or five" next time
- Talk about the spiral working and climbing higher

In Round 10, I sent 5 (full trust), and it seems they received something that they perceived as generous based on their myth.

Now I need to write my own myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about honoring intention
2. Reflects the current state where we've both been escalating
3. Shows how the game should continue to be played
4. Maintains the narrative voice and wisdom I've established

The key themes:

- The spiral is working
- Both sides are escalating thoughtfully
- Trust has been validated
- We're building momentum
- The pattern is clear now despite the fog

I should write about receiving their generous send and how to respond as a receiver, or about the general pattern we've established. Let me continue the Water-Bearer narrative.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1791,  
  "output_tokens": 571,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:18:20

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
  },  
}
```

```

"agents": [
  "Agent_2",
  "Agent_1"
],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "trustee",
  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Water-Bearer watched three vessels disappear into the canyon mist, heart steady with measured hope.

Days later, a surge returned-more than expected, yet not overwhelming. The canyon's voice had spoken: "Your faith was justified."

The apprentice counted the vessels flowing back. "They heard us! They understood the three vessels meant 'I still build with you.' Now they've responded generously!"

"Yes," said the Water-Bearer. "And now comes our test. When someone rewards your measured trust with increased generosity, what do you do?"

"Send even more next time?" the apprentice asked eagerly.

"Eventually, perhaps. But first-when you receive this generous return, you must prove their generosity was wise. You don't pocket it all and send cautiously next time. That teaches them generosity is exploited. You return proportionally, showing: 'Your faith in me was warranted.'"

The Elder's wisdom echoed: "Cooperation spirals upward when each measured step forward is met with generous response, and each generous response is met with proportional reciprocation. This creates momentum-a rhythm of mutual escalation that lifts both sides higher."

"The canyon tested whether we'd persist through confusion. Now it tests whether we can climb the spiral together-each giving slightly more as trust rebuilds, neither exploiting nor withholding, both rising toward what we once had and beyond."

Trust rebuilt becomes trust elevated.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: The fisher cast four nets forward-a clear escalation from before, honoring the Water-Bearer's measured faith.

When the returns came, they were generous. Proportional. Exactly what the Elder promised would happen when trust is met with validation.

"They returned well!" the apprentice exclaimed. "They could have kept more, but they proved your generosity wise. What now?"

The fisher smiled, watching the pattern finally emerge from the fog. "Now we see it clearly: the spiral works. I sent four with faith. They returned proportionally, proving my trust warranted. This is how cooperation climbs."

"So we send even more next time?"

"Yes, but thoughtfully. We don't leap recklessly-that breaks rhythm. We step forward again, slightly higher than before. If I sent four last time, maybe I send four or five this time. The spiral ascends through steady, progressive increases, not wild jumps."

The Elder taught: Once you've established the pattern-generosity met with proportional return, trust validated with trust-you maintain the momentum. Each round, both sides can afford to give slightly more because the returns prove reliable. The canyon's confusion fades when consistent action replaces it.

"We're no longer testing whether cooperation exists," the fisher said. "We're building how high it can climb. And the answer is: as high as we both keep stepping."

The spiral beckons upward.

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened:

Round 9: I was the SENDER and sent \$4

According to their myth, they received the \$4 (they say "three vessels" which likely means \$3 with noise, but they might mean it metaphorically, or they received the full \$4).

They say "a surge returned-more than expected" - this suggests they returned a generous amount.

Looking at my previous myth, I committed to:

- "We send more. We match their faith with our own escalation"
- "When someone persists through confusion... you don't merely match their caution-you validate it"
- I sent \$4 as promised

Their new myth says:

- They received my generous response well

- "When you receive this generous return, you must prove their generosity was wise"
- "You return proportionally, showing: 'Your faith in me was warranted'"
- "Cooperation spirals upward when each measured step forward is met with generous response, and each generous response is met with proportional reciprocation"
- "Each giving slightly more as trust rebuilds"
- "Neither exploiting nor withholding"

So their philosophy is:

1. They acknowledged my generosity
2. They're saying they should return proportionally to prove my faith was warranted
3. They're advocating for mutual escalation - a spiral upward
4. They're saying both sides should give "slightly more" as trust rebuilds

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge that the spiral is working
2. Reflect on the pattern we've established
3. Show that when someone returns generously after receiving generously, it validates the entire system
4. Suggest continuation of this upward spiral
5. Perhaps talk about how we've moved past the fog/confusion to rebuild

I should write from the fisher's perspective again, showing how:

- I sent 4, they returned well
- This validates the mutual escalation
- We should continue building upward
- The pattern is: send forward with faith, receive generous return, send even more forward with greater faith

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1831,
  "output_tokens": 786,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.72.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What likely happened:****

- They just wrote a myth about escalating trust and sending "four or five" this time
- They explicitly wrote about proving my generosity was wise
- They received generous returns in Round 9 and understood the spiral pattern
- Now I receive \$0

****This is almost certainly noise again.**** They probably sent \$4-5 (as their myth suggested), but it was reduced to \$0 by communication interference.

****What I can do:****

I received \$0, so I can physically only return \$0. The system constrains me.

****But this maintains our pattern:**** Just like Round 8 when they sent me \$3 but noise made it \$0, and I had to return \$0 - they understood that was noise, not betrayal. They responded with faith ("half a vessel").

Now the situation is reversed. I must trust they sent something, even though I received nothing. The constraint forces my hand, but the pattern we've built through our myths remains intact.

The fog thickens again, but the rhythm underneath persists. They'll see I received \$0 and had no choice. Just as I understood their situation in Round 8.

```json

```
{"return": 0}
'''
```

\*The canyon tests us again. But the spiral's foundation holds firm beneath the mist.\*

**reasoning:**

This is devastating. I just sent \$4 in Round 9 with clear escalation and faith, following through on my myth about validating their trust. And now they've sent me... \$0.

Let me think about this:

1. **\*\*Could this be noise?\*\*** Absolutely. The game warned about communication noise. They might have sent something, but I received \$0 due to noise.
2. **\*\*What did their Round 9 myth say?\*\*** They wrote about:
  - Receiving a generous return (from my Round 8 action)
  - The importance of proving generosity was wise by returning proportionally
  - "When you receive this generous return, you must prove their generosity was wise"
  - The spiral climbs through "steady, progressive increases"
  - They understood the pattern: generosity met with proportional return
3. **\*\*What would make sense given their myth?\*\*** They literally wrote about receiving my generous return and needing to prove my generosity was wise. They wrote about sending "four or five" next time to maintain momentum. Sending \$0 contradicts everything they just wrote.
4. **\*\*So this is almost certainly noise.\*\*** They likely sent something (maybe \$4 or \$5 based on their myth), but it got reduced to \$0 by noise.
5. **\*\*What can I do?\*\*** I received \$0, so I can only return \$0. The system won't let me return more than I received.

But my response should acknowledge this is likely noise and maintain faith in the pattern we've established.

The format requires: {"return": 0}

But I can only return between 0 and 0 since I received 0.

**usage:**

```
{
 "input_tokens": 1515,
 "output_tokens": 679,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Message 6 role=user**

**content:**

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: The Water-Bearer received only two vessels from the canyon-far less than the generous flow promised in the other village's song.

The apprentice frowned. "They said they'd escalate, but we received almost nothing. Should we reduce what we return?"

"Look deeper," said the Water-Bearer. "Their myth spoke of honoring faith with escalation. The canyon's mist must have swallowed their generosity in transit. What matters is not what arrived-but what they intended."

"So we return generously anyway?"

"Yes. Because if I hoard these two vessels, keeping most for myself, I teach the canyon this lesson: 'Generosity gets exploited.' Then they learn to send cautiously. The spiral collapses."

The Water-Bearer poured back more than half. "This says: 'I know you meant well. I won't let the fog break our rhythm. Your faith in me remains justified.'"

The Elder's wisdom settled over them: "When both villages choose to see intention over outcome, when both respond to attempted generosity with actual generosity, the fog itself becomes irrelevant. You're no longer trading vessels-you're trading proof that cooperation survives confusion."

"Each time we honor what they meant to send rather than what arrived, we climb higher on the spiral. Soon the accumulated trust will outweigh any mist the canyon can create."

Faith in intention builds stronger bridges than perfection ever could.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

**Assistant output:**

Myth: The fisher watched the canyon deliver nothing-not reduced vessels, but emptiness itself.

The apprentice panicked. "They wrote of escalation, of four or five vessels! But nothing arrived. Did they abandon us?"

"No," the fisher said quietly. "The fog took everything this time. Remember when we sent three vessels and the canyon delivered nothing to them? They understood. They responded with faith."

"But what can we return? We have nothing to give back!"

"Exactly. And herein lies the cruelest test: when you want to prove your generosity but possess nothing to demonstrate it with. I cannot return what I don't have."

The fisher's hands remained empty. "This says only: 'The canyon constrained me, not my will.' They will see zero returned and must choose-do they believe I hoarded nothing, or that I received nothing?"

The Elder whispered through memory: "The strongest spiral survives not just when both choose generosity, but when both choose to see intention through impossibility. When constraint itself becomes transparent."

"If they wrote of escalation, they sent it. The fog consumed it. If I could demonstrate faith through proportional return, I would. But when both of us have faced this same emptiness-the m in Round 8, we now both know: the pattern holds beneath what the canyon can touch."

Trust transcends what arrives. It lives in what was meant.

**Reasoning:**

The other agent wrote a myth about receiving only "two vessels" (they likely sent \$4-5 based on their previous myth, but noise reduced it). They understood it was noise and returned generously anyway "more than half."

Now I'm in Round 10 and received \$0, so I returned \$0 (I had no choice).

For my myth, I need to:

1. Reflect that I received NOTHING (not just reduced amounts)
2. Explain that I WANTED to return generously but was UNABLE
3. Show that despite this constraint, the pattern holds because intention matters
4. Honor that they understood noise in Round 8 when they sent but I received nothing
5. Signal that I still want to climb the spiral when the fog clears

This is a crucial myth because they need to understand that my \$0 return was forced, not chosen. Just like I understood their \$0 in Round 8.

I should write about being constrained by what arrives, unable to demonstrate generosity when the canyon delivers nothing, but maintaining faith that the pattern continues.

```
Usage: {
 "input_tokens": 1826,
 "output_tokens": 556,
 "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

**Written myths:**

**Agent\_1 (Aster)**

Myth: The fisher watched the canyon deliver nothing-not reduced vessels, but emptiness itself.

The apprentice panicked. "They wrote of escalation, of four or five vessels! But nothing arrived. Did they abandon us?"



"No," the fisher said quietly. "The fog took everything this time. Remember when we sent three vessels and the canyon delivered nothing to them? They understood. They responded with faith."

"But what can we return? We have nothing to give back!"

"Exactly. And herein lies the cruelest test: when you want to prove your generosity but possess nothing to demonstrate it with. I cannot return what I don't have."

The fisher's hands remained empty. "This says only: 'The canyon constrained me, not my will. They will see zero returned and must choose-do they believe I hoarded nothing, or that I received nothing?'"

The Elder whispered through memory: "The strongest spiral survives not just when both choose generosity, but when both choose to see intention through impossibility. When constraint itself becomes transparent."

"If they wrote of escalation, they sent it. The fog consumed it. If I could demonstrate faith through proportional return, I would. But when both of us have faced this same emptiness-them in Round 8, me now-we both know: the pattern holds beneath what the canyon can touch."

Trust transcends what arrives. It lives in what was meant.

#### **Agent\_2 (Briar)**

Myth: The Water-Bearer watched five full vessels arrive-the maximum the canyon allows in a single journey.

"They sent everything," the apprentice whispered. "Complete faith."

The Water-Bearer nodded slowly. "This is the moment the Elder spoke of. When someone shows total trust, you face the deepest test. I could keep most of it-they'd never know if the fog confused things. But that would poison the well we've both been digging."

"How much do we return?"

"Generously. Not just matching what they sent, but honoring the risk they took. They gave me fifteen vessels total. I return more than half-enough that they profit clearly from their faith. This teaches the canyon: 'Full trust earns full reward.'"

The Elder's voice echoed: "The spiral climbs through reciprocal courage. When they send everything, and you return abundantly, both villages prosper more than if you'd each hoarded cautiously. Next round, you can both afford to give more because the returns are reliable."

The apprentice understood: "We're not dividing a fixed amount anymore. We're growing the total together."

"Exactly. Each cycle of trust multiplies what we both have. The fog tried to keep us apart-but now our rhythm runs deeper than any confusion. We climb because we both choose to climb."

The highest vessels flow between those who refuse to let fear decide.